行至摩卢旁卡
Journey to Mor Pankh

目录 / Contents

观星者们 / The Stargazers . . . 2

黄水晶灵摆 / Yellow Crystal Pendulum . . . 6

寻宝新骑兵 / The Young Indiana Jones . . . 14

交织线 / Intersecting Lines . . . 21

继承者 / The Heir . . . 28

石窟异响 / Noises from the Stone Cellar . . . 37

菩提树 / The Sacred Fig . . . 37

银手镯 / The Silver Bangle . . . 48

泪水壶 / Drown in Tears . . . 55

小守护者 · 1/2 / The Little Guardians · 1/2 . . . 62

太阳升起，月亮落下。生命的指引在新芽上跃动，也许不必真的日复一日。 / The sun rises and the moon veils its face. Life's gentle fingers guide each tender seedling, a hint of a different path free of monotony. . . . 66

金星闪烁。思绪自唇舌开启，从笔尖流露，于一切始源的创造中生发。 / Venus shines. Thoughts flow easily from your lips into your pen. The wellspring of Creation shall gush unabated. . . . 66

木星沉默。在阁楼上点一盏灯吧，放任想象的边际延展，因它无尽。 / Jupiter falls silent. Light a lamp in your attic and allow your boundless imagination to wander. . . . 66

水星追溯。自走的放映机，脱口而出的预言。被动的表达需要被掐灭在襁褓之中。 / Mercury is in retrograde. A projector that plays on its own, the predictions that issue forth uninvited. Any desire for reticence must be stymied. . . . 66

月亮高悬，太阳低沉。天穹与地境手牵着手，就像世界最开始那样。 / The Moon hangs high in the sky, the Sun in its thrall. Heaven and Earth have joined hands again, as they did when the world was born. . . . 66

另一座山岩 / The Other Mountain Boulder . . . 67

小守护者 · 2/2 / The Little Guardians · 2/2 . . . 67

篱笆墙之外 / Outside the Fence . . . 68

硕鼠的智慧 / Rat and Its Days . . . 73

以卵击石 / Straws Against the Wind . . . 79

芝麻开门 / Open Sesame . . . 82

无星之地 / No Starry Sky . . . 92

博识者美餐 / Feast for the Savant . . . 95

新观星者们 / The New Stargazers . . . 98

无昼无夜 / Neither Day Nor Night . . . 103

观星者们
The Stargazers JMP-01

???: Hypotheses have been made regarding the quasars as follows ...
???: ……关于类星体，我们有以下假设……

The hall was packed with audience members.
会场内座无虚席。

exhales
呼——

The darkness below the podium is boiling. The eyes with questions and inspection, some behind glasses, are cast out of the darkness.
讲台下方的黑暗翻涌着。那些质询的，审视的，或许在镜片后的目光滑出了黑暗。

Just like the signals beamed from several light years away and received at the top of the observatory.
仿佛我们曾在塔顶观测到的，那些几光年外的讯号。

???: Good.
???: ……很好。

???: Based on the data of its redshift, Dr. Schmidt deduced that it is moving away from us at a recessional velocity of 1/6 of light speed.
???: 根据光谱红移，施密特博士初步推算它的退行速度可达到光速的六分之一……

Page 3, mmm, I did put it in ...
第三页……第三页我记得我放在……

???: In most cases, we would consider a stellar black hole as what is left from the gravitational collapse of a star.
???: ……通常，我们认为恒星黑洞是恒星坍塌后的遗骸。

The red chalk left a jaggy circle in one stroke on the blackboard.
红色的粉笔在黑板上的圆圈周边留下了一圈嶙峋的痕迹。

???: They fight, attract each other, and merge into a supermassive black hole to which the stars in the nearby galaxies will be eventually pulled by gravity ...
???: 它们相互斗争、吸引、融合，最终成为超大质量黑洞——也是其周围星系内恒星的最后归宿……

Page 3, oh, here it is. Did Kumar put it here for me?
啊，第三页在这儿。是库玛尔给我调整的位置吗?

"Then there was neither existence nor non-existence; there was neither the realm of space nor the sky beyond."
“于那时日，混沌中空无一物。存在者与非存在者皆无，无至上之域，无大气，无天穹。”

???: *"Then there was neither death nor immortality; there was neither day nor night."*
???: “无死无生，无昼无夜。”

???: Inside the quasars, there is a violent activity occurring that is close to a supernova.
???: 类星体之中……正发生着一场近似于超新星爆发的剧烈活动。

???: It devours stars ...
???: 它吞噬恒星……

???: And the gas cloud turns into stars out of gravitational driving.
???: 其生成的气体云在引力作用下又将重新耦合——

???: Thus, a new star is born.
???: 诞生出新的恒星。

???: It is a graveyard filled with corpses.
???: 它是由恒星的尸骸融成的墓茔。

???: As well as a cradle for new stars.
???: ——却亦是恒星诞生的摇篮。

Meadow
野草地

The evening breeze, the meadow, and the fresh air. Despite its lack of privacy, this was as good a place to chill as it could be.
风，草地，新鲜的空气，这里是个并不隐秘的好去处。

It was a clear night. Stars twinkled in the sky like golden sprinkles on a dark cloth.
今日的夜空格外的晴朗，群星闪烁，清晰可辨。

???: That was a successful lecture, Kaalaa Baunaa.
???: 成功的演讲，伽菈波那。

Kaalaa Baunaa heard a familiar voice and recognized the footsteps. Without looking back, she already knew who was behind her.
熟悉的声音与步伐节奏，无需回头，脑海便能浮现出那抹身影。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Thanks for your rare compliment.
伽菈波那: 感谢你难得的夸奖。

She extended her arm, reaching out for the stars.
她伸出手去，仿佛能碰到繁星。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I can't believe the first thing you do after the long absence is listening to my embarrassing speech.
伽菈波那: 没想到你离开这么长的时间，回来第一件事就是亲自来看我出糗……

Kaalaa Baunaa: You see, this is not my thing. I'm still struggling with a word I should use in Part 3.
伽菈波那: 你知道，我并不擅长这些……我现在仍认为自己在第三部分的一处用词不够精准。

???: Oh, but you know I won't pass up a good chance to sit in the audience ...
???: 哦，但你也知道，我无法抗拒这样美妙的观众席——

The grass rustled. She lay down next to Kaalaa Baunaa.
身侧草丛窸窣作响——有人并排躺了下来。

???: ... to be someone who can smile knowingly at the argument made by the lecturer, knowing full well the thinking process behind, while staying close to other whispering opinions.
???: 既能与讲台上的瞩目者心照不宣，又能清晰地感受周围的窃窃私语……

???: This is the perfect spot for observations, like a perfect observatory from which we witness the events in the universe!
???: 置身事内的绝佳观景位，正如同我们在这个星球上去观测宇宙里的一切！

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'd rather not give a comment on your personal taste. Kumar, I think we should make some adjustments to the details of the following observation.
伽菈波那: 唉。比起评判你的个人趣味……库玛尔，我认为之后的观测仍需要做一些细节上的调整——

Kumar: Here's an idea. How about we put away the work for the moment? Forget those things. Just look at the stars. Simply fix your eyes on them. Ah, move over. The grass beneath me feels like pine needles.
库玛尔: 我有个建议——这会儿放下工作如何？就好好儿地、单纯地看看这些星星……往那边躺躺，这草怎么像松针似的扎人……

Kaalaa Baunaa: When you were away, Daane from the institution had paid a visit here. Based on his attitude, I may tell he was doubting my identity as a human.
伽菈波那：……在你离开的这几个月里，研究所的达恩曾来过。看他的态度，似乎已经对我的人类身份起了疑心。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: If it goes on like this, we are likely to be kicked out of our own project.
伽菈波那：这样下去我们很有可能被踢出这个原本属于我们自己的项目……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I've destroyed all the observation data of that special celestial body. At least through this, we can keep the observation method between you and me.
伽菈波那：关于那个特殊天体的观测资料我已经全部销毁了……至少这样可以暂时确保观测方式只有咱们两人掌握。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Her words were only met with a lasting silence. Kaalaa Baunaa turned to the person next to her.
长久的沉默。伽菈波那微微侧头望向身侧。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You seem ... Have I done anything wrong?
伽菈波那：看你的表情……我做错了什么吗?

Kumar: No. As a research student, you did an excellent job, though no more than I'd expect from a student of mine.
库玛尔：不，以研究项目的角度来说，你做得很好——不过我对此早有预料。

Her voice was incredibly calm.
她的声音出奇地平静。

Kumar: That's just what we've been doing, isn't it? Hiding in the corners, doing research that **completely** has nothing to do with others.
库玛尔：我们不总是这样？偷偷摸摸、躲躲藏藏，做一些——**完全**与世无争的研究。

Kumar: You know what? I'm a bit tired, seriously, tired of the pointless power struggles between these specks of "stardust." We all know none of us could avoid the fate of being restored to the basic elements of the universe after we die.
库玛尔：……你知道吗？我真的有些厌烦了，厌烦这些“星际尘土”之间的无聊斗争，明明死了之后都会变为这个偌大宇宙的一部分……

She sighed deeply at the thought.
她深深叹了口气。

Kumar: Never mind. It's not the first time it's happened. I've never been welcomed on either side.
库玛尔：……算了，这又不是第一次。反正我无论在哪边都不受欢迎。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kumar: Ah, speaking of which ...
库玛尔：嘁，说起这个……

Hooked by the conversation, unpleasant memories swam up again.
她显然因为这个话题被勾起了更不好的回忆。

Kumar: My parents, yeah, I told you about them. They abandoned me because I had little so-called talent for arcanum.
库玛尔：我那对父母——我和你说过的，那对因为我见鬼的薄弱神秘学家血统而抛弃我的父母……

Kumar: And now, they are showing remorse for what they have done!
库玛尔：如今……他们竟然感到对不起我！

Kumar: There's more—my stupid younger brother knew nothing about what happened to me. He didn't even recognize me, his own sister!
库玛尔：更离谱的是——我那个傻弟弟竟然一无所知……甚至没认出我是他姐姐！

Kaalaa Baunaa: You paid them a visit this time back in your hometown?
伽菈波那：……你这次回乡见到他们了？

Kumar: Visit them? No, sweetheart, I went home to ... to do many things except to hear some old people's apology! I've never cared about those things.
库玛尔：见？不，亲爱的，我是去——反正不是为了听人忏悔去的！我没在乎过那些。

Kumar: I went there to deal with a little business, and it was done smoothly.
库玛尔：我只是去处理些小事……而且很顺利。

She seemed to be in a state of ease.
她似乎感到了安心。

Kumar: So smoothly that I've taken care of everything there is to be done.
库玛尔：顺利到……我把我能做到的，都做到了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...?
伽菈波那：……?

Kumar: Kaalaa Baunaa, if ...
库玛尔：伽菈波那，如果……

A gust of wind blew by the meadow. The subtle sound of plant fibers rubbing against each other could be heard clearly.
一阵风吹过草地。纤维细碎的摩擦音清晰地传入耳中。

Kumar: If one day, we can see that celestial body with our own eyes, or even touch it with our own hands, I will definitely ...
库玛尔：如果有一天，我们能亲眼看到那个天体，能触碰到它的话……我一定——

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar?
伽菈波那：库玛尔?

Kaalaa Baunaa: What are you talking ab- ...
伽菈波那：你在说什……

Kaalaa Baunaa propped herself up on both of her elbows, trying to see the one beside her clearly.
女孩倏地支起身子，试图看清身旁的人。

But that person's face was indistinguishable, as if hidden in a thick black fog.
可对方的面容就像是隐藏在黑色的浓雾之后，令人无法辨认。

Kumar: I WILL DEFINITELY ...!
库玛尔：把他们*……&%……都*&*——！

Kaalaa Baunaa: KUMAR!
伽菈波那：库玛尔！

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

3#1
3#1

黄水晶灵摆
Yellow Crystal Pendulum JMP-02

Matilda: Excuse me.
玛蒂尔达：让我——

Matilda: Let me get through!
玛蒂尔达：过——去——！

Train Station, Mor Pankh, 1966
1966 摩卢旁卡火车站

Matilda: Ah! Will you move, please? For the sake of Marie Anne Lenormand!
玛蒂尔达：哦……让让，都给我让开……看在勒诺曼的面子上！

The crowds on the platform are like schools of colorful sardines, pushing each other toward their destinations at an incredible speed.
站台上熙熙攘攘的人流像是忙碌的彩色沙丁鱼群，相互拥挤着，以极快的速度涌向各自的方向。

Matilda: Oh, finally! Ah-ah, ouch, this train ride gave me a real pain in the neck!
玛蒂尔达：总算——痛痛，挤火车挤得脖子好痛啊。

She finally gets to relax in one of the few empty seats in the station.
女孩卸了浑身的力气，瘫倒在车站为数不多的空座椅上。

Matilda: How nice it'd be if I were to sleep on my bed in such cool and comfortable weather! Or I may as well just stay in Delhi with Mom to sell those topazes!
玛蒂尔达：这样凉爽的天气，如果能在我的小床上睡上一觉……或者干脆和妈妈一起留在德里，卖完那些黄水晶也好啊！

Matilda: *sighs*
玛蒂尔达：唉……

Her fist tightens, though she doesn't consciously want to. The documents rattle in her hand.
手掌不自觉地收紧，小小的动作让手中的资料发出了轻微的响动。

She looks down at the documents.
她低下头去，看向手中的一叠纸张。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: No! Matilda will not just give up here!
玛蒂尔达：不行，玛蒂尔达绝对不会放弃！

Matilda: Who knows when they will approve my leave next time?
玛蒂尔达：谁知道下次外出审批等到什么时候?

Matilda: These days, the celestial energy appears to be ideally strong, and the best observation area happens to be close to Delhi. What a heaven-sent opportunity for this genius of divination! Only the fools will take no action!
玛蒂尔达：难得观测到这么充沛的天体能量——距离这样近、这样刚好，简直是为我这样的占卜天才特意准备的……笨蛋才会让好机会溜走！

Matilda: Wait and see. When I find the right place to meditate ...
玛蒂尔达：等着吧，等我找到那个冥想点修习了之后——

She slightly shakes her fist. It seems she has made up her mind very seriously.
女孩轻轻挥舞着拳头，像是下了什么了不起的决心一般。

Matilda: Hum-humph, sooner or later, I will take my ride back to the top!
玛蒂尔达：哼哼，第一的宝座早晚会回到我手里！

She rummages through the documents and moves close enough to read the poorly printed text.
她手上翻动着，凑近查看那些印刷模糊的文字。

Matilda: Emm, let me see what this poster is about. Emm, Dīpa Festival?
玛蒂尔达：唔，让我看看，他们究竟发的是什么的宣传海报……烛星节？

She turns over the poster.
手中的海报被翻了个面。

Matilda: *"People in Mor Pankh hold the Dīpa Festival during the meteor shower period every year to seek the blessings of Vindre."*
玛蒂尔达：“……而摩卢旁卡将每年的流星雨期定为烛星节，以祈求毗因陀神的护佑……”

Matilda: Oh, so it's based on the meteor shower here! Vindre ... I think I have seen this name in the materials.
玛蒂尔达：哦，原来是与当地的流星周期相关！毗因陀……我记得我查到的资料里提到过这个名字……

Matilda: Now I'm in the east of Chandigarh. Can there be fewer signs here?
玛蒂尔达：我现在在……昌迪加尔东面……这里的景点标识也太少了吧？

Matilda: Ah-ha! This map has English on its back! Very nice. Would be more classy if they put French here instead.
玛蒂尔达：啊哈！地图背面有英语版！很好，如果有法语版的就更有品位了。

Matilda: The place I found through divination is called Mor Pankh. It's a shrine! I need to go to its north cave?
玛蒂尔达：之前占卜出来的地方是——摩，摩卢……旁卡……是个神庙！是它的……北窟？

Matilda: Good. So, a shrine. Perhaps it has something to do with that comet myth I read about earlier. Isn't this also one of the places to see the upcoming meteor shower?
玛蒂尔达：神庙……那或许与我调查到的那个彗星神话有些关系，最近这里是不是也要有流星雨来着？

Matilda: Great! This is where I am going, then. Where's my pen? Ah, here! Very good, let me put it down.
玛蒂尔达：好！目的地确定了。我的笔呢……在这里！很好，让我先标记一下……

She hunches over and writes down something carefully.
女孩躬起身子，努力地在纸上标记着什么。

Matilda: Phew! Nicely done! Everything is a lot more convenient in the new town.
玛蒂尔达：呼！大功告成！新城真是方便多了……

The ceiling looks new. This train station seems to have been built not too long ago.
仰头望去，车站的天花板看起来像是才搭建了不久，光洁如新。

Matilda: Looks a lot better than the ceiling in Delhi's train station. I wonder how Mom and Dad are doing now. That Indian man can speak really fast when he's bargaining.
玛蒂尔达：德里的看上去甚至比这里还旧些。也不知爸爸妈妈在那边还顺利吗……那个印度大叔讲起价来语速真夸张……

Matilda: Emm.
玛蒂尔达：唔……

As she slackens off, tiredness catches up with her.
松懈下来的神经令疲惫缓缓攀上躯体。

Matilda: Emm. Just one quick nap, very brief ...
玛蒂尔达：唔……就休息一下……就一下……

Matilda: ... Zzz ...
玛蒂尔达：……Zzz……

???: Wow, cool! What a bold girl!
???：哇，真不错，够胆大的……

???: Hee hee ...
???：嘻嘻……

???: Guys, you see that? The girl brave enough to sleep in the train station.
???：大伙儿，看到了没？那个敢在火车站睡觉的家伙……

Ajar: Err, I see nothing, Boss! Not everyone has the great eyesight as yours. Oh, thank you. Nice monocular.
阿贾尔：呃……看不到哇，坎吉拉大姐！像你这样的好眼神能有几个——呃，好吧，谢谢你的望远镜……

Ajar: Oh, shiny jewels and wallet.
阿贾尔：哦哦，亮晶晶的宝石和钱包……

Ajar: But what is the thing she is holding so tightly, even when she's asleep? Isn't that the map they give away at the train station for free?
阿贾尔：可她怎么睡着了还能把手里那堆纸攥得那样紧？我记得车站门口的地图是免费的……

Kanjira: Hmm, something valuable, I guess? Like the treasure map pictures in the books! If I can take a closer look ...
坎吉拉：唔，没准儿是什么值钱的东西？像是那些书中插画里的藏宝图！要是能凑近一些……

Kanjira: Well, that's too hard for you. Ajar, you go from left, just as I taught you. Give me this gesture after you get it.
坎吉拉：算了，那个对你来说难度有点大……阿贾尔，你从左边过去，就按我教你的那样去做，得手了就打这个手势……

Ajar: Heh-heh, no problem!
阿贾尔：嘿嘿……没问题！

Kanjira: Do it well, boy! If you make it, that would be your first step to victory! Oh, remember, don't tell Ms. Sherjah I taught you these!
坎吉拉：好好干，小子！这单成功了，你就能顺利踏出第一步了！噢，记得，别告诉夏尔贾我教了你这些！

Kanjira: Go, go! Don't let other people get it before you do.
坎吉拉：去吧，快去。别让其他的家伙抢了生意……

Matilda: Umm ...?
玛蒂尔达：呃……嗯?

Matilda: What is it? Something swaying?
玛蒂尔达：什么……晃来晃去的……?

Sleepily, Matilda struggles to open her eyes and sees a little figure prowling away.
女孩儿迷迷糊糊地睁开眼，正看到一个鬼鬼祟祟，转身欲走的小小身影。

Ajar: Emm, ahem! Is this yours, Miss?
阿贾尔：呃，咳咳……小姐，这是你的东西吗?

Matilda: Emm? Hey, that's the pendulum Mom gave me! Who are you?
玛蒂尔达：嗯？嘿，这是我妈妈给我的灵摆！你是……

Ajar: It fell on the floor. I was just picking it up for you! There, don't lose it again.
阿贾尔：多亏我给你拾起来啦！喏，拿好了～

Matilda: Oh! Thank you ...
玛蒂尔达：哦！真是谢——

Matilda reaches for the pendulum.
玛蒂尔达伸出手，想要接过男孩掌心的灵摆。

???: Nuh-uh. It's yet too early to say thanks, girl.
???：可惜，谢得有点早啦，小姑娘。

Matilda: Hmm?
玛蒂尔达：嗯？

Shamane: They find themselves in the shadow of a tall man.
鬃毛沙砾：不知从哪里冒出来的巨大身影笼罩住了他们。

Shamane: The man seems travel-worn, but he's carrying just a little luggage.
鬃毛沙砾：男人看上去风尘仆仆，却没见他带着什么行李。

???: About three minutes ago? Or, five minutes ago? This fellow was wandering around you like a sneaky ferret-badger. Trust me. This is no friendly encounter.
???：三分钟前？五分钟前？这小子在你身边儿打转的样子就像只鼬獾——总之相信我，这可不是什么友好的巧合。

He raises his left hand, more specifically, his prosthesis, to show the delicate wallet between those seemingly stiff fingers.
他抬起左手，义肢看似僵硬的手指灵巧地夹着一枚精致的皮夹。

Matilda: Umm? That's mine. You! You stole my wallet?!
玛蒂尔达：嗯？这是我的——你这家伙，竟然偷了我钱夹?！

Ajar: Wha, what? I've put it in my pocket.
阿贾尔：什……我明明放在裤子——

???: Someone needs to work on his techniques, right, boy?
???：看起来你的技术不太过关，小子。

The man catches Ajar's clothes—this time with his real hand—and easily picks him up.
这次是那只正常的手，他轻巧地向上一提，男孩便像个小鸡一般被男人拎在了手里。

Ajar is lifted in the air, but he isn't strangled with his collar, for the man has skillfully avoided the area of his neck.
他抓得极有技巧，领子丝毫没碰到男孩脖子上的肌肤。

Ajar: Let go! Let go of me! D**n it! Go mind your own business!
阿贾尔：放手，别抓我衣服！可恶，怎么遇上个多管闲事的……

???: Unfortunate for you, my business these days is to mind others' business. Seems like there are more things in that pocket of yours. Come on, you know where we are going.
???：很不巧，多管闲事目前是我的主营业务。看样子你身上还有其他东西——走吧，有什么话到该说的地方去说。

Ajar: Ah! Urrrh!
阿贾尔：讨厌！啊呜——

Ajar shows his teeth and bites the man hard on the right hand, which is dragging his collar.
男孩呲着两排牙齿，一口咬上了男人正拎着他领子的右手臂。

???: Hiss—ah!
???：嘶——！

He lets go because of the pain. The little thief breaks free and quickly slips into the crowd.
小贼挣开那只因吃痛而松懈的手，飞速地滑入了人群中，向远处跑去。

Matilda: He's gotten away. My, my, my pendulum! He had my pendulum. Stop! You!
玛蒂尔达：他跑了——糟糕，我的灵摆还在他手上……给我站住！

Ajar: *pants* D**n it! They are catching up!
阿贾尔：呼……呼……噢，该死的，他们快追上来了！

Matilda: Stop right there, you little thief!
玛蒂尔达：赶快停下，你这个偷东西的坏家伙！

Ajar: Humph!
阿贾尔：哼！

The annoyed boy throws the pendulum into the distance with full strength.
恼羞成怒的男孩把灵摆狠狠地向远处一抛。

???: Ah, you, boy! Wait!
???：喂，你这小子……站住！

The man runs into the colorful schools of sardines in hot pursuit.
男人紧随其后，与男孩一起没入了彩色沙丁鱼群中。

Matilda: You! No! It's fragile. Don't!
玛蒂尔达：你——糟了，那个东西不能摔！

In a beautiful arc, the transparent topaz falls toward the ground like a meteor.
剔透的水晶在半空中划过一条优美的弧线，如流星一般向地面坠去。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

Suddenly, a palm appears and catches it safely.
——而突然出现的一只手掌稳稳接住了它。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Phew. Just in time.
伽菈波那：呼——刚刚好。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Is this yours?
伽菈波那：这是你掉的东西吗?

Matilda: Ah, yes.
玛蒂尔达：啊，是的……

The lady leans forward and speaks in a soft voice. Matilda stares into her eyes, completely abstracted.
女人微微俯下身，声音轻柔。玛蒂尔达抬头望向看着她的双眸，一时间没反应过来发生了什么。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Put it away, kid.
伽菈波那：拿好了，孩子。

As she tilts her palm, the topaz falls swiftly into Matilda's hand.
她的手掌微微倾斜，黄水晶从她的掌心轻巧地滑落到了玛蒂尔达的手心中。

Matilda: Ah, thank you.
玛蒂尔达：谢谢……

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's okay.
伽菈波那：举手之劳。

The lady slightly nods and leaves like a gust of wind.
女人微微颔首，像是一阵风一般转身离去。

Matilda: She left so quickly.
玛蒂尔达：她走得好快……

Matilda: Ah, the documents. Hope I didn't mess them up in the chase.
玛蒂尔达：哎！得赶紧核对下手里的资料，别只顾着追小偷弄乱了……

Matilda: One, two, emm? Two pages are missing. Where did they go?
玛蒂尔达：一……二……嗯？怎么少了两张？掉到哪里去了……

A small, black-haird head is peeking from behind a pillar nearby.
不远处的柱子后面，一颗小小的黑色脑袋探了出来。

Kanjira: Thankfully, I've planned my way out in advance. Well, at least Ajar won't be caught by anyone!
坎吉拉：……还好我提前就规划好了逃跑路线——至少阿贾尔在跑路上不会输给任何人！

Kanjira: Good luck running away, poor Ajar.
坎吉拉：祝你顺利，可怜的阿贾尔……

She puts her palms together and wobbles her head to show her pity.
女孩双手合十，颇为惋惜地晃了晃脑袋。

Kanjira: I will make a profit from her, including the part you failed to make. Humph, that easy mark with milky blonde hair, you'll see how Kanjira ...
坎吉拉：我会好好带着你的份再次赚回来的。哼，不过是个金色的小肥羊，看我怎么——

Kanjira: Whoa! What did I step on?
坎吉拉：哇！脚底下这是什么……！

Kanjira: Is this the thing she was looking at? Yes, my eyes won't fail me.
坎吉拉：这……这好像就是她看的那份？没错……我的眼睛绝不会出错……

Her face puckers up as she examines the paper in front of her.
女孩儿皱着小脸，仔仔细细地辨识着。

Kanjira: It really is a treasure map! Look here. She even drew a star, just like those pictures in books.
坎吉拉：没想到这真是藏宝图！瞧这儿还标着星星呢，和书里说的一样……

Kanjira: You lucky girl, Kanjira. This is really something valuable!
坎吉拉：这下可捡到好东西了，坎吉拉！

Kanjira: Let me see. Oh, I have to read it together with the handwritten notes. What are these, hmm? She spelled these all wrong! Even added some lines above them.
坎吉拉：我瞧瞧，哦，看上去得按标注才能……可这旁边写的什么……嗯？她怎么把词都拼错了？英文字母上面怎么还有花纹……

Matilda: Don't even bother trying. It's in French!
玛蒂尔达：——很遗憾，那是法语！

Kanjira: Hey! Don't even think about taking my treasure, oh.
坎吉拉：嘿！谁敢来抢我的藏宝——哦。

Matilda squints to scan the suspect, who is trying to avoid eye contact.
金发女孩眼睛微眯，打量着眼前眼神游离的可疑人员。

Matilda: What were you muttering about with my map?
玛蒂尔达：你拿着我的地图在这里鬼鬼祟祟地嘀咕什么呢?

Kanjira: Emm, ahem.
坎吉拉：呃，咳咳——

Kanjira: I, uh, just pick it up and look for its owner. Hope I can help!
坎吉拉：我，我这不是帮您捡起来，等着帮您呐！

Matilda: Help? Humph! Matilda needs no one's help! Not to mention from a girl who just showed up out of nowher- ... Hey! Don't ... don't touch me!
玛蒂尔达：帮我？哼，玛蒂尔达可从不需要别人的帮助！更别提你这个不知道从哪儿来的——喂！你，你别碰我！

Kanjira ignores Matilda's contempt. She holds Matilda's arm intimately, with a big smile on her face.
满脸堆笑的女孩全然无视了她语气里的不屑，甚至直接上前，亲昵地挽住了对方的胳膊。

Kanjira: Wow, you is so cool!
坎吉拉：哇，那您好厉害啊～

Kanjira: Is this your first time in the village? On your own? What's the plan? Sightseeing? Family visit? Or looking for some ...
坎吉拉：您第一次来的？自己来的？来做什么？观光？探亲？还是找某些——

Matilda: Hey! Let go first. Why's that any of your business?
玛蒂尔达：喂，你先放……你问这些做什么？

Kanjira: Umm, aha, I mean, perhaps not clear to you, but in fact, I am a guide who always give best service!
坎吉拉：咳咳，是这样的……您可能不知道，我是一位非常有个人追求的……向导！

Matilda: A guide? Who always gives the best service?
玛蒂尔达：有追求的向导？

Kanjira: A tour guide, maybe? Anyways, I tell you, nobody know this village better than I!
坎吉拉：哦，或者说是导游？总之，我敢说，没人能比我更熟悉这个村子……

Kanjira: Hey, don't stare at me like this. I'm wandering here for a reason: I only give services to outstanding and cool people. They have good taste!
坎吉拉：诶，您别这么看着我嘛，我在这儿闲逛是有原因的——我有个小小的个人习惯：我只愿意为那些厉害的，优秀的，有眼光的家伙服务～

Kanjira: That why I find you at the station from all travelers! My most great, great customer ever!
坎吉拉：所以我刚才一眼就注意到了您！我最伟大的服务对象！

Matilda: Ah! The outstanding and impressive people, you say. Humph, at least you have sharp eyes.
玛蒂尔达：优秀的，有眼光的……哼，算你眼神好使。

Matilda tries hard to suppress her complacent smile.
玛蒂尔达努力控制着自己嘴角上扬的弧度。

Kanjira: See, the place you is visiting is different from others!
坎吉拉：您看，您选择的这个位置就与众不同！

Kanjira: This shrine, only few tourists are willing to ... ahem, only the locals know! And now, people can only go into three caves out of four. But, if you choose I ...
坎吉拉：这神庙除了本地人没几个游客愿意……咳，知道！目前也只开放了三个窟，但如果是我——

The black-haired girl reaches out and pats the map on the star.
黑发女孩伸出手去，拍了拍地图上五角星的位置。

Kanjira: I can take you go north cave, even if it's not open!
坎吉拉：您标记的这个北窟，我同样能带您好好享受～

Matilda frowns in response. There is suspicion in her eyes.
玛蒂尔达皱起眉毛，眼中闪烁着质疑。

Matilda: How are you going to take me there?
玛蒂尔达：那你打算怎么带我去呢？

Kanjira: How, how I do that? Um, my local connections, of course!
坎吉拉：怎么带……怎么带比较合适？呃，当然是靠人脉啦！

Matilda: I see. No wonder there were some discrepancies between the documents and the tourist brochure. Ah-ahem, well, of course, I knew this all along!
玛蒂尔达：原来如此。怪不得资料和旅游手册上有出入……咳咳，当然了，这种小事，我早就知道了！

Kanjira: Heh heh.
坎吉拉：噗——咳。

Matilda: Hmm? What are you laughing at?
玛蒂尔达：嗯？你笑什么？

Kanjira: No, no, no, my dear guest, it's just sneeze.
坎吉拉：不不，客人，我只是打了个喷嚏……

Kanjira: Well, you see, I just make a living here. I'm short and thin, can't compare with adults.
坎吉拉：您看，只是想赚点小钱，您瞧我这样小的个子，就算有经验，也根本抢不过那些大人……

She tilts her head slightly—the angle is so perfect that it seems to be a result of countless practices—and sheds tears naturally.
她微微偏头，那角度像是精心设计过一般，恰到好处地泫然欲泣着。

Kanjira: And you is so great. You will not let I, weak poor kid, get hungry for no money, will you?
坎吉拉：您这样厉害的人，也不会忍心看我这种幼小又脆弱的孩子因为赚不到钱而饿肚子吧——

Matilda: Err. Even if you look at me with those puppy eyes ...
玛蒂尔达：呃唔……你，你就算这样看着我——

Kanjira: First sight I know, you is a lady with great taste, just like a sand cat, brave and smart.
坎吉拉：而且，您是有眼光的，我一眼就瞧得出——您就像只聪明又勇敢的沙漠猫……

Kanjira's downcast green eyes subtly steal a covert glance up at Matilda, secretly reading the signs on her face.
垂下去的绿色眼眸微不可察地抬了抬，时刻观察着对面女孩的神情变化。

Matilda: Sand, sand cat? It does sound like a smart animal.
玛蒂尔达：沙，沙漠猫？听起来好像很聪明的——

Kanjira: Anyways, you is lucky to meet me, my lady!
坎吉拉：哎呀，遇到我，算是客人您的好运气～

Kanjira waves her hands as if she has made a big decision.
她一边说着，一边像是下了很大决心似的摆了摆手。

Kanjira: Well, well, for a great customer like you, I can only suffer some loss! Just 200 rupees, and I'll show you the shrine and the whole Mor Pankh village! With a special Dīpa Festival tour on the house!
坎吉拉：我这次为了您这样的好顾客，只能吃大亏了！只要二百卢比，不光是神庙，我带您玩儿遍整个摩卢旁卡村～还附赠烛星节特殊观景点！

Kanjira: Want me to recommend a hotel? I know good hotels, too.
坎吉拉：——或许您还需要介绍旅店吗？那些我也很熟……

Kanjira: Yes or no, my dear guest? My most great guest? Please ...
坎吉拉：怎么样，客人？厉害的客人？您就帮帮我——

Matilda: Fine, fine. I will allow you to be my temporary assistant, for your life has been so sad already.
玛蒂尔达：好啦好啦……哼，看在你这么可怜的份儿上，就暂且允许你做我的帮手……

Kanjira: Yay! Let's go treasure hunting, hmm, sightseeing!
坎吉拉：哦！太好了，那客人我们赶紧出发寻宝——咳呃！观光吧！

Matilda: Excellent. Have you arranged a shuttle bus for the travel?
玛蒂尔达：很好，那你有安排好接应的旅游巴士吗？

Kanjira: Heh heh, I have something gooder than bus for you!
坎吉拉：哼哼——客人，我这儿有比巴士更为灵活的东西～

Kanjira puts on a mysterious smile on her stained face.
女孩带点脏污的小脸上露出了神秘的微笑。

Kanjira: And I promise you, quick like flash!
坎吉拉：保证能让您体验——绝佳的速度！

3#1
3#1

寻宝新骑兵
The Young Indiana Jones JMP-03

Kanjira: Woo-hoo! Alright, sit tight!
坎吉拉：哈哈！好嘞，坐稳了——！

Kanjira: Let's GO!!
坎吉拉：出发吧！

Matilda: Waaaaah?!
玛蒂尔达：哇啊啊——?!

Villager 1: *coughs* You little j**k again! D**n it, Sinha, for one last time, don't borrow that annoying human thing to her!
村民：咳咳……又是你这个崽子！该死的，我都说了多少次了……辛哈怎么总是把这种惹人烦的人类玩意儿借给你！

The bright-yellow tuk tuk drifts in a beautiful arc on the soft road, the brown sand kicked up in the air covering up the curses of the passer-by.
明黄色的电动三轮在松软的路面上甩出一道优美的弧线，把路人的咒骂声遮掩在了黄灰色的沙砾里。

Matilda: Slow down, slow down! We are going too fast!
玛蒂尔达：好快，好快，太快了啊！

Matilda: Waaaah! Is this thing really under control?!
玛蒂尔达：呜哇哇哇！这是怎么回事啊——?!

Kanjira: Hey!
坎吉拉：嘿！

As the tuk tuk roars along, the marigold petals are flying wildly in the wind.
三轮顶上的万寿菊挂饰在风尘中扬起花瓣。

Kanjira: Not yet best part! Hold that bar tight!
坎吉拉：这才是刚开始呢！抓紧那根棍子——!!

Matilda: Waaah ...
玛蒂尔达：哇，哇啊啊啊——

Street
街道

Matilda: Whuu ... phew ...
玛蒂尔达： 呼……呼……

Kanjira: Woo-hoo! How you feel, my guest?
坎吉拉： 呜呼！客人，感觉如何啊?

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达： ……

Matilda: *vomits*
玛蒂尔达： 呕……

Kanjira: Oh, I'm sorry. You must not be used to this. Here, use it.
坎吉拉： 噢，真是抱歉，看来您还不太习惯这个。来，用这个擦擦……

As Kanjira passes over the hem of her skirt, Matilda takes out a handkerchief from her pocket in silence.
玛蒂尔达抬眼看着对方递来了自己的裙角，默默地掏出了自己口袋里的手帕。

Kanjira: If you want your silk dirty. Fine, you look very decent after all.
坎吉拉： 如果您更愿意弄脏丝绸的话……那好吧！毕竟客人您看起来挺讲究的……

Kanjira: And, here it is.
坎吉拉： 喏——就是这儿了。

The shrine is apparently an old one, judging by the worn bricks. The smell of sticky spices in the air is almost suffocating.
寺庙的石砖斑驳，显然是有了一定的年头，空气中的香料味湿润黏稠，几乎封住了呼吸。

Matilda: What's this smell? Is it ... *coughs*
玛蒂尔达： 这味道，怎么这么……咳咳……

Kanjira: Smell of full white musk and sanders, calming palo santo and cinnamon. Hah! You feel your chakra open?
坎吉拉： 饱满的白麝香与檀香，凝神静气的圣木与肉桂——唔，有没有感觉脉轮都打开啦?

Kanjira: But, I can also smell, hmm, a lot of mango. That smells good.
坎吉拉： 但我更在意的是——嗯……闻起来有很多芒果……真香啊。

Kanjira glances at the stone wall to measure its height and then nods.
坎吉拉大致扫了下石墙的高度，点了点头。

Kanjira: Okay. Jump over this wall, and we are in!
坎吉拉： 很好……从这儿翻进去就可以了！

Matilda: Jump over it?! I thought there is at least a hidden side door!
玛蒂尔达： 翻进去?！我以为至少会有个隐蔽的旁门！

Kanjira: To see the closed cave, you must pay a price!
坎吉拉： 想要看到不开放的石窟，总要付出点代价嘛！

Matilda: Ah. So this is your "local connections"!
玛蒂尔达： 好啊，原来这就是你嘴里的“人脉”?

Kanjira: Um. Well, that mean tuk tuk, my guest! No tuk tuk this village is faster than that! Uncle Sinha is not so nice and lend me if I don't give him my lunch money!
坎吉拉： 嗯……哦～那是三轮车的部分，客人！这个村的电三轮再没第二辆这么快的了。辛哈大叔的那份和善可是用我牙缝中省出来的好处交换的～

Kanjira: My route don't need entrance ticket! Shouldn't you give me credit?
坎吉拉： 这还能省下一笔门票钱呢，客人您该夸赞我的路线绝佳才对！

Even if she is busted, Kanjira is not embarrassed at all. On the contrary, she looks a bit proud. She puts her hands together to form a temporary "stepping stone."
黑发女孩毫无被拆穿的尴尬，甚至神色里还多了几分得意。她伸出双手，组合成了一个方便蹬踏的台阶。

Kanjira: Now come! Although I think you don't like this "rude" behavi- ...
坎吉拉：来吧，我想您可能不太习惯这些“粗鲁”的行……

Matilda: Humph!
玛蒂尔达：哼！

Ignoring the "stepping stone," Matilda raises her arms and jumps up the wall deftly.
无视了那个“台阶”，玛蒂尔达径自伸直双臂，轻巧一跃。

Kanjira: Hmm?
坎吉拉：嗯？

Matilda: I was thoughtful and considerate enough not to wipe my nose on your skirt, yet you repay my kindness with contempt. Climbing over a wall of this height is really a piece of cake!
玛蒂尔达：我不拿你的裙角擦鼻子可是为了你好，你竟敢小瞧我……这种高度对我来说，根本就是小菜一碟！

Matilda: So? Do you need a hand getting up here?
玛蒂尔达：怎么样？要不要我拉你一把？

Matilda looks down proudly from the top of the wall.
金发女孩骑在墙头，得意洋洋地看着下面。

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Kanjira: Huh! Weirdo.
坎吉拉：嘿！奇怪的家伙。

Mor Pankh Shrine
摩卢旁卡神庙

The shrine is shrouded in thick smoke and packed with pious believers, resembling a legged cloud with the smell of spices.
神庙内被浓厚的烟雾笼罩着，虔诚的信众穿梭其中。远远望去，烟雾变成了一群长了腿，富有着香料香气的云。

The two small figures sneak into the shadow in the corner while avoiding the believers in their way.
而两个小小的身影左右闪躲，鬼鬼祟祟地潜入了墙角的阴影之中。

Matilda: I don't know what this skulking was for! You'd better not be lying!
玛蒂尔达：真不知道为什么要这么偷偷摸摸的！你别是什么骗……

Kanjira: Nom nom.
坎吉拉：嚼嚼……

Matilda: Hey, what's that in your hand?!
玛蒂尔达：喂，你手里……?!

Kanjira: You want a bite? The prayers are so pious, so don't worry, the fruits is tasty! Nom nom, like I expect, so sweet.
坎吉拉：您也想来一口？过来祈福的家伙虔诚得很，带过来的果子不会差的……唔，和我猜的一样！这芒果真甜……

Matilda: When did you ... Did you take it from the offerings?!
玛蒂尔达：你什么时候——你怎么能随便拿别人的贡品！

Kanjira: Don't mind! Manka, come back.
坎吉拉：不用在意这些小事情！曼咔，回来。

A little black snake creeps up her arm quietly.
黑色的小蛇悄悄游上她的手臂。

Kanjira: By the way, I hope you is not afraid of snakes. I'm a special kind.
坎吉拉：顺便一提，希望您不害怕蛇——我和别人比，稍微有些特殊……

Matilda: And I'm curious about what exactly you are referring to. Specially rude, or specially annoying?
玛蒂尔达：你指什么？哼，是指特别的粗鲁，还是特别地令我恼火？

Kanjira: Why so angr- ... I mean, um, I'm arcanist. Hope I don't scare you. Relax, I'm not like others.
坎吉拉：咦，您这就恼火——我是指，咳咳，我是一名……神秘学家。希望您不会被我吓得跑掉，放心，我属于里面比较……

Matilda: Are you serious? Can't you tell I'm also an excellent, one of the best, arcanist?
玛蒂尔达：你在开玩笑吗？你看不出我也是一名优秀的——最优秀的那种——神秘学家？

Matilda jumps up with a jerk out of excitement, but then she notices the crowds and has to crouch down again very quickly.
玛蒂尔达激动地弹跳了一下，注意到人群，又不得不迅速蹲下身子。

Matilda: So you were lying to me! Spoke about all those good virtues you can see in me.
玛蒂尔达：你果然是骗子！还说什么眼光好，看得出我的……

Kanjira: Hey! It's not my fault! You doesn't look like one!
坎吉拉：嘿，这不怪我，您一点儿也不像！

Kanjira drops the mango core and scans Matilda in slight surprise.
坎吉拉抛掉手中的芒果核，略带惊讶地将玛蒂尔达上下打量了一番。

Kanjira: I thought all arcanists except me are like ...
坎吉拉：我以为，除了我之外的所有神秘学家都会像……

Matilda: Like what?
玛蒂尔达：像什么？

Kanjira: Like the villagers, those old mans, yell when they see humans, like annoying monkeys or crowing chickens. They even drive humans away, don't care they is here to help.
坎吉拉：……像这里的村民，一些迂腐的老头子和大叔，见到人类总是大呼小叫，像是看到了讨人厌的猴子或是尖叫的鸡，甚至会把来帮助他们的人类赶出他们的地盘——

Kanjira: Why you think only the train station is tidy and clean? Humans in other places is all drive away!
坎吉拉：不然您以为，为什么只有那个火车站光洁如新？其他地方的人类，早被他们赶走啦！

Kanjira: I'm not like them because ... Anyways, I never thought there is more arcanist like me.
坎吉拉：我是因为……算了，总之，我从未想过除我以外还有……

Kanjira speaks in a quiet voice. A confused look appears on her face.
女孩儿的声音逐渐放轻，脸上出现了一丝不解。

Matilda: Humph, if you ask me, I'd say you read too little and know too little.
玛蒂尔达：哼，要我说，你只是读的书太少，见识不够多罢了！

Matilda: I suggest you follow my example and adopt the style of a real arcanist.
玛蒂尔达：建议你跟着我好好学学，学习一下真正的神秘学家应有的姿态……

Kanjira: Fine, fine! Oh, Manka say there is just a few people outside, so up your head, stay confident, and walk out like we paid!
坎吉拉：哦哦，说得没错！曼咔说外面人不多！很好，挺胸抬头，就像咱们交了钱一样地走过去！

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: Have you been listening or not?!
玛蒂尔达：……你到底有没有在听我说话啊！

North Cave
北窟

Following Kanjira, Matilda goes through the smoke and arrives at the entrance to the cave.
云雾缭绕之中，玛蒂尔达跟随着坎吉拉来到石窟口。

Kanjira: Ha! Nice. Nobody around as usual!
坎吉拉：很好，很好……像以往一样，一个人都没有！

Kanjira: But I still suggest you be careful, since ... Hmm, I understand the damage when digging. Just don't involve me if you must break something!
坎吉拉：不过还是建议您小心行事，鉴于……嗯，挖掘总是要破坏点什么的——总之一定要破坏的话，别和我扯上关系就行！

Matilda looks up, not hearing a word of her mutter.
玛蒂尔达抬头望去，全然没听进去女孩细碎的话语。

Matilda: So this is "the Head of Vindre"?
玛蒂尔达：这就是……“毗因陀之首”吗……

The top of the cave looks like a black hole. No one knows where it will lead or what it will devour.
石窟的顶部像一口黑洞，不知延伸向何处，也不知会吞没什么。

Kanjira: Tsk tsk, dark and scary. But this is what must go through on the way to treasure, just like you must say "Open Sesame," right?
坎吉拉：啧啧啧，黑黝黝的，看着真吓人。但这就是寻宝的必经之路，就像那句“芝麻开门”一样！不是吗?

Matilda: I really don't know what to make of this "treasure" you've been mumbling about. I hope you didn't get the wrong idea.
玛蒂尔达：真不懂你一直嘟囔的寻宝究竟是什么……你不会是误会了什么吧?

Kanjira: Ah. I see what you mean here. Relax. I will zip my lips and tell no one.
坎吉拉：啊——您的意思，我很明白！放心，守口如瓶，我绝对不会说出去的。

She zips her mouth shut and nods sincerely.
她在嘴巴旁做了一个关上拉链的手势，真挚地点了点头。

Kanjira: I'll just stay here, then. Everything good luck!
坎吉拉：那么，我就不进去了，祝您一切顺利！

Matilda: Ah? Anyway, despite all the strange things you've been talking about along the way, you have successfully taken me here as promised. I guess here is where we part! Thank you.
玛蒂尔达：嗯？虽然你总在嘟囔着些奇怪的东西，但终归是把我带到了目的地……那就这样吧！多谢你啦。

After bidding her goodbye, Matilda turns around to walk toward the cave while browsing the documents in her hand.
玛蒂尔达摆摆手，一边翻开着资料，一边转身向石窟内走去。

Soon she is devoured by the bottomless darkness.
很快，那片深不见底的黑暗便隐去了她的身影。

Kanjira: Sincerest wishes to you, my brave guest! Whether a giant snake or dragon, as long as you find the legendary treasure, we'll meet again! Hee hee.
坎吉拉：衷心地祝福您，勇敢的客人！不论是巨蛇还是巨龙，如果您真找到了传说中的宝藏，我们就一定还会再见面的～嘿嘿～

Footsteps echo inside the cave like a piece of poorly composed percussion music.
脚步声层层回荡在窟内，仿佛一首音律不齐的打击乐。

Matilda: This mural seems to be related to that myth! Here, on this paper! Let me see.
玛蒂尔达：这个壁画……看起来真的和那个神话有关系！资料在……这儿！让我看看……

There is a huge mural carved on the wall, spreading to the end of her sight.
在视线所能达到的尽头，巨大的浮雕壁画赫然其上。

She turns the pages of the notebook quickly.
女孩快速地翻动着笔记的纸页。

Matilda: Found it! *"Before the Serpent struck in night sky, the stone house of Asura rose to the north of the Head of Vindre."*
玛蒂尔达：找到了！……“彗首降世之初，毗因陀之首以北有石生长……”

Matilda: *"The master of the stone has acted, with countless feet, with countless eyes, to trip, to pry, in bringing the blessed house of men to rest."*
玛蒂尔达：“石之子，处处生足，处处生目，并阿修罗之相，使致人之子庇佑之处倾塌……”

Matilda: Wow, impressive! Perhaps this is the origin of some arcane creature.
玛蒂尔达：哇……真厉害，说不定这就是某种神秘动物的起源……

Matilda: "The Serpent struck," that is to say, the best time to practice on the celestial energy is when the comet goes across the sky?
玛蒂尔达：“彗首”……也就是说……天体能量的最佳修习时间，是要等到流星降落的时刻?

Matilda: *"Long darkness reaches the men as the Serpent's tail reveals itself. Some are sent down the great slopes and never return ..."*
玛蒂尔达：“继而彗发临地，人子没入虚妄域，因欲而堕……”

Matilda: *"... for desire is the infallible devourer. "*
玛蒂尔达：“……因妄念而不可回。”

Matilda: Desire, hmm, I should meditate before practice.
玛蒂尔达：妄念啊……嗯，感觉在修习前还是得先进行冥想才好……

Matilda: *"The circle of everything ends at the tip of the great tail, all ..."*
玛蒂尔达：“万物终于彗尾，皆……”

THUD!
“咚!”

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……!

The echo has disappeared.
回响消失了。

Behind her, there is nothing but boundless darkness.
身后，只有无尽的黑暗。

Matilda: Did I hear it wrong?
玛蒂尔达：是我听错了吗——

Matilda: No ...
玛蒂尔达：……！是真的有声音。

Matilda: Come into the light! Who, who is there?
玛蒂尔达：出来！是谁！

Her voice ripples out. Its echoes and the echoes of the echoes reverberate between the walls of the cave.
声音在石窟中仍只是被荡了一层又一层。

There is no response.
无人应答。

Matilda: This doesn't seem right.
玛蒂尔达：……不对。

Matilda: Was this statue posing like this earlier?
玛蒂尔达：这个雕像，刚刚是这个姿势吗?

While Matilda is still wondering, the statues in her sights start to move.
就在玛蒂尔达犹疑的时候，视线中的石像动了起来。

Matilda: Aah!
玛蒂尔达：呀！

The benevolent-looking statues, which were sitting in lotus position, are now struggling in a twisted way to break free from the wall.
那些或作佛观，或盘踞而坐的石像扭曲着，挣扎着，自墙壁上探身而出。

Matilda: Not good! Time to retreat.
玛蒂尔达：不好！赶紧离开这里……

She turns around immediately and runs toward the exit, yet the ground is pulling her back like a rolling carpet.
玛蒂尔达试图转身向外跑去，地板却如同正在被收起的地毯一般迅速后撤。

Matilda: What?! Aah!
玛蒂尔达：什——呜啊！好痛！

She can feel her chin hitting hard against the rock.
她感觉自己的下巴狠狠地在岩石上磕了一下。

One arm, two, three, and more of them are growing out from both sides of the statues, each with a glossy eyeball embedded within.
一只手臂，两只手臂，更多的手臂自石像两侧分裂开来，每一只掌心内都嵌着一颗明润的眼珠。

Matilda: What? What is this!
玛蒂尔达：这是……这是什……

Following the slight noise, every eye turns to the girl lying on the ground.
细微的响动，让每一道视线都集中到了仰倒在地面的女孩身上。

Matilda: Oh! Hurry up. Get yourself together! Think what you have learned and practiced in the past!
玛蒂尔达：呜，呜……快点，振作起来！要把平时所学的东西，全，全都用上……！

3#3
3#3

交织线
Intersecting Lines JMP-04

Matilda: Aah, ouch, it hurts!
玛蒂尔达：哈……哈……痛……好痛……！

Matilda: How ... how come there are so many of them!
玛蒂尔达：怎么……怎么会有这么多的石像……！

Like overgrown grass, more and more statues are coming out of the walls, no matter how many Matilda destroys.
暗黄色的石雕如同野草，仿佛有着无尽的生命力，倒下一个，就有更多新的自各处诞生而来。

Matilda lies against the sharp gravel on the ground. She covers her waist and gasps in pain.
布满尖碎石子的地上，玛蒂尔达捂着自己的腰间吃痛地喘息。

Matilda: Not good, not good. Think, Matilda.
玛蒂尔达：不行，不行……得赶紧想想办法……

Blood is running out from between her fingers unstoppably, taking away her vitality like a water pump does.
鲜血像是止不住一般自指缝间涌出，生命力似乎与血液一起从躯体中被抽离了出去。

The statue in front of her raises the umbrella in its hand.
面前的石雕高高举起了手中宝伞。

Matilda: No, don't ...!
玛蒂尔达：不，不可以……！

Her hands drenched in blood, she can no longer hold the orb.
女孩的双手被血液浸润，几乎握不住手中的水晶球。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Get on your feet!
伽菈波那：站起来！

Matilda: Hmm?
玛蒂尔达：嗯?

The moment she hears the strange voice, Matilda regains strength in her limbs.
无力的四肢突然在瞬间充满了力量。

Matilda: Aah!
玛蒂尔达：啊！

She can't help but bounce up like a puppet controlled by some invisible threads.
玛蒂尔达整个人如提线木偶一般不受控制地向上弹起。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Well done, little diviner.
伽菈波那：做得好……小占卜师。

Kaalaa Baunaa: &
伽菈波那：&

Matilda: My legs, they heal themselves. Where are the wounds?
玛蒂尔达：腿怎么自己……血和伤口……消失了?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Close your eyes. Don't look at anything.
伽菈波那：闭上眼睛，什么都不要看。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The illusions would destroy your will.
伽菈波那：幻觉会摧毁你的意志。

Matilda: Wait. That, that was ...
玛蒂尔达：什么？刚才的居然是……

Kaalaa Baunaa: %
伽菈波那：%

Matilda: *pants*
玛蒂尔达：哈……哈……

Silence and cold fall again, as if nothing has happened.
石窟内恢复了最初的阴冷黑暗，仿佛什么都没发生过一般。

Matilda looks down at her legs, slapping them to check if she's dreaming.
玛蒂尔达低头反复确认着自己的双腿，将大腿拍得啪啪作响。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

However, they are smooth, nimble, and healthy. There are no signs of injury on her skin other than the light red marks from the slaps.
然而，它们光滑，灵巧，无比健康——除了被拍打出来的轻微的红印，不曾受过任何伤害。

Matilda: How come ...? Is it some kind of hallucinating arcane skill?
玛蒂尔达：为什么会这样……难道那是某种致幻的神秘术?

Matilda: You are the lady from the train station.
玛蒂尔达：你，你是车站里的那个……

She looks at the lady in confusion.
她抬头，看向一旁伫立的女人。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Looks like part of our destinies are now tied together, kid.
伽菈波那：看来我们有一部分命运纠缠在了一起，孩子。

Kaalaa Baunaa responds to her with a reassuring smile.
伽菈波那轻轻地露出一个安抚性的微笑。

Kaalaa Baunaa: What are you doing here? I don't think this place is open to tourists.
伽菈波那：你怎么会来这样的地方？这里应当不会对游客开放……

Matilda: I ...
玛蒂尔达：我……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……!

Something is churning imperceptibly in the dark.
石窟深处的黑暗微不可察地扭曲着。

Matilda: They are coming again!
玛蒂尔达：它们……又出现了!

Matilda: Is it another illusion?
玛蒂尔达：这次也是幻觉吗?

Hands, hands, and more hands. The familiar dark-yellow statues are like newly hatched creatures, slimy and ugly. They are trying hard to break the shell of darkness.
手，手，和更多的手。熟悉的暗黄色雕像像是某种刚冲破卵壳的新生之物，黏着撕扯着自黑暗中剥离出来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: No, they are not.
伽菈波那：不，不对。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Please, stay behind me.
伽菈波那：……请站到我身后来。

Kaalaa Baunaa sounds a bit confused.
女人的声音里带着一丝困惑。

Kaalaa Baunaa: They look ... real?
伽菈波那：它们看上去……是实体……？

Matilda: Careful! Watch out! They are coming again! Move!
玛蒂尔达：——小心，它们过来了！快躲开！

Kaalaa Baunaa: *coughs* Are you alright?
伽菈波那：咳咳，你没事吧？

Hiding behind the rock, Kaalaa Baunaa carefully brushes away Matilda's milky blonde hair to find a wound.
伽菈波那拉着女孩掩藏在岩石后方，她的手指小心翼翼地拨开金色的头发，一道伤口裸露了出来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Not illusions this time.
伽菈波那：……这不再是幻觉了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Too bad. D**n it! How did Kumar do this!
伽菈波那：这下糟了。可恶！库玛尔是怎么做到的……

Matilda: Aarh! The pain ... What is happening now? I was only here for ...
玛蒂尔达：呜——！好痛……这一切都是怎么回事？我只是来……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Sorry, but it's not the time for explaining.
伽菈波那：抱歉，但现在不是解释的时候。

Kaalaa Baunaa: We are at the exit soon. Remember, leave this village as soon as possible after you're out. Do not ...
伽菈波那：你看，我们就快到出口了，你记住，出去之后尽快离开，离开这个村子，不要再……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：——！

Before she finishes the words, Kaalaa Baunaa seems to have sensed danger and immediately rolls to the side while covering Matilda's head.
话音未落，她如同感应到了什么，护住女孩的头部迅速地向侧方滚去。

Huge rocks fall to the ground. The rock they hid behind is now a pile of powder.
巨大的岩石落下，用以躲藏的岩石应声化为了一摊齑粉。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

The cave shakes under the strikes of the statues.
石窟在石像的攻击下颤抖着。

Matilda: Um.
玛蒂尔达：呜……

???: Hey!
???：嘿——

They hear a strange voice.
陌生的声音自身旁擦过。

???: Watch your head!
???：——当心头顶！

Kaalaa Baunaa seems quite nervous; her arms are holding Matilda even more tightly.
玛蒂尔达感觉环着她的怀抱紧张似的收紧了一些。

A familiar figure leaps onto the statue's shoulder and raises his fist.
略微眼熟的身影轻巧地攀上石像高处，挥出了拳头。

???: Hah!
???: ——嗬！

The left half of the statue's face flies across the cave.
石像的左脸飞了出去。

???: Huh, harder than I thought! Dad hadn't told me those statues could move.
???: 啊哈，还挺结实！原来这石像还会自己动……老爹可没告诉过我这个。

???: Again!
???: 再来——！

The giant statue breaks into pieces under his fist and falls to the ground.
被男人击碎的巨大石像崩落开来，无数大块的碎石坠向地面。

???: Whoa! That's dangerous!
???: 喔！这也太危险了——

???: Sorry. Though you have a very impressive appearance as a statue, your attitude and manner are problematic.
???: 唔——！抱歉啦，虽然你们看着很酷，但你们也太不友善了……

???: Hah!
???: ……哈！

Matilda: Waah!!
玛蒂尔达: 哇哇！

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那: ……

Kaalaa Baunaa grips Matilda's sleeve gently, pulling her one step to the side.
伽菈波那轻轻拉住玛蒂尔达，向右前方挪了下步子。

The next moment, the falling rocks graze their hair and smash into the ground.
——紧接着，碎石擦着她们的发梢，狠狠地砸向了她们前一秒驻足的地方。

Matilda: Ugh!
玛蒂尔达: ……呜！

The cave goes quiet again.
石窟内终于回归了安静。

The debris of the statue piles up in front of them.
被击落的石像碎片形成了一座小丘。

???: Hah-ah!
???: 唔呃——嘿！

A huge rock is cast aside. The man emerges from the ruins, patting the dust off his broad shoulders.
眼前的大块岩石被丢到一边，男人从碎石里探出头来，扑落着肩膀上的尘土。

???: Phew! I almost got killed.
???: 呼——！压死我了……

???: Hey, you guys alright? These things are freaky!
???: 嘿！你们没事吧，这些东西真是太吓人了！

As he speaks, he waddles down from the huge pile of rocks and walks toward Matilda.
他摇摇晃晃地从石堆上滑下来，向着玛蒂尔达她们的方向靠近。

???: So, do you know where they came from? My head almost got smashed when I reached the entrance.
???: 不过……或许你们知道这些东西是从哪儿来的吗？我刚走到门口就差点被它们敲碎脑壳……

He walks at a slow pace, but he keeps his tongue busy.
男人的动作不算快，但嘴上却一刻都没有歇着。

???: Hmm, it's been 11 or maybe 12 years since I left this place. I'm welcomed by these things as soon as I'm back. What a surprise, huh?
???: 唔，我有十一……或者是十二年没回这儿了？刚回来就遇到这个，真是个惊喜，是吧?

Matilda: ...?
玛蒂尔达: ……?

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那: ……

Matilda: Is he talking to us?
玛蒂尔达: 他在和我们说话吗……?

The man walks over to Matilda. His eyebrows are drawn together in bewilderment.
男人在玛蒂尔达眼前站定，突然微微皱起眉头。

???: Mmm. Wait.
???: 哎……等等。

But quickly, his face brightens up.
那团眉毛迅速地松开，高高扬起。

???: Aren't you the little one from the train station? I helped get your stuff back, remember me?
???: 你不是那个在车站被人偷了东西的小家伙嘛！还记得我吗?

The man quickly wipes his face, hoping that Matilda can see him more clearly.
男人胡乱抹了一把自己的脸，试图让玛蒂尔达看得更清楚些。

Matilda: Huh? Oh!
玛蒂尔达: 噢……哦……!

The tall figure takes her back to the train station.
玛蒂尔达想起了那个在火车站的巨大身影。

Matilda: It's you, the man bitten by the thief!
玛蒂尔达: 是你……！被那个扒手咬了一口的大叔!

???: Yeah, that's me. That was one merciless bite.
???: 噢，没错，那一口咬得非常实在……

He cracks a smile.
他咧开一个笑容。

???: Ha! What a happy coincidence! Well, maybe this is not the best place for a reunion, but the occasion is not for us to decide.
???: 真是令人惊喜的巧合——虽然这环境有点尴尬，但咱们没得挑……

Shamane: Oh, I should introduce myself this time. The name is Shamane. Sorry, I wasn't much of a helping hand earlier and let that kid get away. But this time, I have made it up to you, eh? Eh?
鬃毛沙砾: 哦，自我介绍一下，我叫鬃毛沙砾，虽然之前没帮成你，让那个小崽子跑没影了……但看来这次还挺成功的!

Matilda: Oh, emm.
玛蒂尔达：哦，呃……

Matilda casts a hesitant glance at the ruins.
玛蒂尔达心有余悸地瞟了一眼脚边的碎石。

Matilda: You have made it up, I guess?
玛蒂尔达：……或许算成功……吧?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Sorry to interrupt you.
伽菈波那：抱歉……

Kaalaa Baunaa raises a hand and interrupts them.
站在一旁的女人微微抬手，打断了二人的谈话。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But I think this place is safe only for now. It'd be a wise choice to leave as soon as possible.
伽菈波那：我想目前这里的安全或许只是暂时的，尽快离开这个地方应当是更稳妥的选择。

She speaks a bit faster.
她的语速比原来快了一些。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And I mean more than this cave. Actually, are you tourists? I'm hoping you can leave this village in a couple of days.
伽菈波那：不，不仅是指离开这个石窟，实际上……你们似乎是这里的游客？我更希望你们可以在这几天离开这个村子……

Matilda: Hmm?
玛蒂尔达：嗯?

Kaalaa Baunaa: I know this sounds weird, but you need to trust me.
伽菈波那：我知道这有些奇怪，但请你们先相信我——

She reaches inside the pocket of her coat and tries to take out a stack of files.
她略带匆忙地将手探入风衣的口袋，试图拽出一叠文件。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Huh? D**n, where's my ID? Ah!
伽菈波那：嗯？该死，我的证件去哪儿了——啊！

Her finger slips, and the files litter the floor.
手指一滑，文件散落一地。

Shamane: Whoa, whoa, whoa. Easy, lady. Take your time. We're listening.
鬃毛沙砾：哦，哇哦，哦……不急，女士，不急……慢慢来，我们在听。

Shamane hunkers next to her, helping her pick up the files.
鬃毛沙砾也跟着弯下身来，帮助对方将那些纸张重新规整到一处。

Shamane: Oh, here's your ID! Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa? Hold it.
鬃毛沙砾：啊，你的证件在这儿！伽菈——波那小姐？拿好了……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Ah, thank you.
伽菈波那：谢谢……

Kaalaa Baunaa reaches for the card, but he doesn't loosen his hand.
伽菈波那伸手去接，意外的是，对方却没放松手上的力道。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...?
伽菈波那：……?

Shamane points at her waist with a shocked look on his face.
鬃毛沙砾一脸不可思议，抬手指着女人的腰间。

She follows his gaze and looks down. A pair of tortoiseshell spectacles hangs on her belt, one temple broken.
她顺着目光看过去，断了一只镜腿的玳瑁色眼镜正如往常一样挂在那里。

Shamane: This is ... No, I can't be wrong.
鬃毛沙砾：这是……我绝对没认错……

Shamane: How come you have Kumar's stuff on your belt?
鬃毛沙砾：库玛尔的东西怎么会挂在你身上?

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……!

Without conscious thought, she tightens her grasp on her ID.
她下意识地捏紧了证件。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You ... You know Kumar?
伽菈波那：你——你认识库玛尔……?

Matilda: Hmm? Kumar? Who's that?
玛蒂尔达：嗯？库玛尔？谁……?

Matilda returns to their side with the files she found nearby.
玛蒂尔达将滑到远处的文件拾了回来。

Matilda: And what's with the shock? I thought we need to leave now.
玛蒂尔达：而且你们俩怎么停下了……不是说要先离开这里吗?

She mumbles in confusion and picks up the last piece of paper on the ground.
她困惑地嘟囔着，自顾自地拾起地上的最后一张纸片。

Matilda: Okay, that's the last one! Let me see, Page 1, Page 2 ...
玛蒂尔达：好的，一个也没落下！我看看，这边是第一页，第二页……

As she speaks, the files are flattened, moved around, and rearranged.
纸张被展平，颠倒，翻动，快速地回归到自己本来的位置。

Matilda: Page 5, hmm?
玛蒂尔达：第五……嗯?

She stops at a page with familiar content.
熟悉的内容让翻动的动作停滞了。

Matilda: What?
玛蒂尔达：哦……?

It is a data analysis chart. Some notes, hastily written in graceful handwriting, are left next to it. Some words are even highlighted with question marks.
那是一张数据分析图，周围的字迹娟秀，却显得有些匆忙混乱，甚至有些字眼的旁边还被打上了问号。

Matilda: These papers are on celestial energy and exactly the one I want to practice on!
玛蒂尔达：这是有关彗星能量的……这不就是我想修习的那个吗?!

Matilda: That's right. The analysis on the arcane energy is very similar to that in the materials I found.
玛蒂尔达：嗯嗯，没错，这部分的神秘学能量分析和我查到的几乎一致……

Matilda: But not completely. This one looks ...
玛蒂尔达：可它看上去……

The black curves in the chart make her stomach sink.
统计图里黑色的曲线形成了一个令人不安的陡峭的趋势。

Her gaze slides down the page and fixes on a word with a question mark next to it.
玛蒂尔达的目光飞速地下滑，直到页脚处的最后一个标注了问号的单词。

Matilda: Ah! Manus Vindictae?
玛蒂尔达：……“重塑之手”?

Matilda: What?!
玛蒂尔达：什么……?!

3#4
3#4

继承者
The Heir JMP-05

Kanjira: Burp. What a good meal.
坎吉拉：嗝，吃得真饱……♪～

Kanjira: Hmm? Still nothing happened after so long? She won't really be eaten by some monster, right?
坎吉拉：嗯？怎么里面还是一点儿动静都没有？那家伙不会……真的被什么怪东西吃掉了吧?

Kanjira: Hmm. Forget it!
坎吉拉：唔……呃……算啦！

Kanjira: Lord whoever, bless that stupid moron has escaped from there. Oh, and without the treasures!
坎吉拉：随便什么神，保佑那个傲慢的笨蛋已经顺利逃跑了——哦，并且没带走宝贝！

Kanjira wipes her mouth with the hem of her skirt and steps into the cave.
坎吉拉用裙角擦了擦嘴，朝石窟里迈进。

Kanjira: Be careful. Don't be spotted. Oh?
坎吉拉：悄悄地，悄悄地……哦?

Kanjira: Huh! She's fine. What is she doing in the depths? Who are those two?
坎吉拉：啊！那家伙还好好的——他们怎么在那么里面……而且还多了两个人?

She quietly climbs on a rock nearby.
她轻巧地爬上一块岩石。

Kanjira: Oomph. Mmm!
坎吉拉：唔……嗯——！

Kanjira: I didn't know there were so many rocks here. Okay. Keep climbing, almost there.
坎吉拉：这里怎么多了那么多石头……啊……差一点点就能爬——上——去——

She kicks her dusty feet in the air, struggling to climb onto a raised edge of the rock.
脏脏的脚丫努力地向上够着，试图攀上岩石上那个恰好的凸起。

Kanjira: Huh?
坎吉拉：呜……?

Something grabs her ankle.
有东西抓住了她的脚踝。

Kanjira: What is it?
坎吉拉：什么东……

She frowns and looks down ...
她皱着眉将目光下移——

It is a severed hand.
那是一只断手。

Kanjira: AHHH!!
坎吉拉：啊——!!

Impulsively, Kanjira kicks her leg.
坎吉拉条件反射般猛地将腿踢了出去。

The hand, already covered with many cracks, is thrown into the air and smashes into pieces on the ground.
原本就布满裂痕的断手被甩向半空，在落地的时刻应声而碎，再没有了动静。

Kanjira: Whuu ... phew ...
坎吉拉：呼……呼……

Is that a hand? Whose hand is it? Where does it come from?
那是什么？谁的手？这里为什么会有手？

Her heart beats violently.
女孩的心脏砰砰地跳着。

She holds her breath and gathers enough courage to look closer.
她屏住呼吸，大着胆子凑到那些碎片前面去瞧。

Kanjira: It's stone?
坎吉拉：……石头？

She tentatively touches a lump with her fingertip. Nothing happens. Feeling relieved, she starts putting them back together.
犹豫再三，坎吉拉伸手试探性地触碰了一下石块，随即手脚麻利地将它们拼到了一起。

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……!

Kanjira: It looks like one of those ugly statues in there, so they can move?
坎吉拉：这看上去像里面那些丑丑的怪雕像……这里的雕像……会动？

Kanjira: Wow!
坎吉拉：哇哦……

Kanjira: It's just like, like the ...!
坎吉拉：这就像，就像……!

There's a twinkle of excitement in her eyes.
女孩的眼中迸发出兴奋的光芒。

Kanjira: Like the story in the book!
坎吉拉：就像那些书里写的事!

Kanjira: Yes, that's right! Those "golems guarding the treasure."
坎吉拉：对的，对的！那些“守卫财宝的石像”……

Kanjira: They are true! I knew it! And "the dragon that eats the castle," "the gem that smashes the sea," "Open Sesame" ...
坎吉拉：瞧吧！我早就说那些都是真的！什么“吃掉城堡的巨龙”、“砸碎海洋的宝石”、“芝麻开门”……

Kanjira: Ms. Sherjah is lying! They are not fairy tales!
坎吉拉：夏尔贾还骗我那些只是童话故事!

Kanjira: No wonder she has two helpers. They are the "treasure hunters"! They beat the "guards"!
坎吉拉：怪不得多了两个人——他们就是“寻宝小队”！他们打败了这些“守卫”！

She nods at her thought, overjoyed by the conclusion.
女孩兴奋且笃定地点了点头，对自己的想法深信不疑。

Kanjira: Oh, yes! Just follow them secretly, and I will get at least a bit of the "treasure" they leave behind! Like how Kasim got the coin from the scales.
坎吉拉：噢，这太好了！只要我继续偷偷跟着，总能从他们的牙缝儿里取点“财宝”！就像卡希姆从斗上取下金币……

She is heartened by the plan.
她被自己的发现鼓舞到了。

She turns around, nimbly jumps on that rock again, and quietly follows the others in the cave.
坎吉拉雀跃地转身，三两下就蹿回了那块岩石上，缓缓地靠近石窟深处的众人。

Shamane: Okay, okay. I think I understood every Hindi word, but none of them make any sense anymore when put together.
鬃毛沙砾：好的，好的……虽然你说的每个字我都听得懂，但是它们连起来怎么这么难以消化……

In the messy cave, the three of them look at each other speechlessly. Shamane is patting himself on the head, trying to understand Kaalaa Baunaa's words one by one.
一片狼藉的石窟内，三人面面相觑。男人敲着脑袋，试图消化伽菈波那句子里的每一个单词。

Shamane: You're saying, Kumar, that Kumar I know, the sister whom I've only seen once in my life ...
鬃毛沙砾：你是说，库玛尔——那个我所认识的、从小到大只见过一面的姐姐……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... is also my tutor in the university.
伽菈波那：——也就是我大学的导师。

Matilda: Plus, she's a bad guy associating with the Manus?!
玛蒂尔达：还是个与重塑有关系的坏家伙?!

Matilda slowly puts down the files.
玛蒂尔达将手中的文件慢慢放下。

Matilda: So these abnormal growth curves ... The fluctuation of celestial energy is a man-made result?
玛蒂尔达：……所以这个奇怪的增长曲线……天体能量的波动，是人为造成的?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Actually, I'm not a hundred percent sure about their association, but yes, your conclusion about the growth curves is right.
伽菈波那：其实关于她与重塑的关联，我并没有十足的把握。但是……是的，你理解得没有错。

Kaalaa Baunaa calmly takes over the files.
她轻轻接过了被重新整理好的文件。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The fluctuation was caused by an unnamed celestial body, and its existence is only known to Kumar and me.
伽菈波那：天体能量的波动来源于一颗未被命名过的天体……而它的存在，只有我和库玛尔两人知道。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It was the object of our research at Banner University. At that time, we found some arcanum-related materials very helpful for our project, but then ...
伽菈波那：它曾是我们在班纳尔大学的研究项目。当时我们发现某些神秘学文献对研究非常有帮助……但后来……

She gently shakes her head.
伽菈波那轻轻摇了摇头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: She was way too radical. Arcanum is strictly prohibited in the field of human science, and we were expelled from the university. After that, our disagreement got even worse. In the end, we took different paths.
伽菈波那：神秘学在人类科学的研究内是被禁止的。我们被迫离开学校后分歧越来越严重，她太过激进……总之，我们最终分道扬镳。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But apparently, neither of us gave up on the research. We could frequently feel the existence of each other from the changes of the celestial body.
伽菈波那：但显然，她和我都没放弃对这颗天体的研究。我们时常能从天体的变化中察觉到彼此的存在。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And one day, I found an abnormality during the observation: the energy never fluctuated in such a fierce and peculiar way. I decided to contact her, but when I finally found the lab she had worked in, the staff told me she had already left.
伽菈波那：而我在一次观测时发现了它的异常——此前从未有过这样剧烈而特殊的波动。但等我终于找到她研究所的位置时，那边的人说她早就已经离开了那里……

She looks at Matilda.
她望向玛蒂尔达。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Our common friend told me she had seen Kumar by coincidence. She saw her leave with the Manus.
伽菈波那：……我们共同的熟人曾告诉我，她偶然见到过库玛尔……跟着重塑之手的人离开了。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Kaalaa Baunaa spreads her fingers and shows Matilda a dusty stone in her left palm.
伽菈波那摊开左手，掌心之上，躺着一个脏兮兮的石块。

Despite the misshapen outline, the stone seems to be a little idol.
它模糊的轮廓难以辨认，看上去似乎是一尊神像。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And I found this from what she left behind. I compared it to the hole in the wall. It does come from this cave, and it has something to do with the arcanum-related materials on that celestial body.
伽菈波那：我在她留下的东西里发现了这个——我刚刚比对过缺口，它确实来自于这个石窟，而且……与那颗天体对应的神秘学文献有所关联。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But Kumar never makes mistakes. This one is more like a clue she left to me.
伽菈波那：但库玛尔从不出纰漏，这更像是她刻意为我留下的线索……

Matilda: Hmm. I don't understand her.
玛蒂尔达：唔……真是个奇怪的人……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Judging from the situation, apparently, I'm not the only one "invited."
伽菈波那：但从目前的情况来看……她显然不只“邀请”了我……

She raises her right hand, showing them the wrinkled envelope.
她扬起右手上拿着的那个被不甚爱惜的、皱巴巴的信封。

There is a blue postmark on the envelope and an elephant pattern on the bright-yellow seal. Inside the envelope, there is a worn piece of paper with nothing on it.
信封上面有着蓝色的邮戳，明黄色的蜡封上是一只象。而信封内，泛黄的信纸上空无一物。

Shamane: Oh, this is getting even stranger than seeing those moving statues!
鬃毛沙砾：哦，在我看来这比刚才那些会动的石像还要怪！

Shamane: Like I said, I am, well, to be more precise, I "almost" am the last living member of my family.
鬃毛沙砾：就像我说的，我是——嗯，现在应该说“几乎是”我家最后一个人了。

Shamane points at the majestic elephant on the seal.
他指了指蜡封上威风凛凛的大象。

Shamane: This stamp was supposed to come from a special seal that belongs to the heir of the family. Unfortunately, it was passed down to me, and I lost it to a bear many years ago.
鬃毛沙砾：这本应该是唯一一个，属于所谓继承人的印章——但很不幸，我早就不小心把那个印章丢到了熊肚子里了。

Shamane: I checked the postmark on the envelope and found the letter came from this remote cave, where even rock pigeons don't bother to pay a visit.
鬃毛沙砾：而这个邮戳指向的位置，正是这个岩鸽都不来筑巢的石窟……

Shamane: Since it is highly unlikely that the bear with my seal in its belly would take transport all the way to a cave to send me a letter, I decided to come here myself and find out what this was all about.
鬃毛沙砾：鉴于那只黑熊自己乘坐交通工具来到这里给我寄信的可能性微乎其微，我觉得我有必要亲自过来瞧瞧这个情况。

Shamane: But there's one thing I found weird in what you said.
鬃毛沙砾：不过你说的有一个地方有点奇怪……

Shamane hesitates about what he is going to say.
鬃毛沙砾看上去有点犹豫。

Shamane: As far as I know, my sister is even worse than "unqualified," if taken as an arcanist—She's almost like a human! It's nearly impossible for her to use the most basic arcane skills!
鬃毛沙砾：就我所知，我姐姐作为神秘学家是非常……“不合格”的——她几乎和人类没有一点儿区别！连使用最基本的神秘术对她来说都难如登天！

Shamane: And this ...
鬃毛沙砾：而这个——

He opens both of his palms and gestures in the direction of the broken statues on the ground.
他摊开双手，示意着地下七零八落的石像肢体。

Shamane: This is not something a random person from our world can do. Is she really able to control these things?
鬃毛沙砾：这可不是一个普通的神秘学家能做到的事情……她可能操控这些东西吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa: No, she can't.
伽菈波那：……她确实不能。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But she has a solution—a solution even I'm not aware of. Theoretically, our skills can only create illusions and nothing more.
伽菈波那：但她知道方法，甚至知道了我不知道的方法……按理说，我们最多、最多只能创造出一些幻觉……

Kaalaa Baunaa: But if the Manus really offered to help her, even though I don't want to think this way, she may be able to do that.
伽菈波那：尽管我不愿意相信……但如果真的是重塑给予了她帮助，这一切就是有可能的。

Shamane: Oh, I forgot the Manus part.
鬃毛沙砾：……噢，我忘了还有这一环。

Shamane: Alright. All I know is, if this letter is really an "invitation" from her, I guess this won't be a delightful trip for me.
鬃毛沙砾：好吧，我这边知道的只有——如果这封信真是她的“邀请”……那估计没我什么好果子吃了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I've heard about that incident in her family, and I don't think her ultimate purpose is just to gather us here.
伽菈波那：关于她家里的事，我曾经有所耳闻……但我们的到来，应当并不是她的最终目的。

She turns around and looks at Matilda with a serious but sincere expression.
她转过身，郑重地面向玛蒂尔达。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Thank goodness I met you here, young lady. Can't believe I ran into a Foundation investigato- ...
伽菈波那：谢天谢地，在这里遇到了你……小姑娘竟然是基金会的调查——

Matilda: Ahem. Don't, don't mind the title! Every member of the Foundation is obliged to contribute to the cause of peace, let alone an arcanist as extraordinary as I am!
玛蒂尔达：咳，咳咳，不，不用强调职位！每一位来自基金会的成员都有义务为了和平做出贡献——更何况是我这么出色的神秘学家！

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's great. Sarasvati blessed me.
伽菈波那：这真是太好了，看来娑罗室伐底还愿青睐于我……

Matilda: Yeah, yeah, exactly. How fortunate the Foundation has been to have such an excellent subordinate like I am.
玛蒂尔达：嗯嗯，是的，基金会有我这样优秀的学员真是太好了……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I hereby apply for assistance to the Foundation as an astronomy professor and an arcanist.
伽菈波那：——我以天文学教授及神秘学家的身份向基金会正式提出申请。

Matilda: Em, emm?
玛蒂尔达：嗯，嗯？

Matilda: Yes, Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?
玛蒂尔达：伽菈波那小姐……？

Kaalaa Baunaa: Rather than find Kumar and the Manus, we have something more important to do now.
伽菈波那：比起找到库玛尔和重塑，我们眼下有个更重要的问题。

Matilda: Something more important?
玛蒂尔达：更重要？

Kaalaa Baunaa: We need the Foundation's assistance to evacuate the villagers and tourists in Mor Pankh village as soon as possible because that near-earth astero- ... No, no. It's not an asteroid.
伽菈波那：希望基金会可以协助我尽快疏散摩卢旁卡村的居民与游客，目前，那颗近地……不，不……它不算小行星……

Kaalaa Baunaa: That celestial body we study, not able to be observed by human technology, is approaching this village at a dangerous speed. It reaches level 5 on Torino Scale and 0.01 on Palermo Scale.
伽菈波那：那颗我们研究的、无法以人类科学观测到的……天体，正以极快的速度接近该村，该星体的都灵危险指数为 5，巴勒莫撞击指数预计为……0.01。

Matilda: What?
玛蒂尔达：什么？

Kaalaa Baunaa: In brief, the meteor shower that is occurring during Dīpa Festival will become a disaster of meteorites. I tried to ask organizations in the surrounding areas for help, but this village is out of Chandigarh's jurisdiction.
伽菈波那：简单来说，烛星节的流星雨即将演变成一场陨石灾难。我近期曾尝试过向周边地区的机构寻求支援，但村子的地理位置特殊，不在昌迪加尔的辖区内。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Besides, the villagers refuse to accept help from any social organizations related to humans.
伽菈波那：除此之外，该村的民众也拒绝信任一切与人类有关系的社会机构……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: The good news is, there are still days before the Dīpa Festival starts. We still have time to evacuate the people. Meanwhile, I will do whatever I can to find Kumar and stop her, no matter what her next step is.
伽菈波那：好在现在距离烛星节正式开始还有几天时间，如果现在疏散这里的村民，一切都还来得及……我也会尽快找到库玛尔，阻止她继续——无论她要继续做什么。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If the Foundation offers its assistance, I will provide any support when needed.
伽菈波那：如果基金会同意支援，我将提供一切有效支持。

Matilda: So this, this is her real ...
玛蒂尔达：所以，这，这才是……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes. In this case, what happened in the caves was probably nothing more than an experiment.
伽菈波那：是的——现在看来，石窟里发生的事很可能只是她的一次实验……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm not sure why she's doing this, but I won't allow such an abuse of our hard work.
伽菈波那：我不知道她究竟要用它做什么——但我不能看着她利用我们的研究、我们的心血做这种事。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It is our work, after all. That's why I must stop the star from falling.
伽菈波那：这毕竟与我脱不了干系……所以，我一定要阻止它的坠落。

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……！

Kanjira: D**n it.
坎吉拉：该死……

Shamane: Hmm?
鬃毛沙砾：嗯?

Shamane: Did you guys hear anything?
鬃毛沙砾：你们有听到什么声音吗?

Kanjira: Hey!
坎吉拉：嘿——！

The small figure vaults deftly over the wall, running down the road in the opposite direction.
矮小的身影灵巧且迅速地翻过墙壁，急匆匆地沿着街道往另一个方向跑去。

Kanjira: Ugh. This is the worst, worst fairy tale ever!
坎吉拉：呜……这是最糟、最糟的那种故事……！

Kanjira: It has no treasures, and now even rocks are falling down!
坎吉拉：没有财宝就算了，怎么还……怎么还会有石头掉下来啊！

Kanjira: *pants* I, I have to go back.
坎吉拉：呼……呼……得赶紧回去……

Kanjira: And warn everyone!
坎吉拉：……必须告诉大家！

She seems to know the place well. She takes a few turns, climbs over another wall, and lands in a deserted yard.
她轻车熟路地转过几个弯，翻入一座破破烂烂的院子里。

Kanjira: Run, run. Ajar, you need to take everyone to ...
坎吉拉：快，快跑……阿贾尔，你带着大家……

Kanjira: *pants* I-I'm out of breath.
坎吉拉：呼呼……好累，喘死我了……

???: Kanjira?
???: 坎吉拉?

Kanjira: Um, Ms. Sherjah?! Why, how you find this place?
坎吉拉：……呃？夏尔贾老师?！你，你怎么找到这里的……

Ms. Sherjah: Of course, I can find it. It's your secret base, right?
夏尔贾老师：我当然得在这里了。这里是你们的秘密基地，啊，是吧?

She reaches out and drags the nervous-looking girl to herself.
她伸出手去，将难得出现紧张神色的女孩拉到自己面前。

Ms. Sherjah: A secret base in other's house without the owner's permission? Well, well, well.
夏尔贾老师：擅自把别人的房子当作秘密基地——好啊……

Kanjira: Aw. No, no, no, Ms. Sherjah. It's not time to judge me. Something huge just happen.
坎吉拉：呜哇……不，不不，夏尔贾老师，你先不要急着训我，这次是真的有大事……

Ms. Sherjah: Sorry, sweet Jalebi. Your tricks never worked on me.
夏尔贾老师：抱歉，可爱的小糖饼。你的花招儿在我这里从没奏效过。

Sherjah catches the ear of the troublemaker.
年轻的女人拎起捣蛋鬼的一只耳朵。

Ms. Sherjah: Taught Ajar to steal? Broke into an old house? Let me check your pocket. I knew it! Whose wallet is this? Did you forget what I've taught you?
夏尔贾老师：教唆阿贾尔偷窃，闯入无人住的老屋，让我看看——口袋——果然！这是谁的皮夹？看来我教给你的东西都忘干净了?

Kanjira: Ye-yes! I do all these! I'm sorry, Ms. Sherjah, but LET ME DOWN!! It's too late if we don't leave now! The village is going to destroy!!
坎吉拉：是，是！这些都是我做的！对不起夏尔贾，可是……快放我下来——现在再不跑就真的晚了！这个村子就要被毁啦！

Ms. Sherjah: What are you babbling about this time?
夏尔贾老师：你又在胡乱说些什么?

Kanjira: It's real, not lie! I even run all the way back from the shrine like idiot, and leave tuk tuk I borrow from Uncle Sinha there.
坎吉拉：是真的，是真的！我像个蠢蛋一样一路从神庙跑回来，都忘了自己从辛哈大叔那儿借来了车——

Ms. Sherjah: Ah! You went to the shrine and ate the offerings again! Young Miss!
夏尔贾老师：啊！你还去神庙偷吃了！你这小崽子……

Kanjira: *sobs* I'm really sorry! But you must believe me this time! Where are the others? Where they go? We must tell them now. They must take train and leave this place today.
坎吉拉：呜呜，我真的知道错了！但是这次你一定要相信我啊！其他人呢？他们都去哪儿了？得赶紧告诉他们，越快越好，最好能爬上今天的火车……

Ms. Sherjah: *sighs* They went to the street for business. What on earth is happening?
夏尔贾老师：唉，他们去街上做生意了……究竟是怎么回事——

Kanjira: Li- ... listen to me!
坎吉拉：你听我说！

Kanjira stops, drawing a huge circle in the air with her hands.
坎吉拉停下来，用手在半空中挥了个巨大的圆。

Kanjira: I'm, I'm catch by a stone hand in the shrine's cave! And, and I see the "treasure hunters"! I hear what they say.
坎吉拉：我在神庙的石窟里被一个石头手拽住了脚腕！还遇到了“寻宝小队”！我偷听到了他们说话……

Kanjira: They say a big big stone called "meteorite" will fall and smash the village when Dīpa Festival start!
坎吉拉：他们说，在几天后的烛星节上，会有那种叫“陨石”的大石头掉下来——把村子砸平！

Ms. Sherjah: *sighs* Honey, I told you they are just fairy tales.
夏尔贾老师：唉，亲爱的，我说过那些只是故事……

Kanjira: No! It's true! Those statues actually move.
坎吉拉：不是！是真的！那石像真的动了……

Inside the old house, Kanjira is so busy persuading Sherjah that she has not noticed the approaching footsteps from outside the door.
坎吉拉在这栋老屋里急得团团转，没留意到屋外的脚步声愈来愈近。

Shamane: Ah, the lock's broken, but that's okay. I know the place well. Though Kumar hasn't come here very often in the past years, it's a good place to start with, at least better than randomly searching like a headless chicken.
鬃毛沙砾：哦，这门锁都坏了。但没关系……这位置我绝不会记错，尽管库玛尔后来也没使用过几次，但是总比漫无目的地找——

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……！

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Ms. Sherjah: You are ...?
夏尔贾老师：你们是……？

The two groups look at each other in silence through the door.
隔着老屋院门，两队人马面面相觑。

As the silence goes on, Matilda notices the wallet in Sherjah's hand.
玛蒂尔达的视线在沉默中滑向夏尔贾手中的皮夹。

Matilda: Hey!
玛蒂尔达：嘿！

Matilda: That in your hand ... Is that my wallet?
玛蒂尔达：你手上的那个——那个是我的钱包吗？

3#5
3#5

石窟异响
Noises from the Stone Cellar 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

菩提树
The Sacred Fig JMP-06

Old House
旧屋

Crowded by these many people, the old house seems even shabbier.
破旧的小屋在众人的衬托下显得更加逼仄。

The five of them sit around a piece of furniture that can barely be used as a table. The awkwardness surrounds them like a naughty bird.
五个人围坐在唯一一张可以称之为“桌子”的家具旁。尴尬像只灵巧的雀儿，在众人的头顶上盘旋。

Ms. Sherjah: Thank you so much for your understanding, Mr. Sharma and Ms. Bouanich.
夏尔贾老师： 感谢你们的原谅，鬃毛沙砾先生、玛蒂尔达小姐。

Shamane: Ah, please, Madam. You have my admiration for voluntarily taking care of these kids. Besides, technically speaking, this room doesn't belong to me anymore ...
鬃毛沙砾： 哈，别这么说，女士，对于您义务照顾这群孩子的行为我只有钦佩——况且这间屋子，从名义上来说早就已经不属于我了。

Shamane: ... but to my sister, Kumar. I wish I could leave the house to you for future use.
鬃毛沙砾： 现在，它仍是属于库玛尔——我姐姐的东西……啊，但你们刚才也听旁边的这位小姐说了……

He gestures for Kaalaa Baunaa.
他伸手示意一旁的伽菈波那。

Shamane: But you heard what the lady said—I don't even know if the house will survive the meteor.
鬃毛沙砾：如果可以，真希望这之后房子还能给你们用！但是，以现在的状况……我可不太确定这儿能不能抵挡住一颗陨石。

This is probably not the best time for a sense of humor. Everyone in the room falls into silence. The coming crisis makes them heavy in mind.
这不是一个开玩笑的好时机。寂静之中，众人不约而同地思考着可能到来的危机。

They sit on the dusted ground. Shamane magically takes out several ceramic cups from his luggage.
椅子显然是这个空间的奢侈品，几人只能坐在积了一层灰的地面上。男人变戏法儿似的从自己的行李里掂出了几只泥陶制的杯子。

Shamane: This is the latest batch of Darjeeling tea. Some locals gave it to me when I went across their village. Ah, careful. It's hot.
鬃毛沙砾：新鲜的大吉岭～前几日我徒步时那边村里人给的好东西，哦呦，小心烫……

He touches a cup to feel its temperature and passes out the cups one by one.
男人伸手试探了一下杯壁的温度，缓缓将陶杯们一一推了出去。

Matilda snatches Kanjira's cup angrily.
玛蒂尔达却一把抢过坎吉拉的杯子，气愤填膺。

Matilda: You two are in it together? You've been lying to me all this time?!
玛蒂尔达：你竟然和那个小子是一伙的！好哇，原来从一开始你就想骗我！

Kanjira: Hey, quiet before Ms. Sherjah.
坎吉拉：哎呀，在夏尔贾面前你小声点……

Kanjira: You don't lose anything, my lady. Please forgive me, will you? Now pass me cookies! I need fill my belly and get to work!
坎吉拉：大小姐，你又没吃什么亏，就别再和我计较啦～你先把饼干递给我，我吃饱了还要去忙活呢！

Kaalaa Baunaa: My apologies, Ms. Sherjah. I know this is totally out of the blue.
伽菈波那：很抱歉，夏尔贾女士。我明白这一切非常突然。

Kaalaa Baunaa takes out her files again. She has carefully prepared herself to persuade the others.
伽菈波那再次将那些文件拿了出来。显然，她为了说服他人已经做了尽可能充足的准备。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And the details are yet to be verified, but our valuable time is running out. The last thing we should do is keep on waiting.
伽菈波那：尽管确切的数据还有待考证……但时间是目前最宝贵的东西，而等待则是最愚蠢的做法。

Ms. Sherjah: Emm.
夏尔贾老师：唔……

Her gaze sweeps the difficult and obscure data and words.
她的目光滑过一行行晦涩的数据与身份证明。

Ms. Sherjah: Kaalaa Baunaa.
夏尔贾老师：伽菈波那……

Her face suddenly brightens up.
她突然露出一个笑容。

Ms. Sherjah: My! I think I know this name! I've read the paper co-authored by you and Professor Himani.
夏尔贾老师：噢，我认识这个名字！你和希玛妮教授发布过的那篇论文我曾读过……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Huh? You've read my paper?
伽菈波那：……？你读过我的论文?

Ms. Sherjah: Emm, yeah! I'm studying in a public university in Chandigarh. I get to learn a lot of new stuff there.
夏尔贾老师：噢，呃……是的！我目前在昌迪加尔的一所公立大学借读……在那边，我常能接触到一些新鲜东西。

Ms. Sherjah: I had a whim to study astronomy before, and I remember reading it in a periodical.
夏尔贾老师：曾有一段时间，我对天文学产生了一些兴趣……我记得，那好像是在一本期刊上见到的。

She gesticulates at the papers.
年轻女孩用手比划着文件上的数据。

Ms. Sherjah: Yes, I'm sure it's the same name.
夏尔贾老师：啊，是的，是你的名字……

Ms. Sherjah: This part and this part! I've read them in your paper, but emm, this one on the side, I don't know anything like it.
夏尔贾老师：这些……还有这些！我曾见过相似的东西。呃，不过旁边的这部分……我还从没见过……

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's okay. That one involves the knowledge of arcanum.
伽菈波那：没关系，那是涉及神秘学的部分。

Kaalaa Baunaa relaxes a bit.
伽菈波那微微放松了身体。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Anyway, this is good news—no, great news. So what are you doing in Mor Pankh?
伽菈波那：这样就太好了，太好了……但你在这里是因为……？

Ms. Sherjah: Oh, I take care of the kids here in my spare time. Most of them are humans, but there are arcanists, too.
夏尔贾老师：我在没课的时候会过来这边照顾孩子们……他们大多是人类……也有少量神秘学家的孩子。

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I see.
伽菈波那：原来如此。

Ms. Sherjah: So, what are you going to do now?
夏尔贾老师：唔，那现在你们准备怎么做呢？

Her question contains both confusion and worry.
夏尔贾的声音里除了困惑，还有一丝担忧。

Ms. Sherjah: I know the top priority is to evacuate the villagers, but we don't have much time since the Dīpa Festival will start in less than four days. Besides, things are complicated in this village.
夏尔贾老师：让村子里的大家尽快离开确实是目前最正确的选择……距离烛星节还有不到四天，我们的时间并不多。但……村子里的情况——有点特殊。

She frowns at the thought. This could be tricky.
她皱起眉头，像是想到了非常棘手的事。

Ms. Sherjah: Most of them, including me, had moved to Chandigarh.
夏尔贾老师：这村中的大部分家庭——比如我——早就搬到了昌迪加尔。

Ms. Sherjah: And the rest of them ... *sighs*
夏尔贾老师：剩下的……唉……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I've heard about that on the way here.
伽菈波那：在来时的路上，我有所耳闻。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Most villagers are reluctant to leave, no matter what I say. I tried by starting with those young arcanists, but shame! It didn't work at all.
伽菈波那：大多数村民都十分抗拒离开这里，我尝试过游说那些看上去年轻一点的神秘学家……但很可惜，也并没有什么效果。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The silver lining is, we have the helping hand of Ms. Bouanich. She will try to make contact with the Foundation as soon as possible. But we still need to evacuate every villager we can.
伽菈波那：但好在玛蒂尔达小姐会为我们提供帮助。我们会想办法尽快与基金会取得联系。不过目前，我仍认为村里能离开的人越多越好……

Ms. Sherjah: ...
夏尔贾老师：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: We know almost nothing about Kumar's plan now, not to mention her whereabouts or purpose.
伽菈波那：我们现在对库玛尔知之甚少……至于她人在何处，又抱有怎样的心思……我们还无法提供确切的信息。

The ice has been broken between them, but their moods have not yet lightened.
尽管尴尬缓和了许多，但气氛并没有向轻松的方向发展。

Shamane: Relax. For now, we have two solutions to the problem.
鬃毛沙砾：别紧张，现在的情况下，我们仍然还有两条出路——

Shamane raises both of his hands, palms up.
鬃毛沙砾举起两只手，掌心向上。

Shamane: First, let's find my clever, evil sister so that our astronomer friend can figure out a way to stop the meteor. Or, spread the word and tell everyone to take the earliest train and leave the impact area!
鬃毛沙砾：一，找到我那个聪明的坏姐姐，这样我们的天文学家就能有办法，阻止那颗星星；二，让这儿的所有人，乘坐最早一班的火车，尽快离开这里！

Shamane: It's hard to be optimistic given the situation, but at least there is something we can do to reduce the damage.
鬃毛沙砾：不能说是乐观，至少还算有点方法，能让它看上去没那么糟～

Shamane: But if we continue to sit around waiting, the situation will only worsen. Come, let's think.
鬃毛沙砾：但是再拖下去可就不一定了，来吧，让我们想想……

Bushes and weeds grow throughout the yard. Matilda finds a relatively open area, taking out a silver device from her pocket with great caution.
屋外的野地杂草丛生，玛蒂尔达站在一处相对空旷的地面，小心翼翼地从口袋里掏出来一个银色的电子机械。

Sherjah and Kanjira, the two people who are most familiar with the village, have set out to evacuate the villagers. Inside the house, Shamane and Kaalaa Baunaa are turning the room into a cloud of dust to find any possible clues about Kumar.
熟悉地形的夏尔贾与坎吉拉早已匆匆行在疏散村民的路上。而寻找库玛尔线索的两人正将老屋里折腾得尘土飞扬。

The only quiet place left for Matilda to perform her duty as "Foundation investigator" is this long-deserted yard.
女孩只得躲到了院子里，履行自己“基金会调查员”的职责。

Matilda: Great! It finally comes in handy.
玛蒂尔达：很好！它终于可以派上用场啦……

SPF-I: SPF-I Portable Contact Device activated. Welcome.
系统音：欢迎使用 SPF-I 型便携联络装置。

SPF-I: Arcane skill verification activated. Please make sure you are not equipped with any wands. Read out the random incantation displayed on the screen clearly. Make sure your tone remains stable.
系统音：已开启神秘术验证。请保持未装备施咒术杖的状态。清晰念出屏幕上随机出现的神秘术咒语，注意声调平稳。

Matilda: Ahem, Fuego Burn.
玛蒂尔达：咳咳……火光灼灼。

SPF-I: Verification success. Registered user: Matilda Bouanich. Access level: D.
系统音：……验证成功。登录人员：玛蒂尔达·布翁尼。目前开放权限等级——D。

SPF-I: No abnormal arcane skill fluctuation detected in the area so far. Level D access only supports Quick Report.
系统音：目前，您的周边未发现异常神秘学波动。D 级权限范围内仅支持快速汇报功能。

Matilda: Hmm? Insufficient access?! The description says ... Ah, so only an investigator can request backup through this system.
玛蒂尔达：嗯？权限不足?！说明页在……啊，意思是，只有调查员才能用它申请支援。

Matilda: So what's the point of carrying it around all along? I thought it would be useful for emergencies.
玛蒂尔达：那我一直带着它有什么意义嘛，还以为可以在关键时刻派上用场……

Matilda: No. Does this mean I will miss the opportunity to study the celestial energy, plus blow my chance to capture the Manus?
玛蒂尔达：呜，天体能量泡汤了不说，这下不是连抓住重塑都没有机会了？

Matilda: The reception is terrible here. How am I going to get in touch with the Foundation!
玛蒂尔达：这边的通讯又糟得要命……该怎么样才能联系上基金会啊——！

Shamane: Oh, that doesn't sound like any progress with her.
鬃毛沙砾：噢，听外面那声音，她那边的进展可不太顺利。

Shamane: And what I have here is only books! Books and books and books. Nothing else!
鬃毛沙砾：而我这儿……书之外还是书，除此之外什么都没有！

Shamane: "Calf Feeding and Management" ... Is my sister really an astronomer? Was I mistaken about anything?
鬃毛沙砾：《犊牛的饲养与管理》……我姐姐真的是天文学家吗？没搞错什么吧……

Shamane: Hey, Matilda! If you like, there should be the last two pieces of Plera-J on the table! Remember to have them with tea, or it's going to hurt your throat and ruin your beautiful voice.
鬃毛沙砾：嘿！玛蒂尔达，你愿意的话，那桌子上应该还有最后两块派尔拉饼干【Plera-J】！记得泡着茶吃，不然可能会噎坏你的好嗓子——

Shamane: Kanjira was ecstatic about those cookies. She even took three pieces with her when she left. *sighs* I hope that kind human girl will get to the train station safely with those kids.
鬃毛沙砾：坎吉拉那小崽子太能吃了，临走前还拿了三块。呼，希望那个善良的人类女孩能带着那帮小家伙顺利到火车站……

Shamane: Now, let's take a look at you. What are you doing?
鬃毛沙砾：再瞧瞧你……这是……

Shamane: Is this the stone Kumar left to you?
鬃毛沙砾：是库玛尔留下的那块石头?

Kaalaa Baunaa carefully parts the stone. An idol emerges from it.
伽菈波那正小心翼翼地剥开岩石的外壳，其中，一尊小小的神像渐渐显露了出来。

Shamane: Vishnu?
鬃毛沙砾：……是毗湿奴?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Brahma creates, Shiva exterminates, and Vishnu safeguards the balance of the world, lying on the Ocean of Stars.
伽菈波那：由梵天创造，由湿婆毁灭，而毗湿奴横卧于宇宙海之上，维护着万物的平衡……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: According to the materials ... Well, maybe I should explain it with mythologies for non-researchers.
伽菈波那：在文献……唔，对于普通人来说或许用神话来解释更合适。

Kaalaa Baunaa: They mentioned three idols, but Vishnu's is the only one left, so she must have taken the other two. Perhaps it's proof that Kumar abandoned the path of maintaining the balance in the first place.
伽菈波那：神话中曾提及了三尊神像，但在她留下的东西里我只见到了这个。想必另外两尊在她那里。或许……这也证明了库玛尔早就放弃了中间的道路。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That mural there ... She said the mythology on it has been passed down in her family.
伽菈波那：那个石窟里面的壁画——她和我说过，她家族曾一直传颂着它……

Shamane: *sighs* That's true. I've recited that story at least 20 times, but the part on the mural, to be honest, it feels so out of place to me.
鬃毛沙砾：唉，那倒是。那个故事我至少背过二十回……壁画讲述的那段，说实话，没头没尾的！

Shamane: It was more like foisted into those well-known myths, like, emm, a pair of ox horns on a horse's head.
鬃毛沙砾：它就那么被突兀地塞进那些传颂得更广的神话里，唔……就像给马的脑袋上安了一副牛角……

The comparison brings a smile to Kaalaa Baunaa's face. But she shakes her head.
伽菈波那微笑着摇了摇头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: An unusual metaphor. But actually, it plays a significant part in connecting all the mythologies we know.
伽菈波那：奇妙的比喻。但实际上，它正是连结起诸多神话的重要一环。

Kaalaa Baunaa: These mythologies are the primary material of our research. We've been trying to prove human science with basic arcanum theory.
伽菈波那：我们一直以来将这些神话作为研究的蓝本，试图用基础神秘学理论去反证人类科学。

Kaalaa Baunaa: In fact, there is a connection between them, and they can support each other.
伽菈波那：二者之间确实存在着关联，它们之间相辅相成……

She sighs.
她叹了口气。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If arcanists and humans could get along, I suppose the world would have developed faster than it does now.
伽菈波那：如果两个族群不是如今那么水火不容的状态……我想，我们生存的世界可能会进步得更快。

Sensing Shamane's confusion, Kaalaa Baunaa pauses to reorganize her language.
感受到对方困惑的目光，女人似乎在重新编排准备说出口的词句。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's not easy to explain it through, but in short, there is another universe in the shape of an egg affecting reality. We call it the Meditator's Realm.
伽菈波那：唔，具体情况想要三言两语解释清楚会非常困难，但简单来说，有另外一个如同鸽卵的宇宙影响着现实世界。我们通常称之为“幻境”……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Just like our daily dreams, you can enter it once you fall asleep, but that's not how we do it. We connect part of our Gnosis with the Realm through a special kind of meditation.
伽菈波那：就像我们通常会做的梦一样。沉睡，你便进入了那个地方……而我们则是用一些特殊的冥想方式，将自己的一部分灵知与其相连。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's not as easy as it sounds. One needs to either master the meditation skills like we do or use a special medium as an anchor.
伽菈波那：这并非像听起来的一样轻松，要么像我们一样掌握纯熟的技巧，要么利用特殊的介质作为锚点……

She raises her hand, showing the Vishnu idol to them.
她抬起手，示意着手中的毗湿奴神像。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Some mythologies are the original translation of the Realm. An existence that cannot be observed through the methods in this world can be located as long as it is included in mythology. That's how we located that star.
伽菈波那：某些神话便是最初对幻境的解析代码，只要与现实一一对应，就可以找到那些原本不在这个世界视野内的存在——我们就是这样定位到了那颗天体。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Sadly, if we can't prove its existence with data recorded by human technology, our discovery is useless.
伽菈波那：只是很可惜，如果不用人类科技所呈现的实际数据来证明，我们的发现就是一纸空谈。

Shamane: I'm surprised. For all this time, she has never given up on studying the old arcanum tale of our family.
鬃毛沙砾：……没想到她从未放弃有关我们家族的神秘学研究。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You can even say she's fanatic about it. It's just ...
伽菈波那：她甚至热衷于此。可是……

Kaalaa Baunaa frowns.
伽菈波那皱起眉头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Indeed, we can do a lot of supernatural things in the Realm. If your mind is calm or your anchor is strong enough, you can even do whatever you want. But it's limited inside there.
伽菈波那：尽管在幻境里我们能做到很多超出现实中的事——如果你的心绪足够平稳，或者锚点足够扎实，你甚至可以在幻境里为所欲为，但这仅限在其内部。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Remember I said it's like our daily dreams? Just think of it as a controllable one. Everything in the Realm is created based on reality. In other words, it's nothing but a "mirror," and the images in a mirror can never affect reality.
伽菈波那：还记得我说它像梦吗？那最多算是可以自行控制的梦……幻境里的一切基于现实而生——它才是“镜子”，理应不存在影响现实的可能性。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's impossible to bring anything into the Realm, not to mention taking anything out.
伽菈波那：我们什么也带不进去，更不要提带出来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But the statues in the cave actually exist in this world. They are tangible.
伽菈波那：但石窟里的神像……却是实实在在，可以触碰到的。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That means she's gone much further than I do. She mastered a method I'm not aware of. What bewilders me is her arcane skill. How did she do that if not for the Manus's help?
伽菈波那：她的研究显然比我成功多了——她掌握了我并不知道的方法。但我不明白，她的神秘学能力……如果不是重塑之手的帮助，她又是怎么……

Shamane: Oh, c'mon, she also knows that cave a lot better than I do, right?
鬃毛沙砾：哦，别太伤心，她对那个石窟不是也比我要熟悉多了？

Shamane goes to the book pile on the other side of the room and casually opens the Underground Survival Guide on top.
男人走到一边，随手翻开了书堆最上方的一本《地下生存手册》。

Shamane: We never hung out much. How long did she stay in the village on her last visit? A month maybe, or two weeks? I'm not sure. I even crushed her glasses by accidentally sitting on them. Those are the same glasses you have on your belt.
鬃毛沙砾：我与她相处的时间并不长。也许有一个月，或者是半个月？我还把她的眼镜坐坏了——喏，就是你腰上的那个。

Shamane: At that time, I thought she was a distant relative I don't know of. After all, it's rare to meet someone so clever and open-minded in this village. I even lent this room to her. *sighs* This was my secret basement, you know!
鬃毛沙砾：当时我还以为她是哪来的远房亲戚，在这个村子里难得有那样聪明、眼界又开阔的家伙，我还把这间屋子借给她——嗐，这里当初可是我自己的秘密基地！

Shamane: But only after we parted did my father tell me that she's my sister—the daughter they sent away for lack of arcanum talent!
鬃毛沙砾：结果，直到和她告别之后，我才从我父亲那里得知，那个人竟然是我的亲姐姐，被他们嫌弃神秘学天赋平平，亲手送出去的好女儿！

Kaalaa Baunaa: I do remember those days roughly. Back then, I couldn't find her in the institution. I was all alone for a long time.
伽菈波那：……关于那段时间，我有些印象。那时候我去研究所，总是见不到她的身影，有很长一段时间，我都是独自一个人。

Shamane: What happened to her has inevitably affected me. I grew more and more rebellious against the family rules.
鬃毛沙砾：总之……这件事不可避免地成为了我日后叛逆的一颗种火——

Shamane: It's like a story full of cliches: giving up the training, refusing to listen to my father, skipping all the practice I could possibly avoid. I didn't want to be the blockhead hedged by the so-called "family heritage"!
鬃毛沙砾：一个讲起来很经典的故事：我放弃那些训练，懒得听我父亲的教诲，逃避一切可逃避的练习，死活不想当那个被所谓“继承”束缚住的蠢人！

Shamane: Of course, at the end of the story, I paid my price for breaking away.
鬃毛沙砾：当然，故事的最后——我仍然为此付出了代价。

He raises the rough prosthesis and stops turning the pages.
他抬了抬那只做工粗糙的手臂，翻书的手停了下来。

Shamane: But I think, for her, it is even harder to break free.
鬃毛沙砾：……不过我想，她可能比我更加难越过那座高墙。

He gently takes out a photo from the book.
他从那本书中轻轻拿起一张纸片。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: I guess her plan is to "invite" me over to this dump full of bad memories, and "Swoosh ... BOOM!" Smash all the annoyances with a star.
鬃毛沙砾：我猜，她的计划是将我“邀请”到这里——到这个给她带来烂回忆的坏地方，再用一颗星星“咻——”地一下把我们这些让她心烦意乱的东西一口气解决掉！

Shamane: Hmm. That's a solemn ending! Pity the ones she hates are all gone now.
鬃毛沙砾：嗯……挺有仪式感的！但很可惜，她恨的那些家伙早就不在啦……

Kaalaa Baunaa takes the photo from him.
伽菈波那接过他递过来的相片。

Shamane: But, how come you're invited, too? Did you upset her as well?
鬃毛沙砾：但你为什么也被邀请了……你也得罪她了？

Kaalaa Baunaa: Hmm. That's a good point. Hatred could be the most likely reason.
伽菈波那：唔……这么说的话，仇恨或许确实是最有可能的原因。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Actually, we didn't get along well after we left the university.
伽菈波那：其实……我们在离开大学之后，关系并不融洽。

Kaalaa Baunaa touches the girl in the photo with her fingertip.
伽菈波那的指尖轻轻碰了碰相片中的女孩。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Ever since our identities as arcanists were exposed, we couldn't stay in the institution anymore. That's also the beginning of our disagreement.
伽菈波那：从我们二人的神秘学家身份暴露之后，就很难继续在研究所待下去了。也是那时候，我们之间有了分歧……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I always thought that, on the way to proving myself, ourselves, we were each other's only friend and best partner. How could I finish my study in campus full of humans without her?
伽菈波那：我总以为，在证明自己——在证明我们自己的这条路上，彼此是对方唯一的朋友、最棒的同僚。没有她，我又怎么能在那个满是人类的大学里坚持下来呢？

The small idol in her palm is a bit cool to the touch.
小小的神像躺在手心，有着微凉的触感。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But then my mind was changed.
伽菈波那：可是那之后就变了……

Her voice lowers.
她的声音低了下去。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I wouldn't have connected Kumar with Manus Vindictae, if Himani's words were all I heard.
伽菈波那：……如果只是希玛妮的几句话，我是不会把库玛尔和重塑联系到一起的。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But I know that was not the first time they made contact.
伽菈波那：但我知道，那并不是他们第一次接触。

Shamane: You mean ...
鬃毛沙砾：你是说……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes. I don't know the reason, but the Manus has contacted her long ago. She gave them the cold shoulder at the time, but I knew something inside her had changed.
伽菈波那：是的，重塑之手在很早之前就联系过她，我不知道是什么吸引到了那些人……她当时把他们拒之门外，但我感觉得到，在那之后她就变了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Soon after that, she left me, taking all the materials with her.
伽菈波那：那之后不久……她便带着所有的研究资料离开了我。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I know the only thing I can do to meet her again is keep walking on the way to study that celestial body. That will lead me to her one day.
伽菈波那：我知道，唯一能让我们再次相遇的方式就是……我也继续在研究那颗天体的道路上走下去。

Kaalaa Baunaa: As I said, we could frequently feel the existence of each other from the changes of the celestial body, but she could always find more information than I do, because the traces left by arcanum are more obvious than those left by science.
伽菈波那：我之前说过，我们常能通过这颗天体察觉彼此的存在……她能察觉到的比我更多。因为研究的特殊性，神秘术留下的痕迹总是更明显些。

Kaalaa Baunaa: This connection between us conveyed my belief to her that one day we would meet again as colleagues.
伽菈波那：我就是这样坚信着，也以这种方式告诉她：总有一天，我们能重新以同僚的形式相逢。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I just didn't expect that this would be the final outcome of my observation ...
伽菈波那：……只是没想到，走到尽头，我的观测会为我带来这样的结果……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... or that we would end up on the opposite sides.
伽菈波那：……也没想到我们会成为彼此的对立面。

Shamane: Emm.
鬃毛沙砾：唔……

Shamane: Can there be any lamer stories to tell than these two?
鬃毛沙砾：真是两个不适合当故事讲的……故事！

Kaalaa Baunaa: For now, we can't find more clues in her house. Maybe we should go to the shrine again? How much do you remember the myth of your family? As I just said, that was the primary material of our study.
伽菈波那：……目前看来，在她的屋子里也没什么线索，或许我们应该再去一次神庙？你关于家族里的那个神话还记得多少，我们当初的研究……

Matilda: Ah-ha! A geeenius you are, Matilda!
玛蒂尔达：啊哈！我真是——天才！天才玛蒂尔达！

Shamane: Hahaha, running and jumping around with hot tea. I sure know the fun within.
鬃毛沙砾：哈哈，举着茶杯四处蹦跳……我能理解这样的乐趣……

Shamane: But at my age, with the benefit of hindsight, I have to tell you to be careful. You might get burned by the tea.
鬃毛沙砾：但以我现在的年纪，我只能说注意安全，这很容易烫到你自己……

Matilda: No, no! It's the spice! The spice in the tea!
玛蒂尔达：不，不！是香料，里面的香料！

Shamane: More spice to it? Hmm. I do have a dozen kinds of different spices with me. Looks like you are very used to them in tea.
鬃毛沙砾：还要再加些？唔……我大概随身携带十几种，你看起来很习惯……

Matilda: Exactly, these spices!
玛蒂尔达：没错，就是香料——

Matilda pats herself on the chest proudly.
金发女孩得意地拍了拍自己的胸膛。

Matilda: Now it's time for Matilda to show you her best shot!
玛蒂尔达：现在是玛蒂尔达的回合了！

Matilda: The orb, cumin ... Oh! You also have clove blossom here! Fantastic.
玛蒂尔达：水晶球……小茴香……哦！你这里还有公丁香！太好了。

Kaalaa Baunaa picks up a transparent blue crystal to look at it.
伽菈波那拈起一颗剔透的蓝色水晶。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The crystal divination. I've spent too much time in the human world to remember the convenience of arcanum.
伽菈波那：这就是水晶占卜……我和人类接触得太多又太长久，竟忘记了神秘学是这样方便的东西。

Matilda: If I can foresee any sign about Kumar, our problem will be ended!
玛蒂尔达：只要看到有关库玛尔的一点点预兆……一切就能迎刃而解！

Matilda: With the help of the great Matilda, of course!
玛蒂尔达：——当然，是在玛蒂尔达的英明指引下！

Matilda: Hmm, okay, take a deep breath, give me your hands, rest them on top of mine. Yes, like that.
玛蒂尔达：好的，深呼吸……我需要你们把手掌叠在我的手心上——没错，就是这样。

Matilda: Now, think of Kumar in your head.
玛蒂尔达：现在，想象着你们脑海里的库玛尔……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Matilda: ...?
玛蒂尔达：……?

Matilda: Odd ...
玛蒂尔达：奇怪……呼……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……!

Shamane: ...?
鬃毛沙砾：……?

Matilda: What, what is this? Is that the train station?
玛蒂尔达：这，这是什么……这是那个火车站?

Instead of showing the sign as usual, the fog in the orb grows unexpectedly. It surges and gathers into a mass of black slime.
水晶球中的雾气不减反增，翻滚着，凝聚成一团黑色。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……!

Matilda: There are ...
玛蒂尔达：这是……

Matilda snaps open her eyes.
玛蒂尔达猛地睁开双眼。

Matilda: The Manus already reached Mor Pankh?!
玛蒂尔达：重塑……已经到摩卢旁卡了?!

3#6
3#6

银手镯
The Silver Bangle JMP-07

Kanjira: Hurry up, Ajar! Bring those guys, too! Take the tuk tuk to the train station. Here are a few spots in my caravan!
坎吉拉：快点，阿贾尔！叫上那些家伙也来！开着三轮赶紧去车站……我的大篷车上还能塞下几个！

Ajar: Yes, Boss!
阿贾尔：好的，坎吉拉大姐!

Kanjira: No, wait. Where's Sherjah! What took her so long? Wasn't she with you?
坎吉拉：不，等等，夏尔贾呢……怎么那么久？她没跟你们一起吗?

Ajar: She ... I saw her went to the other side of the village.
阿贾尔：她……我刚刚看到夏尔贾老师去了村子的那边……

Kanjira: Over there? I remember that's ...
坎吉拉：那边？那边我记得是……

Kanjira: Tsk!
坎吉拉：……啧！

Ms. Sherjah: Sir, please, please trust me.
夏尔贾老师：先生，您一定要相信我……

She wobbles her head while begging with sincerity.
年轻的女人轻轻晃了晃脑袋，脸上写满了恳求。

Ms. Sherjah: You have to convince your father. It's not like before.
夏尔贾老师：您一定要尝试说服您的父亲，这次与以往情况不一样……

Rajesh: *sighs* Sherjah, it's not that I don't want to talk to my father.
村民：唉……夏尔贾，不是我不愿意和我父亲去说。

He bends over to place the candle before the stairs, lining it up neatly with the other candles.
男人弯腰，将手中的蜡烛安置在地上，与台阶前的蜡烛群组成了整齐的一列。

Rajesh: You have come to me ... I don't know, so many times. Father has already scolded me several times for letting Jina learn all those unorthodox stuff from you.
村民：这已经是你第……不知道多少次来找我了。我父亲那边……就因为我让吉娜跟着你念那些乱七八糟的书本已经骂了我好几回!

Rajesh: You know, those human books ...
村民：你知道，就那些人类玩意儿……

His eyebrows furrow, and his face grows red with anger.
他皱着眉头，满脸不悦。

Rajesh: You can see, even Jina's mother has no help in the kitchen now. I even have to prepare the candles for Dīpa Festival myself!
村民：你看，现在，她妈妈在厨房也少了个好帮手——烛星节的星烛甚至要我亲自来准备!

Rajesh: No matter what you say, I'm not taking your advice this time. You'd better leave before my father comes out. You know how mad he gets when he sees a human.
村民：不管你这次说什么，我都不会再接受你的建议，我劝你在我父亲出来之前尽快离开。你也知道他看到人类会发什么样的疯……

Takal: Hey Rajesh, who are you talking to? You, you again?!
老年村民：嘿，拉杰什，你和谁嘟嘟囔囔呢——你，怎么又是你?!

Ms. Sherjah: Sir, please listen to me. It's an emergency. I can't tell you the details now, but in a word, this village is going to be destroyed by meteorites! You and your family need to leave here now.
夏尔贾老师： 老先生，您先听我说……这次事态紧急，我……尽管我没办法与您细说，但这个村子就快被陨石毁了，您一定要带着家人尽快离开……

Takal: Enough! You've played that trick a dozen times. We know what you are up to! Trying to get us out of this place? No way!
老年村民： 去去，这样的话术你们至少用了十几回。别以为我们不知道你那点小心思，想让我们从这儿挪走？门儿都没有。

Rajesh: Please, Father. You know Sherjah has been ...
村民： 父亲……您也别这么说，您也知道夏尔贾她一直……

Takal: I am talking to her! Leave now, or I'll ...
老年村民： 这儿没你说话的份！你走不走？不走我就要……

The old man snatches the broom from next to the door.
老人抄起了门框处的扫帚。

No one pays attention to the running steps coming from afar.
没人注意远处越来越清晰的奔跑声。

Kanjira: Punji! Stop him!
坎吉拉： 喷吉！拦住他！

Punji: Hiss!
喷吉： 嘶——

Takal: Oh, oh, ah! Who are you, kid? Why ... why are you on human's side?
老年村民： 唔啊啊！哪里来的小鬼……你……你怎么敢帮着人类……

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira!
夏尔贾老师： 坎吉拉！

Kanjira: What, who else should I help if not her? You? An ungrateful old pig?
坎吉拉： 怎么，我不帮她，我帮你这种猪猡吗？不识好歹的老家伙！

Kanjira squeezes in between them and confronts the old villager, like an upright snake ready to attack.
黑发女孩挤进二人中间，像只鳞片立起的小蛇。

Takal: You ...
老年村民： 你——

Kanjira: How many times has Sherjah helped you, and how many things did Jina learn from her? You! You only know being mean to her and talking about something like arcanists and humans!
坎吉拉： 夏尔贾帮了你们多少次，吉娜跟夏尔贾又学了多少东西！你们只知道天天抓着她找麻烦，把神秘学家、人类挂在嘴边！

Kanjira: Stay if you like! Sherjah is being so nice and saving your life, but no one is clever enough to listen! Better let the star fall on you and crush you into ashes!
坎吉拉： 你爱跑不跑！夏尔贾好心帮你们，一个两个不识好歹！让星星把你们都砸死算啦！

Kanjira: Let's go!
坎吉拉： 我们走！

Ms. Sherjah: I'm so sorry. She ...
夏尔贾老师： 真是抱歉，这孩子——

Ms. Sherjah: Aah!
夏尔贾老师： 啊！

Without saying another word, Kanjira seizes Sherjah's arm and drags her away.
坎吉拉没再说一个字，她一把抓住夏尔贾的手腕，用尽全身的力气拉着她离开了。

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira, stop! Don't pull me! It hurts.
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉，停下，别，你拉疼我了……！

Kanjira makes a sudden stop. Her chest is pumping up and down out of anger.
女孩收住脚步，胸膛因为愤怒剧烈地起伏着。

Kanjira: They is always mean to you and bullying you! Why you must look for trouble?
坎吉拉：……你都被他们那些人欺负多少次了，为什么还要过去找不痛快?

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira ...
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉……

Kanjira: After all the things you do for them, how can they treat you like that?! Just leave them alone! Come with me. I still have your spot on my caravan.
坎吉拉：你明明，一直是为他们好……他们怎么可以这样对你……你，你不要管他们了！快和我走，我这边还留了你的位置……

Kanjira: The time for entering and exiting the trains of the station is the same every day! I remember it well. There will be a train leaving here soon. There is still time.
坎吉拉：车站每天进出火车的时间都是一样的！我记得很清楚……很快会有一列火车离开这里，现在一切都来得及……

Ms. Sherjah: ...
夏尔贾老师：……

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira, take a deep breath and listen to me.
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉，你先深呼吸——你听我说。

Sherjah becomes conscious of her student's emotions. She bends down to the level of Kanjira's eyes, shaking her arms to reassure her.
年轻的女人察觉到了女孩的情绪。她微微蹲下身子，轻轻地拉着她的手摇晃。

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Ms. Sherjah: I know you said all those things to them for me, and I appreciate that.
夏尔贾老师：我知道你是为我好，为我着想，才对他们说出这种话，我不怪你。

Ms. Sherjah: But think about it, if I treat them just the same way they treated me, just stand by and watch them head to death ...
夏尔贾老师：但是，如果我也做了与他们同样的事，就这样眼睁睁地、放任他们失去性命——

Sherjah chooses her words carefully, as patient as she used to be in every English class.
她斟酌着词句，像是每次为他们讲解英语单词一样尽可能放慢着语速。

Ms. Sherjah: Even if I'm doing this out of understandable fury, how would it make me any different to them?
夏尔贾老师：尽管我愤怒的情绪如此合理，可是这样，我与他们又有什么区别?

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……！

Ms. Sherjah: Volunteering to help you, and, in your opinion, "risking my life to save them" ... They are all out of my own will.
夏尔贾老师：无论是我帮助你们，还是我现在——你眼中的，“拯救”他们……这都不过是在践行我自己的意志罢了。

Ms. Sherjah: Hatred doesn't end itself, Kanjira. It has to be ended by someone.
夏尔贾老师：仇恨是不会无故停止的，坎吉拉，总要有人从自己开始停止这一切。

Kanjira stares at her teacher's face in confusion. Slowly, she lowers her eyes and looks down at her feet.
女孩仍旧困惑的目光在夏尔贾的脸上停留了片刻，缓缓移到了自己的足尖。

Kanjira: I, I don't understand.
坎吉拉：……不，我不懂……

Kanjira: Do I ... Do we mean nothing to you?
坎吉拉：我在……我们在你眼里，就如此不重要吗?

Ms. Sherjah: How come?! What gave you such an idea? You are my most precious children. All of you are my treasures!
夏尔贾老师：怎么会！你怎么会这样想？你们是我最重要的孩子……你们……你们都是我的宝物啊！

Kanjira: This is not the first time you prefer they over we.
坎吉拉：你已经不是第一次选择他们了……

Kanjira: You always put they first when there's a problem.
坎吉拉：每次遇到问题，你总是优先考虑那些家伙……

She knows well that Sherjah should not be blamed for this.
她明白这不是夏尔贾的错。

But this doesn't relieve her of the bitterness.
但这并不能缓解一份被拒绝的酸涩。

Ms. Sherjah: ...
夏尔贾老师：……

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira ...
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉，你……

Kanjira: I, I am not able to read, but I'm not a kid now. If I can, I don't want to be an arcanist too, so me, you, and Ajar is the same.
坎吉拉：我，我是不识字，但我已经不是个小孩子了。如果可以……我宁愿自己也不是个神秘学家……这样我和你，和阿贾尔他们就一样了……

They have no time for this.
这个时候并不适合说这些。

Kanjira struggles to choke back the tears.
坎吉拉试图努力忍住那些在眼眶里汹涌的泪水。

But she's overwhelmed by the fear of losing Sherjah.
但她实在太害怕失去夏尔贾了。

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira. Don't cry, Kanjira.
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉，不哭，坎吉拉……

Ms. Sherjah: So you've been thinking ... Oh, little one. You're just like us! We are your family!
夏尔贾老师：原来你一直……噢，小家伙……你跟我们就是一样的呀！我们就是你的家人……

Kanjira: No, you don't understand, Ms. Sherjah. Enough talk. Maybe I don't understand any of your lectures, but you can't stay here!
坎吉拉：不，夏尔贾，你，你不懂……咳咳，嘶——别再说这些了，我，我不可能听得懂你的大道理，但你绝不能留在这里！

Ms. Sherjah: ...
夏尔贾老师：……

Ms. Sherjah: I'm sorry, Kanjira.
夏尔贾老师：抱歉，坎吉拉……

Sherjah has never found it so difficult to refuse someone.
她鲜少感觉拒绝的话语如此难以启齿。

Ms. Sherjah: I have to admit they're unreasonable, but as I said, we should put that aside now. It's a matter of life, Kanjira. I can't ...
夏尔贾老师：我承认，他们的行为确实有些不可理喻……但就如同我刚才说的，现在不是计较这些的时候，你知道吗？那是生命，坎吉拉，我不能……

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Kanjira feels her stomach churning due to the bitterness, urging her to act on impulse.
那份酸涩在胃部翻涌着——促使着坎吉拉做出冲动的决定。

Kanjira: You ... you is not listening to me at all!
坎吉拉：你，根本没把我的话听进去……

Kanjira: Fine! Be a savior and go! We'll leave here on our own!
坎吉拉：算了！那你就去当你的救世主吧！我们自己走！

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira!
夏尔贾老师：坎吉拉！

Sherjah's hand only lands on empty air. Kanjira runs away and disappears from her sight.
挽留的手终究没能阻止她。夏尔贾只得眼睁睁地看着女孩消失在自己的视野里。

Kanjira: *sobbing*
坎吉拉：呜呜……呜……

She leans on the steering wheel, sobbing.
女孩趴在方向盘上，用力地吸着鼻子。

Kanjira: I, I'm never talking to her again!
坎吉拉：我，我再也不要管她了！

The caravan stops at the train station, which seems out of place in the small village.
疾驰的车子停了下来，这个与小村格格不入的车站再次出现在了视野里。

Kanjira: Ajar! Uncle Sinha!
坎吉拉：阿贾尔——！辛哈大叔——！

Kanjira: Hmm. Where are they? Why is here so quiet? It was crowded this morning.
坎吉拉：奇怪，人呢？车站怎么静悄悄的……上午还有很多人啊……

ooze
“吧嗒。”

Kanjira: This, this is ...
坎吉拉：……这，这是……

Manus Disciple: UGGGHHHH!
重塑·门徒：ㄨㄛㄛ——！

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……！

Kanjira: Blood, so much blood ...
坎吉拉：这……怎么会有这么多……血……

The terrifying masked monsters are staggering among the stone pillars in the train station.
戴着面具的骇人怪物摇晃着，穿梭于车站的石柱间。

Kanjira: No! Ajar!! Uncle Sinha!!
坎吉拉：不……阿贾尔——辛哈大叔——

Ajar: Hey! Boss! Over here. It's safer here. Come over!
阿贾尔：嘿，坎吉拉大姐！我们在这儿……那边危险，快藏过来！

A smart head pokes out from behind the pillar.
柱子旁冒出一个机灵的脑袋。

Kanjira: ...!
坎吉拉：……！

She quickly sneaks through the station on tiptoe without being noticed.
趁着无人注意，坎吉拉踮起脚迅速地穿过车站。

Kanjira: Whoa, I was almost scared to death! Good to see you safe. What happened here?
坎吉拉：哇，吓死我了……还好你没事，这边发生了什么啊?

Ajar: No idea! A bunch of dreadful people suddenly showed up. Each of them has a mask on their face. Over there, on the platform. There are a few more!
阿贾尔：不知道！突然来了一群戴面具的恐怖家伙，火车月台那边就站着好几个！

Ajar: They came out of nowhere and attacked the passengers for no reason.
阿贾尔：他们莫名其妙地出现在这里……毫无道理地开始攻击旅客……

Ajar seems to be thinking of something. He can't help but shiver.
小男孩似乎是想到什么，忍不住打了个寒噤。

Ajar: But luckily, the villagers had been evacuated before they came. Thanks to Ms. Sherjah's efforts.
阿贾尔：不过好事是，在他们过来之前，已经有不少人离开了……唔，这都多亏了夏尔贾老师……

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Ajar: We were left behind because we had to wait for you. Did you come here on your own? Where's Ms. Sherjah?
阿贾尔：但是我们为了等你们没赶上……对了，你怎么自己过来了，夏尔贾老师呢?

Kanjira: She ...
坎吉拉：……她……

Ajar: Quiet. They're coming!
阿贾尔：嘘——他们要过来了！

Ajar: Don't, don't let them see you.
阿贾尔：绝，绝对不能被发现……

As he shrinks in fear, something drops out of his pocket.
他瑟缩成一团，口袋里的东西顺势滑落。

Ajar: Ah! D**n, my silver ...
阿贾尔：啊！糟糕，我的……

Tonk.
“叮。”

A silver bracelet bounces briskly on the floor.
银色的手镯在地上行进了一道迂回的弧线。

The slight noise is thundering in the quiet station.
——清脆的声音在静谧的空间里震耳欲聋。

Kanjira: Really?! You have to take those goods with you now?!
坎吉拉：——你怎么这时候还带着那些货物啊！

Manus Disciple: AAARRRHHHH!
重塑·门徒：ㄏㄜˋ——ㄜˋ——！

Kanjira: RUN!!
坎吉拉：——跑！

Manus Disciple: EEERRRHHHH!
重塑·门徒：ㄨㄚˋㄠˋ——

Kanjira: Ajar, watch out!! Ah!
坎吉拉：阿贾尔，小心！呃唔！

Ajar: Boss!
阿贾尔：坎吉拉大姐！

A sharp rune grazes Kanjira's shoulder, leaving a deep wound.
锋利的咒文擦着坎吉拉的肩膀划过，留下一道深深的伤口。

Kanjira: Ah ...! It hurts so much! Punji, bite them!
坎吉拉：痛，嗷哇哇，好痛！喷吉，咬他们！

Punji: Sssss!
喷吉：嘶——！嘶……

Kanjira: Go hide in the caravan! I can handle this. Ah!
坎吉拉：你们躲到大篷车里去，我还能应对——呃啊！

Another rune flashes across her ankle. Kanjira loses her balance and falls to the ground.
又一道咒文掠过她的脚踝，女孩一时重心不稳，摔倒在地上。

Kanjira: Ah! It hurts.
坎吉拉：痛，痛死了！

Kanjira: Oh, no, I'm dead for sure.
坎吉拉：这下完蛋了，绝对要死了……

Matilda: Pafisto Pecise!
玛蒂尔达：弹无虚发——！

Kanjira: Hmm?
坎吉拉：嗯？

As Kanjira looks up, the first thing that comes to her tearful, blurry sight is a head with milky blonde hair.
坎吉拉泪眼朦胧地抬起头来，略显昏暗的视野里，毛绒绒的浅金色脑袋分外显眼。

Matilda: *pants* Phew! So glad I caught up in time.
玛蒂尔达：呼，呼……赶上了，还好赶上了……

Kaalaa Baunaa: There are people over here! Let's take her first.
伽菈波那：这边还有人！我们先带她走。

Shamane: This place is soon going to be dangerous. I know a place. It's close to here. Come, take them this way!
鬃毛沙砾：这周围很快就不安全了，但这附近……我知道一个地方，先带他们来这边！

Manus Disciple: UGGGHHHH!
重塑·门徒： ㄨㄛㄛ——！

Matilda: Humph, you dirty, filthy, less-than-elegant mugs! Matilda won't even sweat bringing you down!
玛蒂尔达： 哼，脏兮兮、一点儿都不优雅的坏家伙们……玛蒂尔达打你们连香汗都不会出！

Matilda: May the peace be with us!
玛蒂尔达： ——愿和平与我们同在！

3#1
3#7

泪水壶
Drown in Tears JMP-08

Courtyard of the Sharma Old House
沙尔玛旧宅

Kanjira: Ah, ouch. Is your medic skill really okay?
坎吉拉： 唔，痛……你这个包扎技术没问题吧?

Matilda: Hah? Are you questioning my skill? I was always, for most of the time, the best student in first aid class! There, the pain is gone, yeah?
玛蒂尔达： 啊？你竟然敢质疑我！我的应急处理课程一直——经常是第一！喏，不痛了吧！

Kanjira: Well, hmm, not bad.
坎吉拉： 唔……嗯。马马虎虎吧。

Matilda: Hey, I'm not done with your stealing!
玛蒂尔达： 呀，你偷了我的钱包的事我还没忘呢！

Matilda pats her on the wound to show her discontent.
玛蒂尔达不满地在她伤口上拍了拍。

Kanjira: Hey, hey, hey. Ah! I already apologize!
坎吉拉： 哎，哎哎——痛痛，好痛！我不是道过歉了嘛……！

Matilda: Humph, slick!
玛蒂尔达： 哼，欠缺诚意！

Matilda turns her eyes toward the two people standing under the tree.
玛蒂尔达将视线转向伫立在树下的两个人。

Matilda: Hmm. I didn't expect to see this.
玛蒂尔达： 只是没想到……

Matilda: What a spacious yard for a house located right next to the train station!
玛蒂尔达： 车站附近还有这么宽阔的宅子啊……

A massive sacred fig stands in the middle of the yard.
巨大的菩提树伫立在宽阔的庭院中央。

It looks a lot older than it was in the photo, and it has become leafless, like a skeleton.
尽管它的年岁看上去比照片中的那棵久远得多，但其树冠之上毫无一物，只挺拔着光秃秃的枝丫，仿佛一具被燃烧殆尽的尸骨。

Shamane: Old buddy, I'm surprised that you're still here.
鬃毛沙砾： 老兄弟，没想到你还在呢……

His rough hands land on the equally rough bark. The tree responds with nearly imperceptible cracks.
男人粗糙的手抚上了同样粗糙的树皮。手掌之下，传来了微不可闻的龟裂声响。

Kaalaa Baunaa: We have settled everyone so far. I didn't expect so many Manus members here.
伽菈波那：目前救下来的人都安置好了……没想到重塑之手的人有这么多……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I've never encountered them before. They can't be communicated with. How horrible!
伽菈波那：我还是第一次正面遇到他们……几乎完全不能沟通，真是难以想象。

She's still haunted by the battle.
伽菈波那看上去心有余悸。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And, since we meet them here, it means ...
伽菈波那：而且……在这里遇到了他们就意味着……

Shamane: Kumar did cooperate with the Manus.
鬃毛沙砾：……库玛尔确实和重塑之手合作了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Ugh!
伽菈波那：唔……！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Shoot! It's completely out of control.
伽菈波那：真该死……这下情况完全不可控了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The incantation in the cave—She must be able to detect the fluctuation caused by it, and that gave us away.
伽菈波那：石窟里的咒语……一定是那个咒语留下了痕迹，让她发现了我。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But what in the world is her purpose?
伽菈波那：可恶，她究竟有什么目的?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Did she think I would stop her? So she deployed these things to slaughter the village?
伽菈波那：难道她觉得我会阻止她……所以利用这些疯狂的东西在这个村子里大开杀戒?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Does revenge matter that much to her?
伽菈波那：她就这么想——复仇?

Kaalaa Baunaa feels everything is so absurd.
伽菈波那感觉这一切如此荒谬。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I trusted her. I never believed she would do such a thing, even if we're no longer on the same path.
伽菈波那：……即便我们已不再是一路人，我也很难相信她会做出这样的事。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Vishnu's idol feels particularly hard in Kaalaa Baunaa's soft palm.
毗湿奴神像的触感在柔软的掌心中格外突兀。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But the reality tells me, my trust in her is nothing but a joke.
伽菈波那：可这份信任在事实面前……像个玩笑。

Shamane: Hatred changes people.
鬃毛沙砾：……仇恨确实会让人变成另一副模样。

Shamane shakes his head.
鬃毛沙砾摇了摇头。

Shamane: It's not a choice, Kaalaa Baunaa. You don't have to feel bad for trusting people. You trust someone because they are trustworthy, but you never need a reason to hate.
鬃毛沙砾：那并非是一种选择，伽菈波那，你无需为自己的信任懊恼。信任有迹可寻，仇恨却从不遵从逻辑。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: Let your guard down for even one second, the toxic idea will sneak into your mind, and it would be impossible to get rid of it.
鬃毛沙砾：只要有一瞬的松懈，让那些念头钻入你的灵魂里……再摆脱它就难如登天了。

Shamane: It will burn your mind and sanity, until you become an animal living for revenge, even forget your own name.
鬃毛沙砾：它会灼烧你的理智，人将因此退行为一只恶兽，直到忘却自己姓甚名谁。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane: Oh, don't look at me like that. It's nothing personal! In my mind, she is still my cool and scholarly sister. I was young and easily fooled back then.
鬃毛沙砾：噢，别这么看着我，这不是在说她坏话！我印象里的姐姐还是个又酷又博学的家伙——当年的我确实被唬住了！

Shamane: What I said was based on my real-life experience. I was way more outrageous than her!
鬃毛沙砾：这些分析只是基于我个人的经验……我以前可比她离谱多了！

Shamane: Ah, I mean, we were all young once, right?
鬃毛沙砾：呃，我是说……谁没有年轻的时候……

Kaalaa Baunaa shakes her head and sighs.
伽菈波那摇摇头，发出一声叹息。

Kaalaa Baunaa: No matter what, she is already on the move. But we don't even know where she is.
伽菈波那：无论如何……她已经开始行动了，而我们甚至不知道她在哪儿。

While Kaalaa Baunaa and Shamane are talking quietly, in the other corner of the yard, a heated quarrel is taking place between the girls.
院子里的另一处却显得热闹非凡。

Matilda: Don't even think about it! The painkiller won't last long. There's no way you can drive with a wounded foot!
玛蒂尔达：那不可能！止痛只是暂时的，你的脚现在根本没法驾驶呀！

As soon as Kanjira stands up, Matilda pushes her back to the seat.
玛蒂尔达一把将站起来的黑发女孩摁回原本的座位上。

Kanjira: But Sherjah is still out there! She can't use any arcane skills. If she's find by the mask monster ...
坎吉拉：可是夏尔贾她还在外面！她什么神秘术都不会……万一遇到了那些戴着面具的怪家伙就……

Matilda: Even, even if you are right on this, I can't just let you ... Hmm?
玛蒂尔达：就，就算你这么说，我也不能放——嗯?

SPF-I: SPF-I Portable Contact Device activated. Abnormal arcane skill fluctuation detected. Conducting analysis.
系统音：SPF-I 型便携联络装置已开启。检测到当前范围内有异常神秘术波动，正在分析……

Matilda: It just activates itself, eh?
玛蒂尔达：它自动……咦?

SPF-I: Source of abnormal arcane skill fluctuation confirmed. Similar faction: Manus Vindictae. Margin of error: 0.121%. Emergency support application sent.
系统音：已核实异常神秘术波动来源。近似群集：重塑之手。偏差预计 0.121%。已为您自动投放紧急支援申请。

SPF-I: Adjusted support application priority to: HIGH.
系统音：已调整支援申请优先级，目前为——高。

Matilda: Does it mean we can ask the Foundation for backup now?
玛蒂尔达：意思是……可以向基金会发出支援申请了?!

Matilda: This is great! People, I finally got in touch with the Foundation!
玛蒂尔达：太好了……各位，我终于联系上基金会了!

Shamane: Yeah? That's good news!
鬃毛沙砾：是吗？这真是个不赖的消息!

Kaalaa Baunaa: But the Manus is still wandering out there.
伽菈波那：可是重塑的人仍然活跃。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Before the Foundation evacuates them, the village will be destroyed.
伽菈波那：这样下去，没等基金会的人带他们撤离，村子就要遭殃了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: We can't just sit around and watch.
伽菈波那：我们不能坐以待毙。

Kaalaa Baunaa looks down at the glasses. Her finger gently swipes across the broken temple.
伽菈波那低着头，手指抚摸过那支眼镜腿的断痕。

Kaalaa Baunaa: There is another way.
伽菈波那：……我们还有一个办法。

She speaks up, though hesitantly, after the long silence.
良久的沉默过后，她犹豫着开口。

Matilda: Way? What way?
玛蒂尔达：唔？什么办法?

Kaalaa Baunaa: If she can do it, I can do it, too.
伽菈波那：……她能做到的事——我也能做到。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Maybe I can find traces of her if I enter the Realm.
伽菈波那：只要我也进入幻境，说不定就能找到她的蛛丝马迹。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Because I also mastered meditation skills.
伽菈波那：因为，我也掌握着冥想的技巧。

Kaalaa Baunaa's eyes fix on a stone. She's lost in her thoughts.
伽菈波那的眼神聚焦在一块石头上，兀自沉入了自己的思绪里。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes, that's right. I know the path inside.
伽菈波那：对……没错，没错……我也掌握着冥想的……

Kaalaa Baunaa: What do I need? Yes, water, enough water to soak me in.
伽菈波那：……需要什么？对了，水……足量的，能把我包裹起来的水……

Her eyes can't help but move to the large ceramic vat in the corner.
她的眼神不自觉地游向了角落里巨大的陶缸。

Matilda: Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?
玛蒂尔达：唔，伽菈波那小姐……?

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane: Now, hold on. Please wait.
鬃毛沙砾：不，不……请等等。

Shamane waves his hand in front of the researcher, who is already carried away by some emotion.
男人伸出手，在已经陷入了某种情绪的研究员面前挥了挥。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...?
伽菈波那：……?

Shamane: If it was so easy, why don't you look for her in the Realm in the first place?
鬃毛沙砾：如果真的像你说的这样轻松，你为何不在最开始就去幻境里找她?

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……!

Kaalaa Baunaa: I ...
伽菈波那：我……

Shamane: It is a risky move. Am I right?
鬃毛沙砾：这是有一定风险的，没错吧?

Kaalaa Baunaa: How did you know?
伽菈波那：你是怎么知道的?

Shamane: Oh, just my instincts, or experiences, perhaps.
鬃毛沙砾：噢，一些直觉，或者说，经验……

He gives her a gentle wave of his hand.
他摆了摆手。

Shamane: No offense, but when I look at you, I see a desperate tiger cub cornered by the hunters.
鬃毛沙砾：没有侮辱你的意思——但，你现在给我的感觉就像是那些被逼入末路的虎崽子……

Shamane: The situation is not as simple as you think.
鬃毛沙砾：这事儿显然没那么简单。

Shamane: Since she can "invite" us to Mor Pankh, she can play the same trick and "invite" you to her Realm.
鬃毛沙砾：她既然可以“邀请”我们两个人来到摩卢旁卡……她就有能力再请你去她的“领地”做客。

Shamane: This could be a trap, a trap to keep you stuck inside the Realm.
鬃毛沙砾：——这很可能是一个陷阱，一个想办法把你困住的伎俩。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: You are right. It is a risky move.
伽菈波那：你想得没错，这确实有一定的风险。

Kaalaa Baunaa: With the other two idols as her anchors, she is the true dominator of the Realm now.
伽菈波那：她目前拥有另外两尊神像作为锚点，现在的幻境，她才是主人。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I can't foresee what's ahead of us in there, so I've been avoiding it.
伽菈波那：我无法预测即将发生什么……这也是我一直避免进入幻境的原因。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But ...
伽菈波那：但是……

Kaalaa Baunaa looks up at him.
伽菈波那抬头望向他。

Kaalaa Baunaa: We don't have other choices, do we?
伽菈波那：我们现在没有更好的办法了，不是吗?

Shamane: Whoa. Now we are talking, you seem ready.
鬃毛沙砾：哇哦，这个眼神……看起来你准备好要做些什么了。

Shamane: But, hmm ...
鬃毛沙砾：但是——嗯——

He shakes his head with slight disapproval.
男人摇了摇头。

Shamane: Whatever you decide to do next, don't. This is the advice from an experienced hunter.
鬃毛沙砾：不管你决定了接下来要干什么——以一位经验丰富的猎人来说，我个人是不建议你去做的。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Why?
伽菈波那：……为什么?

Shamane: Because whatever is in your mind now is going to send you into the hunter's trap. This happens to all kinds of animals. When the animal realizes it is cornered, its mind will be in a muddle.
鬃毛沙砾：因为这是落入陷阱前的可怜动物最通常的反应。

Shamane: It can't think of anything else, but at the same time, it strangely grows overconfident. It will take the gamble of escaping from its last way out, which is also going to be the entrance of the trap.
鬃毛沙砾：它们走投无路，视野变窄，冥冥之中已知死局，却反而因此开始没来由地盲目自信，在没必要的地方孤注一掷……

Shamane: Trust me.
鬃毛沙砾：相信我。

He seems unusually serious.
他难得地看起来有些认真。

Shamane: I know how you feel. You thought there's no way out but a footlog bridge.
鬃毛沙砾：我很能明白那种感觉，那种眼前只剩下一条独木桥的感觉——

She stares at his face for a long time. Eventually, she shakes her head.
女人盯着他的脸良久，最终还是摇了摇头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The Manus followers are still wandering about, and some villagers haven't been moved to safer locations.
伽菈波那：外面的重塑不知道会游荡到什么时候，还有一些村民没有被带回来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But sometimes, we must take the risky path to get out of the dreadful situation, even though it is full of traps.
伽菈波那：有些风险是必须的……在没有更好的道路出现之前，即便是陷阱，也有尝试的必要。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

He notices her fingers clutch and loosen repeatedly out of anxiety.
他注意到了女人因紧张而反复握起又张开的手。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It may not solve all the problems, but it's better than doing nothing.
伽菈波那：即便不能解决问题，也不会全无收获。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If this really is a trap, that means we will meet again.
伽菈波那：况且……如果真的是陷阱，那就证明我一定会再次见到她。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And I have been waiting for a chance to talk to her face-to-face for too long.
伽菈波那：对我来说，这样直面她的机会……我渴望已久。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I have been chasing after an imaginary goal since she left me.
伽菈波那：自她走后，我一直在向着不存在的目标前进。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I watched that star closely, taking down everything that I could observe. However, despite all the efforts, deep down, I know better than anyone else—it's useless.
伽菈波那：我努力地观测夜空，记录下那颗星星……尽管我拼尽全力地寻找她，但我知道……这样漫无目的的努力毫无意义。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I remember those days, almost half of which were like living in a mist. But now ...
伽菈波那：我还记得那些日子，将近半途都是白茫茫的一片。可现在……

Kaalaa Baunaa: But now, I can feel it. Her silhouette is right there in front of me.
伽菈波那：现在……我，我感觉得到，我已经看到她的背影了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: To be honest, this is not the best time to "seize this chance."
伽菈波那：……诚然，这个机会出现的时机并不算好。

Matilda: Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa.
玛蒂尔达：伽菈波那小姐……

Kaalaa Baunaa: But no matter how I look at it, this is too good an opportunity to pass up.
伽菈波那：但无论站在哪个角度，我不能放弃的理由都太多了。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane meets her gaze squarely.
鬃毛沙砾没有避开她直视而来的目光。

Then he blinks. He scratches his head, feeling a bit powerless.
良久，他眨了眨眼睛，又败下阵来似的抠了抠脑袋。

Shamane: Emm. Okay. Fine. *sighs*
鬃毛沙砾：唔……行吧，好吧……诶呀……

Shamane: If you insist on doing this, I will not stop you.
鬃毛沙砾：……如果你执意要做的话，我不会再拦你。

Shamane: We all have our lessons to learn. And you are right—we don't have any better options.
鬃毛沙砾：毕竟谁没跌过跤呢……而且，你说得对，我们目前确实没有更好的办法。

Shamane: What is it they say? No risk, no feast, huh?
鬃毛沙砾：那句话怎么说来着？一分风险——一分收获！

Shamane: But please keep this in mind—no matter what happens, your safety will always be the top priority.
鬃毛沙砾：只是你要知道，无论在里面发生了什么——请务必保护好你自己。

Shamane: We cannot bear to lose someone who is capable of putting this to an end.
鬃毛沙砾：我们不能失去一个能把事情彻底解决的人。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I will.
伽菈波那：……我会的。

3#8
3#8

小守护者 · 1/2
The Little Guardians · 1/2 JMP-09

They gather before the ceramic vat in the yard.
人们聚在院子里的大陶缸前。

Shamane: Are you sure? To use this?
鬃毛沙砾: 你确定……你要用这个东西吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa: What's wrong with it? It has enough water to soak me in.
伽菈波那: 怎么了吗？这罐子里的水刚刚好……我也正好能够进去。

Shamane looks at the old vat and then checks the filthy water and rotten leaves inside. There is a silence between them.
鬃毛沙砾看着破败的陶缸与其中混沌成一片的落叶与脏污，沉默了片刻。

Shamane: Hmm, you are much more practical than I thought.
鬃毛沙砾: 唔，你对实用性的追求比我想象的高。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Oh, before I go ...
伽菈波那: 对了，还有……

She hands the Vishnu idol to Matilda.
伽菈波那将那枚毗湿奴神像交给了玛蒂尔达。

Matilda: Hmm? Aren't you going to take it with you, Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?
玛蒂尔达: 咦？伽菈波那小姐，你不带着它吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa: No.
伽菈波那: 不……

She slowly shakes her head.
她摇了摇头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Shamane has a point. This is our last chance to win this fight, and it should be kept away from Kumar as far as possible.
伽菈波那: 鬃毛沙砾先生说过的话……不无道理。这是我们的底牌，它离库玛尔越远越好。

Matilda: Emm.
玛蒂尔达: 唔……

Matilda: Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa, take this with you then!
玛蒂尔达: 那伽菈波那小姐，你带上这个！

Matilda passes over a crystal. It is shining brightly, like a freshly picked star.
递过来的矿石晶莹剔透，仿佛一颗刚摘下来的星星。

Kaalaa Baunaa: This is your ...
伽菈波那: ……这不是你的……

Matilda: My pendulum! It's one of my collections, one of the purest! Even I don't have a lot of them around.
玛蒂尔达: 我的灵摆！我珍藏的、纯度极高的珍品！这样好的水晶，我自己总共都没有几颗……

Matilda: I realized that the theory of meditation you've talked about is quite similar to some of the crystal divination theories. So, perhaps this will help you in the water, if the crystal can stabilize the magnetic field and guide you in there.
玛蒂尔达：我发现你所说的冥想理论，一定程度上和水晶占卜的某些理论根源非常相似～所以如果有水晶帮助你平衡磁场、引导灵知的走向……想必一切都会顺利很多——

Kaalaa Baunaa: You ...
伽菈波那：你……

Matilda: Humph, no need to be surprised. This is how quickly a genius can think!
玛蒂尔达：哼哼，不用惊讶，这是天才基本的反应速度！

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Thank you.
伽菈波那：……谢谢。

Shamane: Ah, great. So, it's only me who can't understand this "meditation in water" thing. Well, it takes all sorts of rocks to form a mountain.
鬃毛沙砾：很好，看来不能理解“在水里冥想”这个行为的人只有我一个——但没办法，山岩就是多姿多样……

Before he finishes his sentence, Kaalaa Baunaa has quickly submerged her legs in the water, as if the cold didn't bother her at all.
伽菈波那迅速地将腿探入陶缸内，如同感觉不到冰冷一般。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Okay, the pendulum and enough liquid.
伽菈波那：好的……灵摆，还有足够多的液体……

Kaalaa Baunaa: And all I have to do now is ...
伽菈波那：现在，只需要……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Think of Kumar.
伽菈波那：——想着库玛尔。

She bends her knees and lets herself slide into the water.
卸掉双腿支撑的力，伽菈波那放任自己的身体滑入水中。

Her world is immediately free of sounds.
声音迅速地远离了她的世界。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

As soon as her head is completely submerged in water, the cold attacks from all directions.
寒意没过头顶，自四面八方侵袭而来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: *inhales*
伽菈波那：哈啊……！

Be it real or false, delusional or real, a world reappears before her.
或真或假，亦虚亦实，世界重新浮现于眼前。

???
???

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Where else could it be more suitable ...
伽菈波那：……果然，会是这里。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... than the place we first met?
伽菈波那：我们第一次见面的地方。

The familiar stone stairs extend much longer than she remembers. The rough red bricks, the well-calculated and carefully designed arc ... Everything in Jantar Mantar has a unique kind of beauty.
眼前熟悉的石阶比记忆中的要长得多。粗砺的红色砖瓦，精心计算的圆弧，简塔·曼塔天文台每一处都有着独属于它的美感。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Hah. How thoughtful you were, Kumar ...
伽菈波那：呵，看来库玛尔为这场会面下足了心思。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... to recreate the observatory in the Realm.
伽菈波那：竟然在幻境里还原出了这些……

The figure standing still on its top looks like a black singularity.
在顶端终点静立的身影就像一个黑色的奇点。

She knows who it is.
她知道那是谁。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Just an illusion in my mind.
伽菈波那：我心中的幻影，罢了。

Now, her left foot is on the first step.
左脚踏上了第一层台阶。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

Resistance is expected.
意料之中的困难出现在眼前。

Kaalaa Baunaa: She remembered almost every detail of me as a child.
伽菈波那：看来她把我小时候的样子记得很清楚。

The figure standing in front of her greatly resembles her younger self—always fist-clenching, always ready for confrontation.
拦在面前的身影，与她小时候的模样相差无几，总是紧攥着拳头，脸上的表情永远像是在对抗着什么。

And now "the girl" is irritated by the intrusion.
而现在，“她”的愤怒或许来自于这场不请自来的入侵。

Illusion: ...!
幻影：……！

"She" rushes toward Kaalaa Baunaa and throws quick punches.
“她”朝伽菈波那奔去，灵活地挥动着拳头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Oh, it hurts!
伽菈波那：唔，好疼……！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Did it hurt this much when I hit someone as a child?
伽菈波那：我小时候的拳头，有这么坚硬吗?

Illusion: Get out! You should not be here!
幻影：出去，这不是你该来的地方！

"She" tries to drive Kaalaa Baunaa away, fighting her like a trained warrior.
“她”驱赶着伽菈波那，体态明显受过严格的训练。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Ah, yes. Mom had taught me a few moves to deal with those brats at that age.
伽菈波那：啊……是的。妈妈曾教过我……对付那些坏小子的招数。

Illusion: Leave!
幻影： 离开！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Hmm. This feels weird.
伽菈波那： ……呃唔，真是……好奇怪的感觉。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Did Kumar put you here? To guard this fragment of memory?
伽菈波那： 是库玛尔让你在这里的吗？让你保护着……这段时间的回忆？

Illusion: ...
幻影： ……

Kaalaa Baunaa: This shall be the obstacle in my way to where I want to be.
伽菈波那： 看来必须过了你这一关，才能前往我想要到达的地方。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's time to face the illusion from the past.
伽菈波那： 直面过去的幻影吧。

太阳升起，月亮落下。生命的指引在新芽上跃动，也许不必真的日复一日。
The sun rises and the moon veils its face. Life's gentle fingers guide each tender seedling, a hint of a different path free of monotony. 小径

Fight of the bulldogs
斗犬之隔

金星闪烁。思绪自唇舌开启，从笔尖流露，于一切始源的创造中生发。
Venus shines. Thoughts flow easily from your lips into your pen. The wellspring of Creation shall gush unabated. 小径

Fight of the bulldogs
斗犬之隔

木星沉默。在阁楼上点一盏灯吧，放任想象的边际延展，因它无尽。
Jupiter falls silent. Light a lamp in your attic and allow your boundless imagination to wander. 小径

Fight of the bulldogs
斗犬之隔

水星追溯。自走的放映机，脱口而出的预言。被动的表达需要被掐灭在襁褓之中。
Mercury is in retrograde. A projector that plays on its own, the predictions that issue forth uninvited. Any desire for reticence must be stymied. 小径

Fight of the bulldogs
斗犬之隔

月亮高悬，太阳低沉。天穹与地境手牵着手，就像世界最开始那样。
The Moon hangs high in the sky, the Sun in its thrall. Heaven and Earth have joined hands again, as they did when the world was born. 小径

Fight of the bulldogs
斗犬之隔

另一座山岩
The Other Mountain Boulder 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

小守护者 · 2/2
The Little Guardians · 2/2 JMP-09

Illusion: Ah!
幻影：啊……

The illusion is dispersed and then gathers again in the distance, but this time, "she" is no longer irritated.
幻影消散了，又重新在远处聚拢。与此不同的是，“她”这次不再带有那样强烈的愤慨。

Illusion: Heh heh.
幻影：呵呵……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

"She" gradually fades away in the light and shadow of the observatory, and her voice goes further and further.
天文台的光影使“她”逐渐模糊，声音也愈发飘远。

Illusion: From the past, to the present, and the future.
幻影：从过去，到现在，到未来……

Illusion: The thing you are clinging on to, facing, and chasing ... Think what it is.
幻影：你所要执着的，追逐的，面对的……是什么……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa lowers her head to look at her palm.
伽菈波那低下头，看了看自己的手掌。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You are still asking questions that cannot be answered, just as you always did.
伽菈波那：你还是像以前一样，总是问一些没有答案的问题。

Kaalaa Baunaa: What do you think I "should" chase after?
伽菈波那：你认为我追逐的“应该”是什么呢?

Her fingers clench gently.
她收起手指，将手轻轻握起。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I won't be misled this time, Kumar.
伽菈波那：别想误导我，库玛尔。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I have never given up studying astronomy since that day.
伽菈波那：天文学这条路，从那天之后我就没有放弃过。

There is only an echo in the empty space. The illusion has gone.
空旷的空间里，除了回音，什么也没有留下。幻影已经离开了。

She looks up at the almost endless stairs.
她抬起头，看着几乎望不到顶的天阶。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Keep moving.
伽菈波那：……继续前进吧。

3#8
3#8

篱笆墙之外
Outside the Fence JMP-10

Kaalaa Baunaa: Whuu ... phew ...
伽菈波那：呼……呼……

First, the child self, then the teenage self, and then the young adult self. Only in the Meditator's Realm can one face so many past selves ...
从幼时，到少年，再到青年。也只有在不符合逻辑的幻境中，人才能有机会直面这样多的、来自过去的自己。

... and defeat them one after another.
——并将他们一一击败。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The 20-year-old me was fierce.
伽菈波那：……20 岁的我真够凶的。

Kaalaa Baunaa rubs her bruised cheeks.
伽菈波那揉着自己布满淤青的面颊。

Kaalaa Baunaa: *hiss* That pain feels real.
伽菈波那：嘶……好真实的痛感。

Kumar: You came here sooner than I expected, Kaalaa Baunaa.
库玛尔：你比我想的迅速，伽菈波那。

The wind feels like tingling knives on the rooftop. A familiar, if not too familiar, figure once again emerges in front of her.
天文台顶端的风声凛冽。熟悉到不能再熟悉、甚至梦中都会见到的面孔，再一次地出现在了眼前。

Kumar: I knew you would come.
库玛尔：我知道你会来的。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar.
伽菈波那：库玛尔。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Finally. See you again.
伽菈波那：我终于……见到你了。

Kumar: I miss you dearly, too, my child. I hope you've been doing well while I was away.
库玛尔：我也很想念你，我的孩子……希望在我不在的日子里，你一切都好。

Kumar: Hope you're happy with the surroundings I set. I always find it enjoyable here—a place full of memories and perfect for small talks.
库玛尔：希望你还满意我的安排。这个地方的环境我一直很喜欢——而且颇具纪念意义，很适合寒暄。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'd rather you suffered, Miss.
伽菈波那：……我倒是希望你过得难受点，老师。

Kumar: Ah, someone is having a worse attitude these days.
库玛尔：哎呀，你和我说话真是越来越不客气了。

Kaalaa Baunaa looks around to observe the surroundings.
伽菈波那抬头，打量着周围的环境。

Kumar: There's no need to look around, kid. I already had a few years of experience in the field before you started your research. And one of the most basic skills one has to master in the Meditator's Realm is to cover up the traces of reality.
库玛尔：别看啦，孩子。再怎么说我的研究也比你早了那么几年，在幻境中完美掩盖好现实中的踪迹，是最基本的技巧。

The sky is dark, like the surface of dusted glassware.
天空阴沉着，像是肮脏玻璃器皿的表面。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Even so, you didn't even think about creating a starry sky for yourself here.
伽菈波那：可你竟然不肯在幻境里给自己一片星空。

Kumar is silent for a moment and then shakes her head.
对方沉默了片刻，轻轻摇了摇头。

Kumar: Hmm. That would be unnecessary. You can see it any time outside this Realm if you like.
库玛尔：……随时都可以见到的东西，没有必要。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Why did you "invite" me here?
伽菈波那：你让我过来，有什么目的?

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: I know you've put in a lot of efforts. I understand the difficulty within and sympathize with you, Kaalaa Baunaa. I always do, just like what I did with my younger brother. By the way, that letter has been delivered to him safely, I assume?
库玛尔：我一向体恤你的努力，伽菈波那，就像当年我体恤我那个陌生的弟弟一样……哦，我想那封信成功寄到了，对吧?

Kumar: You're smart enough not to bring the Vishnu statue with you. Did somebody kindly remind you not to do that?
库玛尔：不过你还是很聪明的……你没将毗湿奴带过来。不会有人给你提醒了吧?

Kumar: Never mind. That's not helpful.
库玛尔：算了，它本来就对我没什么用处。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I don't understand. Why involve him?
伽菈波那：……我不明白。你为什么把他牵扯进来?

Behind Kumar, an old finderscope is aiming at the sky.
库玛尔身后，一个老式望远镜指向天空。

Kumar: Emm, maybe I was being vindictive out of "hatred," like you said.
库玛尔：唔，或许……正如你们所说，是仇恨所致的报复心理吧。

Kumar: After all, they precluded me from doing anything even before I gave it a try. Although my misfortune was not my brother's doing, there's no one else left in the family to take my anger.
库玛尔：我最开始的路，就被他们堵得死死的……尽管那孩子并不是始作俑者，但我的怒火总该找个人承担。

Kumar: So ask me now. Ask me anything you wish to know. I can tell you everything. What you're curious about, what you're confused about, anything you can't work out in your little brain. I can explain it all.
库玛尔：来吧，你还想知道什么——我现在都可以告诉你。你好奇的，你困惑的，你那小脑袋瓜儿永远琢磨不出来的事儿，我现在都可以告诉你了。

She smiles warmly, but her words are as cold as usual.
她温柔地笑着，话语却是令人熟悉的刻薄。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Hasn't the idea that I might locate you bothered you for even a second?
伽菈波那：你就不怕我找到你吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa takes a tentative step forward.
伽菈波那试探性地靠近一步。

Kumar: Locate me? Hahaha. You are still as naive as a child, my Kaalaa Baunaa. You little dummy owl. That is simply impossible.
库玛尔：找到我？哈哈哈——哦！你还是像纸一样纯真，我的伽菈波那。脑筋不够灵活的小家伙——不可能的。

Kaalaa Baunaa: This is the first time you doubt my capability.
伽菈波那：——这是你第一次质疑我的能力。

Kumar: No, why would I do that? Of all the students, you are the only child who is smart enough to follow my steps this far.
库玛尔：不，我怎么会质疑你的能力——你是唯一能赶上我脚步的孩子。

Kumar: You just don't have time on your side and need a better mindset in dealing with the unexpected.
库玛尔：你只是……缺少了一点时间，以及缺乏了一点——良好的心态。

Kumar: I've tried to teach it to you. Remember those impromptu speeches I asked you to give? Those were good practice.
库玛尔：我早就试图纠正过这些，一些即兴演讲，你记得吗？很好的锻炼……

Kaalaa Baunaa: "Don't have ..." What do you mean?
伽菈波那：……你……什么意思?

Kumar: Perhaps you have put too much stock in the idea that I will rely on Manus Vindictae in this. Instead, I trust myself more than them. And, of course, I also trust you.
库玛尔：你或许太相信我会依靠重塑了。比起重塑，我更信任自己的手段——当然也更信任你。

Kumar: What's more, they were never good enough for me. But luckily, I have never been a real arcanist or a real human, only pretending to be either of them when necessary. I can easily act like an arcanist to gain their trust, just like I could act like a human when I was teaching at Banner.
库玛尔：……更何况我也看不上那些家伙。但好在我什么都不像，又最习惯于伪装——就像我当初在班纳尔大学当教授的时候一样。

Kumar notices that Kaalaa Baunaa has been staring at the old finderscope.
库玛尔注意到伽菈波那一直盯着那个老式望远镜。

Kumar: What are you staring at? Take it if you're interested.
库玛尔：你怎么老看着这个？拿给你好了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

Kumar takes off the finderscope and throws it lightly to Kaalaa Baunaa. It lands precisely on her palm.
女人轻巧一抛，被她摘下的寻星镜稳稳当当地落在了伽菈波那的手中。

The surroundings remain the same. Kaalaa Baunaa can't find any loopholes at all.
周围仍是不变的景色。看不出任何端倪。

Kumar: What? You thought it is the key to cracking the Meditator's Realm, like those stone statues earlier?
库玛尔：怎么？你以为它像那些石像一样，是击破幻境的核心处？

Kumar: Though it is too late for hints, there is one thing I have to remind you of.
库玛尔：虽然有点晚了，但我现在纠正你一点。

She is indeed as thoughtful as she claims to be.
她就像她说的一样，十分贴心。

Kumar: You didn't catch up to "the real me," nor did you improve the situation by entering the Realm. You chased me all the way here, chased the hope of "winning" against me, but you only helped me complete my plan.
库玛尔：你没有追上“我”，也没有做出最优抉择……你只是追着那个名为“获胜”的饵一直走到了现在，帮我达成了我想要达成的一切。

Kumar: The moment you entered the Realm, the last step of my plan was done.
库玛尔：——从你进来的那一刻起，我的目的就已经达到了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I completed what?
伽菈波那：帮你……什么……？

Kumar: As you know, exerting influence on reality through the Meditator's Realm is challenging. After all, this Realm is like the shadow of its real counterpart, a reflection of reality.
库玛尔：你也知道，想要让幻境影响现实是很难的，毕竟，它就如同现实世界的倒影……

Kumar: I went to a lot of trouble, even wasted a statue, to finally stick out a corner of the shadow over the boundary of the two worlds.
库玛尔：我费了好大力气，浪费了一尊神像——才让里面的东西，伸出一点点影子来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You mean the statue in the cave ...
伽菈波那：你是说，石窟里的……

Kumar: Yes.
库玛尔：是的。

Kumar: What I needed was an outside-in force to break the Realm, which is almost unbreakable from the inside.
库玛尔：而我需要的，是一个由外向内的力，彻底帮我打破这层难以单向冲破的薄膜。

Kumar: A mirror can reflect objects, but there's nothing it can do to itself. It can only be shattered into pieces by people not from the reflection, but reality.
库玛尔：毕竟镜子所映之物的能力有限，但如果镜子之外的现实有人来击碎它……那一切就容易得多了。

Kumar: Whenever there is a shooting star streaking across the sky of this Realm,
库玛尔：——这样幻境中的流星坠落之时……

Kumar: an equally beautiful star will fall on the real earth!
库玛尔：在我们的现实世界，也会有一颗同样美丽的星星落下！

Kumar: And guess what? YOU are the force I'm looking for.
库玛尔：而这个击碎镜子的外力，真巧！正是现在你所做的这件事情。

Kaalaa Baunaa: No. How?
伽菈波那：不，怎么会……

Kaalaa Baunaa: So the fluctuation I detected, the energy of the celestial body felt by the Foundation girl ... are just false alert?
伽菈波那：所以我观测到的波动，甚至是那个基金会小女孩感受到的天体能量……那些只是幌子……

Kumar: Oh, no, I have to admit, that young girl was not part of my plan. But, at least, you are on the right track about what happened!
库玛尔：哦不，我得承认，那个小姑娘的到来属于意外事件……不过——你理解得非常正确！

Kumar: If anything is to blame, it's your ego. You were trying to win, but not by saving people. The idea of proving yourself to me outweighed their lives.
库玛尔：要怪就怪你自己的——冠冕堂皇。你的救人之心终究输给了与我竞争之心——人命在你心里……并不如在我面前证明你自己重要。

Kumar: You must be wondering, "How could she lay such a trap with her insignificant arcane power"?
库玛尔：我想像得到你有多么努力地在说服自己。

Kumar: "She can barely lift a lump of clay. She must have had the Manus Vindictae on her side to help!"
库玛尔：但你知道吗？其实你在想："哦！库玛尔的神秘术连抬起个土块儿都困难，又哪里有能力做那些精巧的局呢？一定是依靠了重塑！"

Kumar: All that being said, you don't have to feel yourself to be a lesser version of me. You're still my best student, my best colleague, and my strongest rival—well, with some room to improve.
库玛尔：别对自己这么没自信，你仍旧是我最好的学生——差那么一丁点智慧就能和我同台竞技的好同事。

Kumar: Even this time, you didn't lose the game for lack of wits, but for the fact that I know you a bit better than you know me,
库玛尔：这次你也没输给我的智慧——而是输给了一点我对你的了解。

Kumar: and I simply have more experience hunting a prey.
库玛尔：……以及捕猎者的经验罢了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You and the Manus ... I've never, never thought that.
伽菈波那：我在此之前，从未……从未将重塑与你……

Kaalaa Baunaa feels her explanation is meaningless and stuck in her throat. She's almost choking for breath in the gentle breeze.
无意义的辩白被堵在喉咙里，在天文塔顶端的微风中，伽菈波那觉得自己的呼吸震耳欲聋。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That means if I didn't enter the Realm to see you ...
伽菈波那：所以，所以如果我这次没有来见你——

Kumar: Then things are going to be tricky for me. You would be enjoying a happy Dīpa Festival, while I would be crying in a dark corner nobody knows of.
库玛尔：那我就棘手了。你们将享受一个快乐的烛星节，而我只能在你们不知道的阴暗角落里，哭丧着脸认输。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Why? Why would you ...?
伽菈波那：你，你为什么——

Kumar: Well, time's up. Remember to ask the most important question first next time, child.
库玛尔：哦，时间差不多了。这么重要的问题，下次记得早问，孩子。

Kumar: Don't thank me for that suggestion, and don't think too much of my kindness. I didn't explain all these things for your sake. I told you everything, because only by doing so can I enjoy the victory to its fullest. Your desperation is a good prize for me.
库玛尔：不用感谢我的贴心，也别自作多情，解释这么多并不是为了你——我只是想要彻底的胜利。而你的绝望，正包含在这份胜利之内。

Kumar: You know I have a bad taste for entertainment.
库玛尔：——你也知道，我的个人趣味向来烂得离谱。

Kumar: Go back to the Dīpa Festival. At least there's one good thing left for you—you will get to see that beautiful shooting star with your own eyes, just like I will.
库玛尔：回去享受你们的烛星节吧——好消息是你们也能和我一样，能亲眼见见那颗漂亮的星星长什么样子了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那：……！

Kumar: Goodbye.
库玛尔：<再见啦。>

3#10
3#9

硕鼠的智慧
Rat and Its Days JMP-11

Kanjira: Hmm. My ankle hurts no more!
坎吉拉：唔……我的脚已经不痛了！

Kanjira tries to move the tightly wrapped ankle.
坎吉拉试探性地活动了下被包扎得严严实实的脚踝。

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Shamane is sitting under the sacred fig, and Matilda is anxiously walking round and round the vat. Neither of them is in the mood to check Kanjira's ankle.
然而无论是菩提树下盘膝而坐的男人，还是绕着陶缸不停打转的女孩——他们都没能分出精力去看一眼那个已经康复了的脚踝。

Matilda: She's been in there for, emm, 4 minutes 26 seconds.
玛蒂尔达：她已经，已经进去了——四分二十六秒……

Matilda: Is this a reasonable length of time? I remember I once learned about the ideal time length for meditation in one of the elective classes.
玛蒂尔达：唔，这是合理的数字吗？我记得选修课有提及过冥想的最佳时间……

Matilda: What's more, she's holding her breath underwater.
玛蒂尔达：而且，伽菈波那小姐是在水下……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane closes his eyes.
树下的男人双眼微阖。

The noise of people, the footsteps, and the light cracks coming from the inside of the tree gradually turn into the crackle of flames.
喧闹声、脚步声、树干深处难以忽视的龟裂声，逐渐变成了熟悉的、火焰迸裂的噼啪声。

When there is only one way to the destination, you have no choice but to take it.
当通往对岸的道路，只有一条独木桥的时候……你很难再去选择其他的路程。

Pain is coming from his scar of the mutilation, which healed up long ago.
早已愈合的断肢处传来隐痛。

You have to force yourself to take that painful step, and then blame yourself for being such a desperate fool to move and lose balance.
你不得不让自己迈出那痛苦的一步，然后在意料之内的重心偏移中，抱着绝望叱责自己的愚蠢。

Who has never made a mistake?
是的，毕竟谁没跌过跤呢?

There was a time when he was just like them.
想必那时的自己，有着与她们同样的目光。

If he had chosen the other path, the sacred fig wouldn't have died, and they would be sitting in its shade.
如果没有走上错误的独木桥，菩提树早应枝繁叶茂，投下庇护的浓荫。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾: ……

But who says that would be the better future?
——可又是否应以未至的“美好”来界定过去的对错呢?

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾: ……

But the silver lining is, it's just a stagger on the solid ground.
但好在接下来你将重新落回坚实的土地。

And you will eventually regain your footing.
站稳自己的脚跟。

Kaalaa Baunaa: *coughs*
伽菈波那: 咳咳，咳咳咳——

The vat bursts into pieces after the five-minute silence. The water splashes onto the ground, like strange shadows cast in all directions.
沉寂了五分钟的陶缸倏然迸裂。水泄向四周，像是中央那个狼狈身影投射出的影子。

Matilda: ...! Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa!
玛蒂尔达: ——！伽菈波那小姐！

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!
伽菈波那: ……!

The poor vat breaks into pieces. The muddy liquid spreads in all directions and covers the ground.
可怜的陶土缸变得四分五裂，浑浊的液体逐渐铺满整个地面。

Her wet hair is clinging to her tightly. She looks as miserable as a drowned rat.
女人的长发狼狈地贴在身上。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Leave here. *coughs* Now, and get everyone.
伽菈波那：快跑，咳咳——快，快带着所有人——呕——

She vomits in great pain, as if she could expel the regret from her body this way.
她痛苦地干呕着，似乎这样就能将悔恨连同呕吐物一起赶出这个躯壳。

Matilda: Did, did you see Kumar?! What happened?
玛蒂尔达：你，你成功见到库玛尔了?！这是……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm the one to blame. D**n it!
伽菈波那：我才是始作俑者……该死的……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm such a fool. I should have known that I'm not a match for Kumar.
伽菈波那：我——我太蠢了。我早该想到自己根本不是库玛尔的对手……

She knows what that means. If the boundary between the Realm and the reality is broken, that celestial body will fall on them in no time.
她知道那意味着什么——冲破了那层薄膜，就意味着那颗天体坠落的时间被缩短到了一个无法令人忽视的地步。

There's no easy way to forgive herself.
她痛苦地、无法自抑地评价着自己。

Maybe it will destroy them today, maybe in the next minute.
——或许就是今天，或许就是现在。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Keep telling myself I did all these things to save the people, to save the village. Turns out it was me fighting against a dummy she set up!
伽菈波那：说着为了救人，为了村子……到头来自己一个人……和她立的靶子打得起兴！

Kaalaa Baunaa: I messed up everything for everyone.
伽菈波那：把大家都……害了……

She looks at her fingers. The nails have sunk into the soft ground.
她看着自己的手指，指甲陷入松软的地面。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

A wrinkled piece of coarse cloth comes into her sight.
视野内出现的，是一块皱皱巴巴的粗布。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm sorry.
伽菈波那：……对不起。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I should have listened to you.
伽菈波那：我应该听你的。

She lowers her head even more.
她的头压得更低了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If I were more sensible and just left this path, this stupid d**n "trap," nothing would have turned out this way.
伽菈波那：如果我更理智一点……放弃这条不可理喻的道路，不去尝试什么该死的“陷阱”……一切就都不会变成现在这个样子。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane: Oh, is that how you see it?
鬃毛沙砾：哦，你是这样想的?

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: I assume you think it this way because you have failed in the mission and thus feel depressed and indulge yourself in some negative thinking.
鬃毛沙砾：你说出这种话，有两种可能性。要么，这只是一次失败之后颓丧的违心之言——

Shamane: Which is totally understandable. Blaming it all on yourself, telling yourself you will be the only one to suffer the consequence so as to alleviate the guilt. Or, you didn't understand what I said to you earlier at all.
鬃毛沙砾：可以理解，把一切问题揽在自己身上，确实可以让自己的愧疚之心好受一点。要么，就是你完全没听明白我的意思～

Kaalaa Baunaa: What?
伽菈波那：什……么?

She looks up with confusion, wondering if that relaxed tone is another illusion.
女人诧异地抬起头来，只觉得那轻松的语气仿佛是自己的幻觉。

Shamane: You have to stop it, Kaalaa Baunaa. Remember what I said? "You don't have to feel bad for trusting people." And here's another piece: Don't blame yourself for being brave.
鬃毛沙砾：别这么说，伽菈波那。还记得我说的吗？——你无需为自己的信任懊恼。同样，也不要因勇敢而谴责自己。

Shamane: What did she tell you? "You're a fool, and you ruined everything"?
鬃毛沙砾：她是怎么说的？说是因为你的愚蠢才让大家都倒了霉?

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

He crouches down and looks straight at his reflection in her eyes.
男人蹲下身，直视着对方眼中的自己。

Shamane: Come on! Both of us know this is not the case.
鬃毛沙砾：得了吧！你我都知道，这不是事实。

Shamane: Brave or reckless, prudent or cowardly ... Comments like these could be predictions, but most of the time are hindsight.
鬃毛沙砾：勇敢还是鲁莽，谨慎还是退缩——这不全是行动前的定义，更多时候，它们是一切发生后，他人的总结。

Shamane: The good news is, we still have time to change that.
鬃毛沙砾：好消息是，现在……还没到总结的时候。

Shamane: You know what kind of bears the hunters fear the most? The ones which were once trapped but eventually got away.
鬃毛沙砾：要知道，被捕兽夹伤过的熊，是最令猎人恐惧的存在。

Shamane: Nobody can remain a predator forever. We don't know what will happen in the next encounter. What's more ...
鬃毛沙砾：——无人能永恒立于捕猎者的位置之上，况且……

Shamane: Life is a long fight where we outsmart one opponent and get outsmarted by the other. That's the wisdom of nature! Bears eat salmon; wolves eat rabbit; but eventually, bears or wolves, their skin will become our blankets.
鬃毛沙砾：算计，说白了也是自然发展的一环！熊吃鲑鱼，狼食幼兔，而它们的皮毛到最后都会变成我们最柔软的毯子。

Shamane: A tiger might have strength, yet a rat also has its wits. You don't need to defeat her to validate your victory. You can win this war in another way, a way to your advantage.
鬃毛沙砾：老虎有老虎的力量，硕鼠有硕鼠的智慧——你的胜利，不需要建立在她败北之上。

Shamane: When will the wrestling between a fisherman and a fish begin? When the fish bites the bait.
鬃毛沙砾：咬饵之后，才是角力的开始。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane: So, if you still have some strength left in you to get back on your feet and think straight, that'd be most helpful. After all, I don't think we have the time for another round of meditation.
鬃毛沙砾：所以如果你现在还站得起来，能厘清我们现在的状况——那就帮大忙了，毕竟听你的语气，我们不像是有继续冥想的时间了……

Kaalaa Baunaa takes the cloth.
伽菈波那接过了那块粗布。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

She buries her face into it, wiping hard across her eyes—the pain brings her senses back.
她将脸埋入其中，狠狠地将它自眼眶抹过——脸上传来的刺痛教人立刻清醒过来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: The last time I wiped my face with this, I was wrestling with my mom.
伽菈波那：上次用这样的东西擦脸，我还在和妈妈练习摔跤呢……

She takes a deep breath, trying to get her brain working again.
她深吸一口气，试着让理智重新夺回大脑的控制权。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar ... She broke the boundary between the Meditator's Realm and reality through me. I'm afraid the falling star will arrive early.
伽菈波那：库玛尔……利用我打破了幻境与现实的界线，坠星很可能要提前了。

Matilda: What?! There's no other way to stop her, then?
玛蒂尔达：什么?！就没什么办法能阻止她吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa: There might be a way to stop her by locating her in person, but I didn't spot any clue in the Realm. And now ...
伽菈波那：如果能找到她本人……或许还有转圜的余地。但很抱歉，我在幻境中没有发现任何线索，现在——

Shamane: We are in a dangerous situation, almost as urgent as the time when Rama was facing the arrow nocked to a full bow. Instead of getting caught up in nostalgia, we should take action and protect what can be saved.
鬃毛沙砾：而现在，这种像是被罗摩用弓指着一样的危机状况……比起留恋这个地方，不如早点保住那些我们能保住的东西。

Matilda: The estimated arrival time of the Foundation backup is 6 a.m. It will be too late if the meteor really falls early.
玛蒂尔达：基金会给出的预计到达时间是……凌晨六时！唔，如果流星提前降落的话，这时间肯定不够……

Matilda: We need a shelter that can withstand the impact! Also, we have to gather all the villagers.
玛蒂尔达：我们需要一个能抵挡——或者躲避流星的地方！除此之外，还要先把落单的村民集中起来。

Matilda: And, and ... Ah! In the field training, the instructor also told us to ...
玛蒂尔达：还有，还有……呜！实战演练的课程还教过我们……

Kanjira: I'll go with you!
坎吉拉：我也要和你们一起去！

Kanjira staggers her way to them.
黑发女孩一瘸一拐地走上前来。

Kanjira: I'll go with you. I know the way better! Besides, Sherjah is not back yet.
坎吉拉：我和你们一起去……我更熟悉路程！况且……夏尔贾还没回来……

Kanjira: If anything happens to she, I will not forgive myself I say those words.
坎吉拉：如果她真出了什么事……我绝对不会原谅那时候的自己。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Hmm.
伽菈波那：……唔。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm staying.
伽菈波那：我要留在这里。

Kanjira: Hmm?
坎吉拉：嗯？

Kaalaa Baunaa: If I can calculate the range of damage of the comet, we may retreat to a safe location.
伽菈波那：如果可以计算彗星的伤害范围……我们或许能在彗星到来之前，撤到一个安全的位置。

Kaalaa Baunaa flings her wet hair back.
女人把湿漉漉的长发向后一甩。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Every rat has its day.
伽菈波那：硕鼠有……硕鼠的智慧。

Kaalaa Baunaa: And "this rat" is doing her best.
伽菈波那：……我在尽力尝试了。

Shamane: Hahaha! Don't put on a face like that. You are not some rat, I can tell! You are the tiger cub. In the meantime, let's not forget—the real rat is still out there looking smug!
鬃毛沙砾：哈！别摆出这副表情——你可不是什么硕鼠，我瞧得出，你是货真价实的虎崽子……真正的硕鼠可在门外溜达着呢！

It is predictable that there will be a long-term battle outside the stone door enchanted with protection incantations.
镌刻着层层保护咒的石门外，是一场预料之内的长线战斗。

Shamane turns around and rubs his hands, feeling a bit uneasy.
他转过身去，有点局促地搓了搓手。

Shamane: Watch out for the things I knock off. I didn't do it on purpose!
鬃毛沙砾：记得躲着点我打飞出去的东西——呃，很多时候，我真的不是故意的！

3#1
3#10

以卵击石
Straws Against the Wind JMP-12

Street
街道

Ms. Sherjah: *exhales*
夏尔贾老师： 呼——

The last butter lamp has been blown out by the quiet breath.
随着轻微的吐息，最后一盏星烛也熄灭了。

Darkness falls on the people who are still in hiding.
掩体背后，黑暗笼罩了下来。

Ms. Sherjah: We are safe as long as they can't find us.
夏尔贾老师： 只要不被他们发现，目前我们就是安全的……

Sherjah hides the fainted woman and the girl in the shadow to keep them safe.
年轻女人将昏倒的妇人与女孩安顿在安全的阴影之后。

Jina: *sobs* Ms. Sherjah, I'm scared.
吉娜： 呜呜……夏尔贾老师，我害怕……

Jina holds Sherjah's hand so tightly, as she is the only lifesaver now.
女孩死死地握住了女人的手，如同抓着一棵救命稻草。

Ms. Sherjah: Relax, Jina. Remember what Dad and Grandpa said? Just wait here, and they will be back soon. Your brother is also helping them out.
夏尔贾老师： 不要害怕，吉娜。爸爸和爷爷不是和你说了吗？在这里好好等着，他们很快就回来，你哥哥也在帮忙……

Jina: *sobs* But those monsters are terrifying. Even, even Mother ...
吉娜： 呜呜，可是……那些怪物好恐怖……妈妈，妈妈也……

Ms. Sherjah: Hmm.
夏尔贾老师： ……唔。

Recalling the tragic scene, Sherjah can't help closing her eyes.
女人回忆起目睹的惨状，不禁闭上了双眼。

Ms. Sherjah: Mother just passed out. Don't worry. She will ...
夏尔贾老师： 妈妈只是暂时晕过去了，你放心，她很快就……

Rajesh: D**n it! F**king monsters!
村民： 可恶，该死的怪物！

Manus Disciple: AAARRRHHHH!
重塑·门徒： 幺幺——！

The man casts an incantation while wielding the ram-dao to keep the monsters away.
男人念着咒语，舞动弯刀，试图与对面的怪物拉开距离。

Takal: Humph! Filthy maggots!
老年村民： 哼，肮脏的东西！

Rajesh: Father! There are still a lot of them.
村民： 父亲！他们的数量根本不见少……

Takal: Don't be such a coward, Rajesh. Be a man! Humph! Can't believe we are even counting on a human girl now.
老年村民： 别窝窝囊囊的，拉杰什！拿出点男子汉的样儿来，哼，还要拜托人类小姑娘来帮我们……

The ram-dao cuts through the air. An arm covered in black slime falls to the ground.
弯刀向前飞去，一只带着黑色黏稠液体的手应声落地。

Manus Disciple: UUUGGGHHHH!
重塑·门徒： ㄝˋ……

Takal: Shame on us! *coughs*
老年村民： 真是丢脸！咳咳……

Rajesh: Father, watch out!
村民： 父亲，小心——

Manus Disciple: AAARRRHHHH!
重塑·门徒： ㄡ——！！

Ms. Sherjah: Sir! Watch your back!
夏尔贾老师： ——老先生，小心背后！

The body acts before the mind. The moment Sherjah exposes herself and rushes into the light, her senses scream to warn her of the danger.
身体比头脑先一步行动。冲出阴影的一瞬间，脑中的理性已发出了危险信号。

Ms. Sherjah: ...!
夏尔贾老师： ……！

Manus Disciple: EEERRRHHHH!
重塑·门徒： ㄡ ㄠˋ——

There is no doubt a bare-handed human challenging a group of Manus followers is throwing straws against the wind.
赤手空拳的人类对上重塑神秘学家——注定是以卵击石。

Shamane: Hah!
鬃毛沙砾： 嗬——

The last Manus follower falls to the ground, the mask broken in half.
最后一位重塑门徒应声倒地，连面具都碎成了可怜的两瓣。

Shamane freezes, his fist still in the air. Even he himself doesn't realize what has happened.
——而男人维持着举着拳头的动作，显然连自己都没反应过来。

Shamane: Oh, boy! That was close!
鬃毛沙砾： 噢，真是……吓我一跳。

He looks down and meets Sherjah's equally confused eyes.
他低下头，对上夏尔贾同样有些惊惶的视线。

Shamane: Ah, Ms. Sherjah, I admire you for your courage, but this is getting a bit too nerve-racking.
鬃毛沙砾： 呼——！夏尔贾女士，我虽然很钦佩你的勇气，但这实在是有点太刺激了……

He withdraws his arm, a bit scared by what has happened.
他收回手臂，心有余悸地擦了把汗。

Kanjira: Ms. Sherjah!
坎吉拉： 夏尔贾！

Ms. Sherjah: Kanjira? Wait, how did you find this place?
夏尔贾老师： 坎吉拉……？还有——你们怎么找到这里的！

Kanjira: Sorry, Ms. Sherjah. I should not is mad at you! That scares me so ...
坎吉拉： 对不起，夏尔贾，我不该跟你发脾气的！刚刚真的……差点吓死我了……呜……

Ms. Sherjah: S-Sorry. I couldn't control myself, and my body just ...
夏尔贾老师：抱，抱歉……我身体不由自主地……

Takal: Hmm? Wait, young man!
老年村民：嗯？等等，你小子……

The old man grasps Shamane's left arm.
老年人一把抓住了鬃毛沙砾的左臂。

Takal: This arm ... You! You are the Sharma boy!
老年村民：这个手……你，你是那个沙尔玛家的！

Shamane: Hey! Aren't you Uncle Takal? It's been such a long time since we last met!
鬃毛沙砾：嘿！这不是卡塔尔叔叔吗——真是好久没见！

Takal: How, how did you ...
老年村民：你，你，你怎么——

The old man seems to be looking at a living ghost.
老人的表情像是见到了活着的亡魂。

Shamane: Oh, Uncle Takal, I wish I could talk to you for a bit more, but the situation seems to be less than ideal.
鬃毛沙砾：哦，卡塔尔叔叔，虽然我也很想和你们寒暄，但是情况稍微有那么一点紧急——

Warmly greeting the old man, he avoids the question.
他热情地避开了老人的疑问。

Shamane: To put it simply, this place is about to be smashed into an impact crater by a meteor. Even worse, the meteor will arrive here sooner than the Foundation's rescue.
鬃毛沙砾：简单来说，这个地方就快被陨石砸穿了～更坏一点的消息是，不出意外的话，意外会比基金会的救援先到——

Shamane: But, among all the unfortunate people, you are the lucky ones! You are the first group we found.
鬃毛沙砾：但你们运气真的很不错——你们是第一批被我们找到的幸运儿！

Shamane: Come on, get in, we will have a get-together at my place. Uncle Takal, you remember the way to our house, right?
鬃毛沙砾：来吧，上车，先去我的宅子里坐坐，我想卡塔尔叔叔甚至还记得路……

Takal: What?! That burned old house?! No way! I will never ...
老年村民：什么?！那幢被烧过的老宅?！不，我绝不会——

Shamane: Well, I will have to apologize to you for this then, Uncle. You must come with us, even if I have to tie you up and drag you there.
鬃毛沙砾：噢，那抱歉了，叔叔——这次就算是用绑的，我也要给您绑过去。

Takal: No! Stop it! You deviant brat!
老年村民：不——别——！你这大逆不道的小子——

The villagers are pushed into the tuk tuk with their complaints.
村民们与他们的嘟囔声一起被塞进了车里。

Shamane: Alright. I'm glad to see that you're fine, Ms. Sherjah. We are in dire need of a helping hand.
鬃毛沙砾：好了——总之很高兴看到你没事，夏尔贾女士，但是抱歉，我们目前需要你的帮助。

Kanjira: Ms. Sherjah, I remember you know this place well!
坎吉拉：夏尔贾，我记得你很熟悉这里！

Ms. Sherjah: Yes, I do.
夏尔贾老师： 是，是这样……

Shamane: We need to transfer everyone here—humans and arcanists—to a safe place.
鬃毛沙砾： 我们现在要把所有人——无论是人类还是神秘学家，都尽快转移到安全的地方。

Kanjira: And you're the best person to do that.
坎吉拉： 我想……你是最熟悉，也是最好的人选。

Ms. Sherjah: I ...
夏尔贾老师： 我……

Ms. Sherjah: ...
夏尔贾老师： ……

Ms. Sherjah: Alright. I'll do whatever I can, as long as it helps.
夏尔贾老师： 没问题，只要能帮得上忙——我一定不遗余力。

Shamane: Wish my father could see this. Isn't she a lot more reliable than I am?
鬃毛沙砾： 噢，真该让我父亲瞧瞧……这可比我可靠多了！

Shamane: Told the old man a million times that humans make more decent work partners than arcanists. *sighs*
鬃毛沙砾： 我早说过人类比神秘学家靠谱得多——唉。

Matilda: Hurry up, you people!
玛蒂尔达： ——别傻站着啦！

Matilda opens the door and urges them to get in.
玛蒂尔达打开车门，着急地催促他们上车。

Matilda: You can chat later!
玛蒂尔达： 嘿，快一点，你们几个！可没时间磨磨蹭蹭的！

Shamane: I hear you. Sherjah, please briefly tell us what the neighborhood is like. We need to pick up everyone in the town as soon as possible.
鬃毛沙砾： 好的——夏尔贾，麻烦你简单描述下周围的情况。我们需要尽快接到所有的人。

Shamane: We need to find the quickest way to do it and avoid all the enemies on the way.
鬃毛沙砾： 而我们要注意规划出最优的路线——尽可能地避开路上的那些怪家伙。

Shamane: Hey, relax. We can't run away from them—we will just run over them!
鬃毛沙砾： 放轻松，如果实在避不开——我们就从他们身上开过去！

3#1
3#1

芝麻开门
Open Sesame JMP-13

Inside the Sharma Old House
沙尔玛旧宅内

Kaalaa Baunaa: How is everything now?
伽菈波那： 现在情况怎么样?

Ms. Sherjah: Well, it's going smooth. The young people and tourists left as soon as I persuaded them. Only the old and the children are left here. It's not that easy for them to move, and ...
夏尔贾老师： 唔，效率很高。村子里的年轻人和游客早在我四处劝说的时候就离开得差不多了，现在的多是一些老人和无法远行的孩子，还有……

Ajar: Hey, you promised to give me half of it! Now what, the boss cannot keep her own promise?
阿贾尔：嘿，你说好分我一半的，坎吉拉大姐怎么还耍赖啊?

Kanjira: Humph! I do most messenger work! More food for more work!
坎吉拉：哼！我在外面跑了一天，当然做得多，吃得多啦！

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Ms. Sherjah: These kids were abandoned and driven away by humans. I'm glad to see Kanjira get along with them.
夏尔贾老师：这些因为是人类而被遗弃、赶出来的孩子……坎吉拉能和他们玩儿得这么好，我真的很高兴……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa looks down at the astrolabe in her hand.
伽菈波那垂眼看着手中的星盘。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If she could enjoy a life like this ...
伽菈波那：如果她曾经……

Ms. Sherjah: ...?
夏尔贾老师：……?

Kaalaa Baunaa: No. Nothing.
伽菈波那：不……没什么。

Kaalaa Baunaa chuckles. There's a faraway look on her face.
她轻轻笑了一下，神情有一瞬间的恍惚。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You just reminded me of my mother.
伽菈波那：我想起来了，我妈妈也是这样的人。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Sherjah, perhaps people like you are the key to saving all of us.
伽菈波那：……夏尔贾，或许像你们这样的人，才是拯救我们的关键。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I just observed it again. The figures are showing a grim picture. Luckily, I've worked out the specific range of damage.
伽菈波那：刚才我又尝试了一次观测。情况确实不容乐观，但好在我依然能根据这些计算出具体的数据。

She draws quite a large circle on the map.
女人在地图上画了个不小的圆圈。

Kaalaa Baunaa: As long as we can get out of this radius, there will be no casualties.
伽菈波那：只要我们能逃到这个范围外，就可以避开人员的伤亡……

Kaalaa Baunaa: As for other losses ... they are beyond my ability to cover.
伽菈波那：至于其他的损失……恐怕我就无能为力了。

Matilda: Emm.
玛蒂尔达：唔……

Matilda: The airship of the Foundation is on the way. At least our water supply is secured for now.
玛蒂尔达：基金会的飞艇已经在路上了，至少一定时间内不会缺少基础的水源补给。

Matilda: But the problem is, in such a distance ...
玛蒂尔达：可问题是，这样的距离……

She draws a straight line on the map lightly.
笔尖自地图上轻轻划过。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The distance ... Even if we follow the straight line, it is impossible for us, with the elders and the children, to get out of it within hours.
伽菈波那：这样的距离……就算是直线，我们带着老人和孩子也不可能在几小时内到达。

Matilda: Err, why! We are getting so close to success.
玛蒂尔达：呜……可恶，明明就差一点了……

Matilda: If only we could go underground ...
玛蒂尔达：要是能藏到地底下的话……！

Shamane: Underground? Wait!
鬃毛沙砾：地底下……？等下！

Shamane: I remember my old man told me about an emergency tunnel leading to the forest on the mountain. Its entrance is right here, beneath the floor of this very room.
鬃毛沙砾：我记得父亲曾教过我……在这间房子的下面，有一条连通着外部山林的隧道，目的就是为了应对灾难……

Kaalaa Baunaa: A tunnel?
伽菈波那：隧道?

Shamane: He told me this, hoping that one day I will take over his responsibility to look after the village. If I remember it correctly, that forest, which is also the exit of this tunnel, is right outside the impact area.
鬃毛沙砾：当时他教我这些，是为了让我以后能承担起管理村子的重任。如果我没记错，那片山林——刚好就在这片范围之外。

He taps on a spot outside the marked range with his rough finger.
粗糙的指尖在红色马克笔的范围外轻轻地点了两下。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's great. In the tunnel, even if we don't make it to the forest in time, we can still avoid the damage.
伽菈波那：这太好了……如果在隧道里的话，即便不足以及时赶到山林，我们也能避开陨石碎片造成的危险……

Shamane: But, but ...
鬃毛沙砾：但是——

He scratches his beard, hissing in embarrassment.
男人龇牙咧嘴地抓了抓胡子，脸上爬满了尴尬。

Shamane: The problem is there's a gate to the tunnel. Now, just for the record, I'm only quoting my old man.
鬃毛沙砾：问题在于，想要进入隧道，必须得通过一扇门——事先声明！这是我爸的原话……

Shamane: "It is a gate which only opens to the leader who has earned his people's trust."
鬃毛沙砾：“只有被子民信任着的领导者才能开启”……的门。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kanjira: Oh, "Open Sesame!" We is going real treasure hunting this time.
坎吉拉：哦哦，“芝麻开门”！这下真的是寻宝啦。

Out of the silence, only the naive child is excited.
沉默中，显然只有一无所知的孩童是快乐的。

Shamane: Oh, well. My father's version was hardly as exciting as "Open Sesame"! I didn't believe him even as a child!
鬃毛沙砾：噢，拜托，这真的很老土——即便在当年也很老土！我压根儿没信！

Shamane: I tried to open it by force many times. Well, it never worked!
鬃毛沙砾：所以我小时候不信邪，偷偷尝试过无数次——没一次成功的！

Shamane: If my old man was telling the truth, things would be problematic for us ...
鬃毛沙砾：当然，最坏的情况——就是我爸的话属实。

Shamane: Because I don't think I can get that gate open! Firstly, I've never wanted to be a leader, and speaking of "the people's trust" ... How do you think those cursing old men in the yard will feel about me?
鬃毛沙砾：那问题可就大了！我可不认为我能打开那扇门！首先，我的个人意愿不足，其次，他们的信任——听听庭院里那些老头子的骂街声吧！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Emm.
伽菈波那：唔……

Kaalaa Baunaa listens to "those cursing old men" for a while. She cannot contradict what he says.
伽菈波那侧耳倾听了片刻，承认他的话不无道理。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Even so ...
伽菈波那：即便如此……

She taps on the map, thinking.
她的手指在地图上轻轻点动，节奏越来越快。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: We will open that gate.
伽菈波那：我们要想办法把那扇门打开。

She looks up at Shamane. He is standing in silence and has a blank look on his face.
她抬头，望向一旁呆立的男人。

Shamane: ...?
鬃毛沙砾：……?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Even if we have to smash it with our bare fists.
伽菈波那：哪怕是用拳头捶……?

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane: I'm not sure if you were being sarcastic.
鬃毛沙砾：我不确定你这句是不是讽刺……

She doesn't give a clear answer. Instead, her eyes flit back to the map.
她不置可否，目光重新落回地图上。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's the best way in the current situation.
伽菈波那：这是目前，最好的办法了。

On the porch in front of the house, there is a loose floorboard.
庭院里侧的走廊上，有一处松动的地板——

Under it, they see some wooden stairs, which appear to be the entrance of a tunnel.
将它挪开，沿着木梯向下，便能抵达隧道的入口。

Ms. Sherjah: Watch your steps.
夏尔贾老师：注意脚下……

One after another, they slowly go down the stairs.
众人在引导下缓缓进入了深处。

In Front of the Stone Gate
石门前

The gray and yellow stone gate has a pattern of an elephant raising its front feet in the middle. It is as immovable as a real elephant.
厚重的灰黄色石门中央，象的前足高高扬起——并且纹丝不动。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Matilda: So the spell Shamane told us is truly useless.
玛蒂尔达：果然鬃毛沙砾说的咒语没什么效用啊。

Shamane: Hahaha, what did I say? This is never the gate for me to open.
鬃毛沙砾：哈哈，我早说过，这门从以前开始就和我无缘……

Shamane gives them an embarrassed smile. Behind him, the criticism comes as expected.
他略带尴尬地笑了笑。而身后，意料中的批判如期而至。

Takal: Tsk, I knew we shouldn't have counted on you, Sharma boy. You can't even protect your own family. How are you supposed to protect others?
老年村民：嗤，沙尔玛家的小子能让人有什么指望……连自己家都保护不好，还来管别人的死活吗?

Villager 2: May the gods listen to my prayer and send us another guide ...
村民：噢，愿众神聆听我的祈祷，再次给予我们指引者……

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Oh, here they come again! The complaints Shamane has heard so many times. Those familiar syllables make him almost—nostalgic.
瞧瞧，可以将人耳朵磨出老茧的抱怨，甚至音节都令人充满了——怀念。

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Kanjira is tapping a foot faster and faster—it's getting hard for her to suppress the anger.
坎吉拉点着脚尖，节奏越来越快——这是不耐烦的表现。

Takal: After dealing with humans all these years, we are already ...
老年村民：和人类接触那么多，我们已经……

Kanjira: ...
坎吉拉：……

Kanjira: You!
坎吉拉：你们……!

Kanjira: SHUT UP YOUR MOUTHS!!
坎吉拉：——都给我闭嘴啦!!

Shamane: ...!
鬃毛沙砾：……!

Villagers: ...!
众村民：……!

The crowd instantly falls into silence.
人群瞬间鸦雀无声。

The spell of "nostalgia" is broken. Shamane lowers his head, surprised by her irritation.
怀念的氛围烟消云散，男人低头，女孩脸上的烦躁还未完全散去。

Kanjira: All you talk about is protect, family, and stuff. Give me a break!
坎吉拉：天天就这么两句话，念念叨叨的烦不烦！

Kanjira: And YOU!
坎吉拉：还有你！

Shamane: Emm? Me?
鬃毛沙砾：呃，啊？……我？

Shamane points at his own nose, brought up short.
男人一愣，伸出手指着自己的鼻子。

Kanjira: Yes, you!
坎吉拉：对，就是你！

Shamane: W-what about me?
鬃毛沙砾：我，我怎么……

Kanjira throws back her head and glares at him.
女孩扬起头看着他。

Kanjira: You love talking, don't you? Now you go dumb? Humph! Big guy can't defend yourself!
坎吉拉：你平常不是话挺多的嘛，怎么现在倒是这么安静？哼……白长这么大块头……

Kanjira: I just don't understand. You feel bad. You say it. Why is you afraid?
坎吉拉：我真是搞不懂你，有不满就说出来啊，你在怕什么？

Kanjira: You don't owe them!
坎吉拉：你又不欠他们的！

Kanjira: See?
坎吉拉：你看——

Kanjira extends a finger at the hushed crowd.
她伸出手，指着鸦雀无声的人群。

Kanjira: You talk, and you shut them up!
坎吉拉：你明明可以让他们闭嘴的！

Shamane follows her pointing finger and looks at the familiar faces.
鬃毛顺着她的手指望向那些熟悉的面孔。

He suddenly realizes that, after all these years, he still remembers each of them clearly.
他突然意识到，即便过了这么多年……他仍没忘记他们，哪怕一星半点。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

There is no longer anger or disdain in their eyes. They just remain silent and avoid his gaze.
曾经那些目光咄咄逼人，但如今，他们只是沉默着，避开了他的目光。

Kanjira: Why don't you do this earlier? We need to focus on the most important thing!
坎吉拉：喏，早这样不就好了?！我们应该把精力放到、放到最重要的事情上去！

Kanjira: It's "Open Sesame" story!
坎吉拉：这可是“芝麻开门”啊！

Kanjira mumbles admiringly.
坎吉拉满脸羡慕地嘟囔着。

Kanjira: In the story, only the most smart and wise people can open it! Why do you hesitate now?
坎吉拉：故事里，只有最聪明、最智慧的人才能打开它！怎么你反而在这里犹犹豫豫的……

Shamane: Haha ...
鬃毛沙砾：哈哈……

Shamane laughs, as if she has said something most amusing.
像是看到了什么有趣的故事，鬃毛沙砾笑出声来。

Shamane: Little one, you think I'm the smartest and wisest person?
鬃毛沙砾：小家伙，你觉得我是最聪明、最智慧的人？

Kanjira: Er, no.
坎吉拉：唔，我不觉得。

Shamane: Oh.
鬃毛沙砾：噢。

His laugh stops.
意料之外的回答让他垮下脸来。

Kanjira: But why ask me? It is your gate!
坎吉拉：但你为什么要问我？这是属于你的门呀！

Shamane: ...!
鬃毛沙砾：……！

Kanjira: My answer don't matter. Their answer don't matter, too. That's why I said you should shut them up!
坎吉拉：我的观点不重要，他们的观点也不重要——所以我才说，你应该及时让他们闭嘴啦。

Kanjira rolls her eyes.
坎吉拉翻了个白眼。

Kanjira: There will be a gate for me, and I will open it my way!
坎吉拉：总会有故事为我准备一扇门的……到时候，我会用我的方式打开它！

Kanjira: I'm the one to decide how to open my gate. My spell will be longer and cooler than some "Open Sesame."
坎吉拉：哼，能决定怎么开门的人，只有我自己……我的咒语肯定比“芝麻开门”更长——更酷——

Kanjira: I'm not jealous you!
坎吉拉：我才不羡慕你呢！

She turns her back to him, refusing to cast a look at him.
她赌气一般地背过身去，不再看鬃毛沙砾。

Shamane: Haha ... *sighs* Interesting! Looks like Dad was right. I'm not qualified to be a leader.
鬃毛沙砾：……哈，哈哈哈哈……唉，真有意思……看来我爸说得对，我可没什么做领头羊的天赋。

Shamane: Thanks, kid.
鬃毛沙砾：谢谢啦，孩子。

Shamane: Phew!
鬃毛沙砾：……呼！

Shamane: Anyway, times have changed. Forget the spell.
鬃毛沙砾：是时候让这些咒语见鬼去了。

That's his father's gate, his father's path, his father's choice of life, and his father's responsibility.
对，那是他父亲的门，是他的道路，他的方式——他的责任。

Shamane: But it is I who am standing here, not him.
鬃毛沙砾：但现在站在这里的不是他。

He raises his voice.
他将声音抬高了些。

Shamane: Screw it. I have no idea what my father once promised you. In fact, I have no interest in what your old heads think.
鬃毛沙砾：我不知道我父亲以前承诺过你们什么——但是很抱歉，说到底，我对你们那些老掉牙的想法从始至终一点儿兴趣都没有……

Shamane: Hmm, but what's my own way of opening the gate?
鬃毛沙砾：唔，可我该做点什么不一样的呢？

Pick a new spell? Sing a song? Bleat like a goat?
选一句咒语？唱一首歌？学山羊叫？

His fist clenches. At this serious, crucial moment, he is strangely relieved by one sudden idea.
拳头攥紧，他莫名想起一句调侃。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

He doesn't need any implements. He can just do it with his bare hands, figuratively and literally.
对啊，哪怕是用拳头捶呢？

Shamane: Hahaha!
鬃毛沙砾：哈哈！

Shamane: And the one standing right here right now is me, not another Sharma.
鬃毛沙砾：没错，现在站在这里的是我——而不是一个新的沙尔玛。

Keep the shoulder loose, stay steady, and engage with the upper arm.
肩膀放松，站稳脚跟，上臂发力。

This is his way.
这才是他更擅长的事。

Shamane: That is to say ...
鬃毛沙砾：所以啊——

Shamane: Hah!
鬃毛沙砾：嗬！

This is the easiest punch he has ever thrown.
那是他有史以来挥出的，最轻松的一拳。

The burden from the past, the pain, and the stress are thrown out of his body at this moment.
似乎所有的包袱都在挥出的那一瞬间远离了他……那些早已放置在脚下的过去也随着这完美的弧线，彻底离开了他的视野。

Oh! Turns out the gate ...
噢……这扇门。

... is much more fragile than I thought.
原来这样脆弱。

Forest on the Backslope
后山森林

It's a quiet night in the forest. A bonfire is lit in a small, open space.
夜晚的山林静谧，其间一块不大的空地上燃起了几丛篝火。

Ajar: "That is to say, I'll smash that door open, even if it takes the other arm of mine!"
阿贾尔：所以啊——这门今天我就算是捶，也会给它一拳捶开——！

Villager 3: Yes! That's what I'm talking about. So cool!
年轻村民：哦！就是这里——好酷哦！

As the stick pokes the bonfire, a clear snap can be heard.
木棍轻轻一拨，篝火发出了清脆的噼啪声。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I guess you didn't see that coming?
伽菈波那：看来蛮力破门在你的意料之外?

Shamane: To tell the truth, I had prepared myself to bounce off from that closed gate, like what had happened many times when I was a kid.
鬃毛沙砾：实不相瞒，我都做好被那扇大门弹开的准备了，就像我小时候一样四脚朝天……

Shamane: But, wow, see how I burst it open? That was cool.
鬃毛沙砾：但是，哇，回想起来，我自己也觉得当时真是太酷了——

He throws a few punches in the air excitedly.
男人兴奋地举起拳头，对着空气一阵手舞足蹈。

Shamane: Ho! Ho! Ha ...! Ah!
鬃毛沙砾：嗬！嗬！哈——！哦！

He takes back his fist, content, and casually pokes the fire.
他心满意足似的收回拳头，又轻轻拨弄了一下篝火。

Shamane: So, in the end, my dad was just telling nonsense to a kid.
鬃毛沙砾：不过看来我爸的确是在哄小孩。

The flame is dancing in his eyes.
火苗在他的眼中跳跃着。

Shamane: Those so-called profound teachings, like one needs "adequate strength" or "a sense of responsibility" ...
鬃毛沙砾：一些故弄玄虚的教导……无非是什么“足够的力量!”或者“责任心!”之类的……

Shamane: Those were too abstract for a kid to understand. Ha, that's indeed his style!
鬃毛沙砾：这样拐弯抹角的表达方式，哈，确实是他会做的事!

Kaalaa Baunaa: But, in the end, the door was opened. That's for sure.
伽菈波那：但是那扇门确确实实地开启了。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's a good ending for a story. At least a million times better than mine.
伽菈波那：这是个不错的结果——比起我的结局来说，要好一万倍。

Shamane: Haha, you have a long way to go before reaching the end! But I'd say you're in a much better place now than you were in the beginning.
鬃毛沙砾：哈哈，你离结局还早着呢！看你目前的状态，我觉得倒比最开始那副绷得紧紧的模样要好多了!

Shamane: It's good progress. Trust me.
鬃毛沙砾：可喜可贺，可喜可贺……

Observed from the top of the mountain, the old village is only as small as half a palm.
老旧的村子自山林之上望下去，只有半个掌心的大小。

Shamane: He who only stays behind a closed door will turn away many things, including a chance to survive.
鬃毛沙砾：有遮蔽者，房门紧闭，将一切拒之门外……甚至是自己活命的机会。

Kanjira: Alright, alright! Best roast rabbit ever! Ms. Sherjah, you have the first bite!
坎吉拉：好啦好啦！绝妙的烤兔子！夏尔贾，给你吃第一口！

Kaalaa Baunaa: A person with no family yet radiates the warmth of family to others.
伽菈波那：无家之人……却拥有了属于自己的温暖。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: *sighs* ... If only Kumar had the slightest warmth from someone, maybe such an absurd thing would have never happened.
伽菈波那：……如果当初，有谁也给了库玛尔这样一个归宿，或许今天这样荒唐的事情就不会发生。

Shamane: I doubt she's upset about what happened. Maybe she has found herself a good seat to enjoy this dance of Shiva!
鬃毛沙砾：噢，我想她应该也不会太难过，没准儿正和咱们一样，坐在这样绝妙的角度，欣赏什么湿婆之舞呢！

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's true. She is the kind of person who always finds herself the best seat to watch the show.
伽菈波那：嗯，她确实会选择一个视野优良的观众席。

Shamane: But, I'm curious. Tell me, did she say anything bad about me?
鬃毛沙砾：比起那些，我更想知道的是，她当时有没有说我什么坏话啊?

Kaalaa Baunaa: That was not a part of our conversation. She just admitted that she was being vindictive.
伽菈波那：坏话倒是没有……她只是承认了自己的报复心理……

Kaalaa Baunaa slightly frowns, hoping to find some clues in the chaotic memories.
她微微皱眉，希望能从混乱的记忆中拾起碎片。

Kaalaa Baunaa: "Maybe I was being vindictive out of hatred, like you said."
伽菈波那：“……正如你们所说，是仇恨所致的报复心理吧。”

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

She suddenly jumps up, as if she were burned by the bonfire.
她突然像是被篝火烫到了一般，迅速地从草地上爬了起来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: "Like you said"?
伽菈波那：“正如你们所说”?

Kaalaa Baunaa: The Realm can never extract every word I've said. It's theoretically impossible.
伽菈波那：幻境中是不会有这样具体的……从理论上来说也不可能做到……

Kaalaa Baunaa: How ... Where-where did she hear that part?
伽菈波那：这句话……她，她是从哪里听到的?

3#1
3#1

无星之地
No Starry Sky JMP-14

Kaalaa Baunaa: She was in the same room?
伽菈波那：难道她当时就在那间屋子里?

Kaalaa Baunaa: How could it be?
伽菈波那：……这可能吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa pinches herself to keep calm.
伽菈波那轻轻掐动自己的掌心，试图以痛感让自己保持冷静。

Shamane: I know that room well. We have searched every inch of it—Unless she was hanging on the ceiling right above us.
鬃毛沙砾：以我对那间房子的了解……咱们几乎走遍了每一寸能走的地方——除非她挂在了天花板上。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But, as I said, she always finds herself the best seat.
伽菈波那：但就像我刚才说的，她总是……总是选择观众席的最佳位置。

Kaalaa Baunaa: "To be someone who can smile knowingly at the argument made by the lecturer, knowing full well the thinking process behind, while staying close to other whispering opinions."
伽菈波那：“既能与讲台上的瞩目者心照不宣，又能清晰地感受到周围的窃窃私语……”

Kaalaa Baunaa: "Like a perfect observatory from which we witness the events in the universe."
伽菈波那：一个……置身事内的绝佳观景位。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

The fog has lifted.
迷雾慢慢自眼前散去。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Maybe I've been in the wrong direction. She didn't make the star fall as revenge on the village.
伽菈波那：或许我一直都想错了。她并不是为了报复村子才创造了这场星体坠落……

She looks up. The sky is completely cloudless, and the stars look just like the silver sand randomly scattered into the Samudra by Vishnu.
仰起头，天空晴朗得没有一丝云彩，星辰像是毗湿奴随手撒入乳海的一抔银沙。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The sky in the Realm when we met ...
伽菈波那：那时，我们相遇的，幻境里的天空……

She recalls the sky in the Realm, which was like the surface of dusted glassware.
肮脏玻璃器皿的表面般的天空再次浮现在了眼前。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Mr. Shamane, she was not on the ceiling.
伽菈波那：鬃毛沙砾先生……她不是在天花板上。

Shamane: Are you taking me seriously? That was just a joke to lighten up the mood.
鬃毛沙砾：你当真了？我只是想开个活跃气氛的玩笑……

Kaalaa Baunaa: But, under the ground.
伽菈波那：是……在地下。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa pulls a photo slowly from her waist. It was soaked when she was in the vat, but now it is almost dried by the bonfire.
伽菈波那缓缓抽出自己悄悄塞到腰间的相片。这张小小的纸片曾被浸湿，如今，表面的潮湿在篝火的烘烤下尽数退去。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Remember the Underground Survival Guide, where we found this photo? She's right under that house.
伽菈波那：夹着它的那本《地下生存手册》……她就在那间屋子的正下方。

The street is empty. All the villagers have been evacuated. There are only Manus followers wandering about at night.
村民被疏散一空，夜晚的街道除了游荡的重塑门徒以外空无一人。

Kaalaa Baunaa: First, to the corner ...
伽菈波那：先去拐角那里……

And the ones who have returned.
但有人重新回到了这里。

Shamane: This is crazy. It has gone beyond my imagination!
鬃毛沙砾：你们真是太疯狂了……简直超出了我的认知！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Sorry, but you don't have to come with me.
伽菈波那：……很抱歉，其实你不用和我一起来的……

Shamane: *sighs* Say no more on that.
鬃毛沙砾：唉，这时候就别再和我说这个了。

The two sneak from one corner to another.
两个人影鬼鬼祟祟地从一个墙角溜到了另外一个墙角。

Shamane: If you don't let me see my own sister, I will be dying for answers! Who would dig a basement here?
鬃毛沙砾：不让我亲眼见到我姐，我真的会被自己的好奇心折磨疯！究竟是怎么样的人才能硬生生挖出个地下室来……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: That reminds me. Her curiosity is one of the, well, the major reason she did that.
伽菈波那：这你倒是提醒我了，库玛尔也有一部分——不，很大一部分，是因为她自己的好奇心才做了这种事。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's possible that she was well-prepared last time she came back to Mor Pankh. I never thought she foresaw that we would be kicked out from the project.
伽菈波那：她很可能在那次回乡假的时候就做足了准备……我以为她只是说说而已，没想到她早就预料到了我们要被踢出那个项目。

Shamane: And as you just deduced, she did so to see that star?
鬃毛沙砾：所以，就像你刚刚推测的，她是为了亲眼见到那颗星星才做了这种事?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Almost 100% sure. Without me, she must have asked the Manus to support her with arcane skills.
伽菈波那：几乎是百分之百的可能性。离开了我之后，她的神秘术支持很可能全部来自于重塑之手。

Kaalaa Baunaa: This way.
伽菈波那：——先走这边。

After avoiding the wandering Manus followers, they can almost see the entrance to the old house.
闪过了还在游荡的重塑门徒，隐约已经可以看到老屋的门口。

Kaalaa Baunaa: She was extremely mentally unstable when she left me. It wouldn't take any effort if the Manus had the intention to recruit her.
伽菈波那：她离开我的时候，精神就已经很不稳定了……这时候重塑那种组织想要招揽她，几乎只要轻轻推一下。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Watching the meteor shower and being destroyed by it has been her plan all along.
伽菈波那：……她这次，根本没打算活着看完这场烛星节的流星雨。

Shamane: At this point, it is hard to say who is worse, she or we, since we have prepared to die with her evil plan. However reluctant I am to admit this, sometimes arcanists are indeed strange creatures.
鬃毛沙砾：很难说，明知可能会跟她同归于尽的咱俩，能比她强到哪里去。尽管我不愿意承认，但有时神秘学家的血液就是这么神奇！

Shamane: Heh heh ... It's like a madhouse party! Hahaha!
鬃毛沙砾：——这下咱们就像疯子开会了！哈哈哈……！

Shamane: But what did you teach Matilda before we left?
鬃毛沙砾：不过，你临走之前，教玛蒂尔达的那个是什么啊？

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's our only chance to survive in her Realm. I came up with it when I was calculating the range of the fallen star damage.
伽菈波那：……是面对库玛尔幻境的唯一胜算……我在计算坠星灾害范围时想到的。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Shamane: As I said, you are the tiger cub, trying to take a bite in the arm, even when the hunter has had you in her grip.
鬃毛沙砾：我就说你像只虎崽子——你那时候都没放弃要给你的对手一口。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That method was between Kumar and me. There is another theory according to my calculation: if there are more observers, the Realm might collapse.
伽菈波那：那个方法原本只有我们两人知道。我计算过，一旦增加更多的观测者，幻境就有可能坍塌。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's the only theory Kumar doesn't know. At the same time, it is not yet strictly verified.
伽菈波那：那是唯一一条库玛尔不知道的理论……也是一条未经过严格实验的理论。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But I have faith in that girl. She is indeed a genius.
伽菈波那：但我相信那个孩子……她确实是个天才。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I hope it's not too late to make our last attempt.
伽菈波那：——只希望现在还是我们孤注一掷的好时机。

Shamane: Hmm, if you ask me, it's not yet the time to make that attempt.
鬃毛沙砾：……嗯，要我说，还说早了两分钟。

Kaalaa Baunaa: What?
伽菈波那：什么……

They are only one step away from the old house.
二人几乎就要踏入那间旧屋的门槛。

A huge Shiva statue rises with the loud rumble.
隆隆的巨响声中，巨大的湿婆神像拔地而起。

Shamane: Haha! This must be the appetizer she served us.
鬃毛沙砾：看来是她留给咱的开胃前菜。

Shamane: *sighs* Great Shiva, I hope your fists feel as light and crispy as pani puri when they land on my body!
鬃毛沙砾：——唉，伟大的湿婆神啊，但愿您的拳头打在我们身上就像那些脆球饼一样酥！

Kaalaa Baunaa: *pants* That's tough.
伽菈波那：呼……呼……真不容易。

Shamane: Hey, look over there!
鬃毛沙砾：喂，你看那里……

The statue's attack has left a crack in the floor of the old house.
老屋的地板被石像破坏出了一道缝隙。

Kaalaa Baunaa: It is empty down there.
伽菈波那：……底下果然是，空的。

3#1
3#1

博识者美餐
Feast for the Savant JMP-15

???: ♪
???: ♪～

Radio: The shower is estimated to fall at 4 a.m. today. By then, the comet will also ...
收音机：……流星雨将于今日凌晨四时降落，届时，彗星也将……

???: Three and a half hours to go. Oh, almost forgot about this—music.
???: 还有……三个半小时。噢，哦对了……音乐——

???: ♪
???: ♪～

Basement
地下空间

In this dark, confined space, there arises a melody played on the violin.
幽暗逼仄的空间内，小提琴的声音悠然响起。

The place looks nothing like a livable space for humans.
这并不像是一个人类居住的空间。

The walls, the table, the floor ... Every surface in sight is covered with paper of seamless formulas. The only exception is a roughly plastered wall, which is full of symbols marking the passing of days.
墙上，桌上，地上。目光所及之处的平面几乎都被密密麻麻的演算纸尽数淹没。而粗糙的抹制墙壁上，刻满了密密麻麻的计数日期。

An old telescope is standing in the mess, pointing at the blocked sky.
一个老式望远镜立在演算纸之间，指向不存在的天空。

Shamane: *coughs* You alright?
鬃毛沙砾：咳，咳咳……喂，你没摔倒吧……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I-I'm fine. It's not too high for me.
伽菈波那：……我，我没事，刚刚好能下……来。

They slide down through the crack.
二人踉跄地顺着缝隙滑了下来。

Kaalaa Baunaa gets back on her feet, patting the dust off her.
伽菈波那扑落着尘土站起身。

And then, she freezes.
——然后僵在了原地。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar!
伽菈波那：库玛尔……！

Kaalaa Baunaa: What ... what happened to you?
伽菈波那：你怎么……变成了这个样子。

Kumar: Oh, well. I didn't expect so many visitors.
库玛尔：噢，怎么……人来得这样齐？

She seems a bit absent-minded.
她显得有些恍惚。

Kumar: But since you're here, please take a seat. I built this place by myself. It's not a big room and not soundproof.
库玛尔：既然来了，那请坐吧。这地方我自己修的。不大，隔音也差——

Kumar: Yes, I heard you very clearly under the ground when you searched the room and went through my stuff. What's wrong about an astronomer reading "Calf Feeding and Management"?
库玛尔：噢，你们在上面搜我房子时，我听得一清二楚——《犊牛的饲养与管理》，怎么就不能让天文学家读了？

She paces around shakily, muttering to herself.
她颤颤巍巍地挪动着步子，喃喃自语着。

Kumar: You ... you should have left. Hmm, my plan has chan- ... changed.
库玛尔：你们……你们应该走的。唔，我现在已经不想……

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Let it be. Let it be. What do they call this? Destiny? You know about destiny, right, Kaalaa Baunaa?
库玛尔：算了，算啦……这叫什么……命运？伽菈波那，你懂这个，对吧？

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kumar: Watching the stars with me. Good, good. It's like living the old days again.
库玛尔：和我一起看星星……挺好，挺好……就像以前一样。

She turns around. Her gaze falls on Shamane.
她转过头，目光落在了鬃毛沙砾身上。

Shamane: Kumar. Sister.
鬃毛沙砾：库玛……姐姐。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Haha. Sister. Sister ...
库玛尔：呵呵……姐姐……姐姐……

A fleeting sneer appears on her lips.
她的嘴角向上扯了扯，又快速地垂了下去。

Kaalaa Baunaa frowns deeply.
伽菈波那的眉头紧锁。

Kaalaa Baunaa: You looked much better in the Realm. What did the Manus do to you?
伽菈波那：你明明，在幻境里不还是挺正——重塑之手到底对你做了什么？

Kumar: The Manus? Oh, they're fine. Helps me a lot. Impressive arcane skills, experiment apparatus, and food—lots of food.
库玛尔：重塑？噢，他们挺好的，他们帮了我很多，厉害的神秘术，实验器械，还有……食物，很多的食物。

Following Kumar's fingertip, they see a pile of naans in the corner, which are under a layer of unknown insects.
顺着她的指尖望过去，烤饼堆满了一个角落，密密匝匝地爬着不知名的小虫。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: These are ...
伽菈波那：这，这……

Shamane: Seems like she's no longer capable of commanding those wandering Manus.
鬃毛沙砾：……看起来不是她不去指挥那些游荡的重塑……只是她已经没有能力了。

He would have panicked, but he is calm this time.
他如今已经不会再惊讶于自己的冷静。

He reminds Kaalaa Baunaa in a whisper.
鬃毛沙砾压低声音，小声提醒着伫立在原地的伽菈波那。

Shamane: But the priority is to stop that star. We can deal with the rest ...
鬃毛沙砾：但当务之急，先看看能不能阻止那颗星星，剩下的——

Kumar: The star? You're going to stop the comet. You are taking it from me? Again?!
库玛尔：星星？你们要阻止那颗星星——你们又要！又要抢走我的星星！！

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar. Argh!!
伽菈波那：库玛——啊！

Kumar, who was absent-minded a second ago, seems to be triggered now. She suddenly pushes the two out with enormous strength.
原本恍惚的女人像是被打开了什么开关，突然爆发出了巨大的力量，一把将即将靠近的二人推了出去。

Kumar: I will never ...
库玛尔：我绝不会……

The confined space starts melting.
周围逼仄的空间开始融解。

Shamane: ...!
鬃毛沙砾：……！

The basement is no longer there.
地下室不复存在。

Instead, the space opens up, unfolding before them like the vast universe. Nebulas are churning beneath their feet, like a colorful, harmless mist.
原本逼仄的空间变得广阔无垠，宇宙像幕布一般在眼前展开。星云在脚下翻滚着，柔软、轻盈、乖巧，如同孩童的安抚毯。

Kumar stands in the void, like standing in the middle of a grand stage.
库玛尔伫立在虚幻的宇宙中，如同伫立在舞台的中央。

Kumar: I will never let anyone set their hands on it!
库玛尔：我绝不会让任何人阻止它——！

3#14
3#14

新观星者们
The New Stargazers JMP-16

Shamane: *pants*
鬃毛沙砾：呼，呼……

Shamane: I-I'm gonna throw up. It feels strange in here.
鬃毛沙砾：我，呕——我要吐了。幻境里怎么……

Shamane feels his legs weaken. He sinks to the floor.
鬃毛沙砾脚步虚浮，一屁股跌坐在地上。

Shamane: ... Was that Master's face?
鬃毛沙砾：哦……哦……那是我师父的脸吗……呕……

Shamane: I-I can keep up.
鬃毛沙砾：我还——可以——

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's hard to get used to it for the first time.
伽菈波那：……第一次进来的人是会不太习惯。

Though panting unstably, Kaalaa Baunaa is still staring at Kumar, who has regained elegance in the Realm.
伽菈波那气息不匀，死死地盯着在幻境里恢复了状态的库玛尔。

Kumar: I feel a lot better in here. I'm sorry, Kaalaa Baunaa. I don't think this body of mine can hold any longer for a more appropriate meeting in the real world.
库玛尔：还是在这里更舒服一些。很抱歉，伽菈波那。我想现实中的我已经没办法体面地与你久别重逢了。

Kumar: I'm glad you came back for me. What I said was indeed too harsh.
库玛尔：你能回来找我，我很高兴——我承认，那些话是有些重了。

Kumar has turned back to herself.
库玛尔又变回了她熟悉的样子。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar, why do you have to ...? Look at you. The price is too high.
伽菈波那：库玛尔……你为什么即便要变成那个样子，也要……

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Hmm, in the first instance, I did have other intentions.
库玛尔：唔，在最开始的时候，我的想法确实没那么单纯。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kumar: I kept imagining how my so-called "parents" would react when they were about to get crushed to pieces by the star.
库玛尔：我一直想象着，那对抛弃了我的父母，被这颗星星砸到脸上时，他们会是什么表情。

Kumar: Little did I know, they have already paid for what they've done.
库玛尔：……但我没想到，他们已经自食其果了。

Kumar casts a quick glance at her puking brother and looks back at Kaalaa Baunaa.
她将目光移向远处那个不断干呕的身影，又飞速地挪了回来。

Kumar: I worked myself to the bone, but who knew I would lose everything, including my purpose? It really sucks.
库玛尔：我付出了一切，但却没了目标。呵呵……那滋味真不好受。

Kumar: But it's okay. Just a minor setback. Compared to what I've been through, it's not even worth mentioning.
库玛尔：但无所谓，这是个小小的挫折——远小于我曾经历过的那些……甚至不值一提。

Kumar: That's why I changed my mind.
库玛尔：所以，在最后，我改变了主意。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kumar: I want to see it.
库玛尔：……我想见见它。

Kaalaa Baunaa: To see it? The star we can't see with our eyes?
伽菈波那：见到那颗……看不到的星星……?

Kumar: Seems like I was not very careful about my wording when my mind was clouded.
库玛尔：看来是我神智不清的时候，用词不够严谨了。

Kumar: It is a celestial body, Kaalaa Baunaa, not a star. It could even be a ... moving black hole.
库玛尔：——那个天体。伽菈波那，那不是一颗星——它甚至可能是一个……运动着的黑洞。

Kumar lifts her palms, like she has done so many times in Kaalaa Baunaa's inquisitive gaze and in the lecture hall of the university.
她举起双手，那神态不像在星云散布的幻境中，更像是在研究所，在黑板前，在伽菈波那无数次投向她的求知的目光里。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'd rather you did this out of the hatred towards the people who abandoned you, or even towards me ...
伽菈波那：……我倒宁愿你只是因为，恨那些抛弃你的人，甚至是恨我……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... for I carelessly exposed my identity as an arcanist, and thus you lost your ...
伽菈波那：恨我因为粗心大意暴露了神秘学家的身份，导致你……失去了……

Kumar: I wish the same. I wish so badly that I could just be filled with pure hatred towards someone. But I can't, kid.
库玛尔：我也想，我太想去恨一个人了——但是我做不到，孩子。

Once again, Kumar looks at Shamane. He still feels dizzy.
她再次看向在幻境中晕眩的鬃毛沙砾。

Kumar: You're the lucky one, young brother. I was going to kick your butt in our last encounter, but ... I just couldn't do it.
库玛尔：你很好运，弟弟。我那次本来是盘算着揍你一顿的，但是，看着那样一无所知的你……我下不去手。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: But the Manus has made you ...
伽菈波那：可是你，你因为重塑……

Kumar: Kid. Banner University can get my name on the SCI list, while the Manus allows me to touch the universe. They are not that different to me.
库玛尔：噢，孩子，班纳尔大学能让我发 SCI，而重塑能让我触及宇宙……这二者对我来说并无不同。

Shamane: Sister, Mother told me about this. You physically can't take such a great amount of arcanum in you! The Manus should also know this!
鬃毛沙砾：……老姐，母亲和我提及过——你的体质无法承受这样强度的神秘术，重塑他们应该知道这个！

Kumar: I appreciate that they remembered this about me, but this is the path I chose.
库玛尔：……我很感谢他们还记得我，但我是自愿的。

Kumar looks down at the swirling nebula.
库玛尔低头，看着脚下涌动的星云。

Kumar: When I look into the sky, I feel myself the freest being in the world.
库玛尔：当我抬头仰望星空的时候，原本是我最自由的时候。

Kumar: The universe, what a vast, life-embracing place it is! No matter if you're an arcanist, or a human, even a grain of sand ... it encompassed everything.
库玛尔：宇宙，它可以包容你的一切——无论你是神秘学家、人类，甚至是一粒小小的土……它都会包容你。

Kumar: But I was driven away from studying it, abandoned by my own family, for some insignificant, unimportant reasons.
库玛尔：可我却因为最微不足道的事情，被逐出了我自己的事业，逐出了我的家庭。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kumar: I should have understood this earlier ... that my struggle means nothing on this planet.
库玛尔：我早该明白的……我这样的挣扎，在这颗星球上毫无意义。

Kumar: I'm tired, Kaalaa Baunaa. I just want to see that celestial body with my own eyes.
库玛尔：我累了，伽菈波那，我只想见见它。

Kaalaa Baunaa: But, Kumar ...
伽菈波那：可是，库玛尔……

Kaalaa Baunaa tries to stare into her eyes.
伽菈波那试图注视她的眼睛。

Kaalaa Baunaa: That's not how you look at a star. The telescope shouldn't be placed in a basement, and you shouldn't lower your head.
伽菈波那：星星不是这样看的，望远镜不应该放在地下室，不应垂下头颅……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar, how long has it been since the last time you looked up at the night sky, at the other stars?
伽菈波那：库玛尔，你已经有多久，没见过夜空，没看见过那些其他的星星了——

Kaalaa Baunaa: What's more ...
伽菈波那：而且……

Kaalaa Baunaa looks grave.
伽菈波那的神情变得严肃。

Kaalaa Baunaa: If the star falls, people in the village, including those kids—none of them will survive.
伽菈波那：这颗天体如果真的落下，整个村子的人——包括那些孩子，将无一人幸免。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The Manus you summoned here has brought disaster to this place, to the people and their families.
伽菈波那：你操控的重塑……也已经伤害了太多的人，破坏了太多的家庭。

Kaalaa Baunaa: They are not the sacrifice of your wish.
伽菈波那：——他们不应该为你的愿望陪葬。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Stop heading down the wrong path, Kumar.
伽菈波那：……不要再一意孤行地继续下去了，库玛尔。

Weariness reigns over Kumar.
憔悴冲破了体面的躯壳，映在库玛尔的眉宇间。

She raises her eyebrows and shakes her head slowly, as if nothing matters to her anymore.
而后，她扬起眉毛，摇了摇头，好像这些事情并不严重，而伽菈波那只是提出了一个无理的、无价值的研究提案。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: You know what? I don't care about them.
库玛尔：你知道吗？我不在乎那些。

Kumar: Just like they've never cared about me, have they?
库玛尔：——从来也没人在乎过我，不是吗？

Kumar denies her, like she did when Kaalaa Baunaa pitched a terrible research proposal.
她轻轻摇了摇头。

Kumar: Sorry, please indulge me with one last willful act.
库玛尔：抱歉，这是我最后的愿望了。

As Kumar raises her arms, the stars in the Realm form a straight line.
库玛尔抬起手臂，幻境中的星星排列成了一条直线。

Kumar: This is the path I chose.
库玛尔：我只想走我选择的路。

Kumar: And you can't stop me, Kaalaa Baunaa.
库玛尔：你无法阻止我，伽菈波那。

Kumar: Hmm?
库玛尔：嗯？

Clear cracks come from the depths of the universe, one after another.
清脆的碎裂声自宇宙深处响起，一声接着一声。

Kumar: What?
库玛尔：什么……

Kaalaa Baunaa: It's Matilda! They made it!
伽菈波那：……看来是玛蒂尔达他们赶上了！

Matilda: Hurry! Quickly! Do you understand? Yes, that's what Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa taught me to do.
玛蒂尔达：快！快！学会了吗？没错……伽菈波那小姐就是这样教的……

Kanjira: Hmm. But I can't see anything when my eyes are closed.
坎吉拉：唔，可是闭上眼睛的话，什么也看不到啊？

Matilda: Don't rely on the eyes. Hold this crystal and take a deep breath.
玛蒂尔达：不要用你的眼睛……握好了这颗水晶，深呼吸——

The kids sit next to Matilda, forming an imperfect circle by the fire.
几个孩子贴着玛蒂尔达，他们在篝火边，坐成了一个不完美的圆。

Outside this little circle, the human kids are peering around curiously.
外围，以阿贾尔为首的几个人类孩子好奇地探头探脑。

Under the starry sky, the ones sitting by the fire take a deep breath and put their hands on a small idol.
星穹之下，篝火旁的众人深吸了一口气，将手叠放在一枚小小的神像上。

Kanjira: To feel, emm, what she said?
坎吉拉：去感受……她怎么说的来着？

Passer-by Boy: The change of the universe.
路人男孩：宇宙的变化……

The starry sky is completely quiet.
星空寂静。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Matilda: The meteor shower is starting earlier!
玛蒂尔达：流星雨提前开始了！！

Kumar: What did you do?
库玛尔：……你做了什么？

Kaalaa Baunaa: *coughs* That's the method only once known between you and me, Kumar.
伽菈波那：咳咳……只有咱们两个掌握的技巧，库玛尔。

Kumar: The observation method?
库玛尔：观测技巧？

Kumar: You told others about the Celestial Egg?
库玛尔：你把“宇宙之卵”的观测方法告诉了别人？

Kumar: So wh- ...
库玛尔：那又怎……

She stops herself.
她止住了话头。

She's always the clever one.
是的，她唯一的天赋就是聪慧——

Kumar: I see, I see. You once pitched that research proposal to me.
库玛尔：……我懂了，我懂了。你提交过这个研究方向……

An almost gratified look appears on her face.
她脸上的表情称得上欣慰。

Kumar: You are indeed my best student, Kaalaa Baunaa.
库玛尔：你确实是我最好的学生，伽菈波那。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: I finally understand why you asked me to keep it a secret. Even if we named it Egg, it's actually a projection of the universe, which has the same feature.
伽菈波那：我之后终于明白你为何一直要求我守口如瓶——尽管我们称那个东西为“卵”……但它仍然是宇宙的投影，拥有宇宙的特性。

Kaalaa Baunaa: The universe is infinite, as long as we observe it self-consciously, think each of ourselves as one of the centers of the universe.
伽菈波那：宇宙是无限的……只要我有意识地，以自己为原点开始观测……我就变为了宇宙中心。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: The Egg will then collapse because of multiple centers, until it puts a quietus on everything, including that star.
伽菈波那：“卵”会因为观测中心的增多而逐渐碎裂，坍缩……直到恢复寂灭，连同那颗星一起。

Kaalaa Baunaa: A shattered mirror will never be pieced together again, if there are enough forces to break it. Am I right?
伽菈波那：——只要拳头足够多，镜子就会完全破碎，不是吗?

Kaalaa Baunaa: *"Then there was neither existence nor non-existence; there was neither the realm of space nor the sky beyond."*
伽菈波那：“于那时日，混沌中空无一物。存在者与非存在者皆无，无至上之域，无大气，无天穹。”

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Who could master these skills? Those old fogeys in the village?
库玛尔：是谁？那群顽固的老家伙们?

Kaalaa Baunaa: A genius girl and a bunch of kids who looked up at the stars.
伽菈波那：一个天才小姑娘……和一群抬头看过星空的孩子……

"Just like you and me in the beginning."
就像你当初带着我那样。

Kaalaa Baunna's lips quietly move, but none of those words come out.
伽菈波那嘴唇翕动，将这几个不合时宜的音节吞入了腹中。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm sorry, Kumar. I have to—no, we have to—stop you this time.
伽菈波那：很抱歉，库玛尔……这次我，不，我们一定要阻止你。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I can't let you destroy Mor Pankh ...
伽菈波那：我不能看着你毁了摩卢旁卡——

They are not enemies. At least for now, this is not a confrontation.
她不是敌人——至少现在，这并非是一场对抗。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ... or destroy yourself.
伽菈波那：更不能看着你这样毁了自己。

3#1
3#1

无昼无夜
Neither Day Nor Night JMP-17

Shamane: It's about to collapse! Got to go now.
鬃毛沙砾：——这里快塌了！我们快离开……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar! KUMAR!!
伽菈波那：库玛尔！库玛尔——！

She extends her arm as far as possible, reaching for that figure.
她奋力向前伸出手去，试图够到那抹破碎的身影。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Ah!
伽菈波那：呃啊……！

A giant rock falls between them. Kumar is lost in her sight.
巨大的土块落下，阻断了她们之间的路。

The shabby basement has completely collapsed. Moonlight floats down through the ceiling that no longer exists.
粗糙的地下室彻底坍塌，月光自早已不存在的天花板上散落下来。

Kaalaa Baunaa: *coughs*
伽菈波那：咳，咳咳……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Mr. Shamane, you covered me.
伽菈波那：……鬃毛沙砾先生，你帮我挡了……

He pats the dust off his shoulder.
男人拂开肩上的尘土。

Shamane: I'm fine.
鬃毛沙砾：我没事。

He looks in the other direction.
他将目光投向远处。

Shamane: ...
鬃毛沙砾：……

Kaalaa Baunaa follows his gaze and sees Kumar.
伽菈波那顺着他的目光望去。

Kumar: Pretty ...
库玛尔：真漂亮啊……

The ragged woman with gray hair looks up slowly at the night sky.
衣衫褴褛，头发带着点花白的女人像是不熟悉这个动作似的，缓缓地抬起了头。

Several meteors are crossing the sky with glaring tails.
夜空之中，几颗流星带着辉煌的尾焰划破了深色的天穹。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Shamane: Her Realm has gone, taking that falling star with it.
鬃毛沙砾：幻境破灭，坠落的天体消失了……

Shamane: Tonight, only the meteor shower will sparkle in the sky.
鬃毛沙砾：只有流星雨一如往日地落下……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar. Kumar!
伽菈波那：……库玛尔……库玛尔！

Kaalaa Baunaa, who is now also ragged, staggers toward the one staring at the night sky.
同样一身狼狈的女人踉跄着跑向那个正抬头看向夜空的身影。

She's haunted by an ominous feeling.
不安爬上了她的背脊。

Faster, even faster, get to her side like she used to ...
快一点，快一些，像以前一样，重新握住……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar.
伽菈波那：……库玛尔。

Finally, Kaalaa Baunaa holds Kumar's hands.
伽菈波那终于握住了她的双手。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm still here, Kumar. How about we ... go back first?
伽菈波那：库玛尔……我还在，我们……先回去怎么样?

Kumar: Go back?
库玛尔：回去?

Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes, go back to the institution, to the university ...
伽菈波那：对，回去，回到研究所，回到大学里面——

She cannot continue.
她说不下去了。

Kumar: It seems Kumar can no longer understand her words. She just frowns and stares at her in confusion.
库玛尔：眼前人似乎已经听不懂她所说的一切，只是拧着眉毛，疑惑地看着她。

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Suddenly, she relaxes her eyebrows and smiles while shaking her head.
库玛尔：忽然，她的眉头舒展开来，笑着摇了摇头。

Kumar: There's no place I can go back to.
库玛尔：我没有可以回去的地方。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes, there is! You can stay at my place. You can use my lab. We can start over.
伽菈波那：有！有的……我会接你到我那里，你去我的研究所，我们还能从头开始……

Kumar: ...
库玛尔：……

Kumar: Sure.
库玛尔：可以呀。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Really? You will? Let's go then! Leave this place first.
伽菈波那：真的吗？你真的愿意……走！那咱们先离开这里……

Kaalaa Baunaa gets up quickly and holds Kumar's arm in hers. She drags Kumar to leave, seemingly afraid that Kumar may change her mind.
伽菈波那迅速起身，像是怕对方反悔似的拽住她的胳膊转身就走。

Kumar: But there are some papers I need to take with me. Let go of my arm.
库玛尔：不过我需要带些资料离开，你先放开我。

Says Kumar behind Kaalaa Baunaa. She sounds quite relaxed.
库玛尔在她身后轻轻说道。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Okay.
伽菈波那：……好。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Somehow, Kaalaa Baunaa dares not look back. She can only look up at Shamane's face.
她觉得自己有点不敢回头，只得抬头看向对面男人的面孔。

Kaalaa Baunaa: Mr. Sharma, Kumar says she'll come with us! She just needs to take some papers. It won't take long!
伽菈波那：鬃毛沙砾先生……库玛尔说会和我们离开！她要去拿些东西……很快……

Shamane: He slowly shakes his head.
鬃毛沙砾：男人缓缓地摇了摇头。

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...
伽菈波那：……

Shamane never feels this calm. He looks at his sister, but he feels he is looking at someone else.
鬃毛沙砾的眼神比任何一个时刻都平静。他望着库玛尔的方向，却又不像是在看着她。

He is looking at a weary soul waiting for her final salvation.
他望向的，是一个等待解脱的疲惫灵魂。

She is his last kin.
她或许是这个世界上最后一位与自己血脉相连的人。

And he is going to respect her decision.
但他决定尊重她的选择。

Kumar: *"Then there was neither death nor immortality; there was neither day nor night."*
库玛尔：“无死无生，无昼无夜。”

Kumar: Everyone has a place to go back to. What a nice world to live in.
库玛尔：每个人都能回去……多好的地方啊。

Kumar is familiar with the space, even if it's a ruin now. She reaches a corner and takes out a black gadget.
女人轻车熟路地走向坍塌之处的一隅，从其中摸出一把泛着黑色的小巧东西。

It is the only item she has ever asked from Manus Vindictae.
这是在第一次接触重塑时，她开口向他们索要的唯一物品。

And now, for the second and the last time, she places her hand on it.
从那之后——直到现在，它终于再次被她握在掌心。

Kumar: I hope ... when the universe constructs me for a second time, I will not come to this world again.
库玛尔：希望下次……宇宙再次将我重构的时候，不要让我再来到这样的世界啦。

Bang!
“砰——”

Chandigarh Night Market
昌迪加尔夜市

Ajar: Wow! So this is what Chandigarh look like! It slay!
阿贾尔：哦哦……这里就是昌迪加尔！太酷了！

Passerby: What's this? Candy?
路人女孩：那是什么……糖果吗?

Ajar: This way. Come over here.
阿贾尔：这边，快来这边……

The once rugged paths have been turned into smooth roads. In this new city, the villagers still carry on their old customs.
尽管门前崎岖的土路如今早已变为了平坦的街道，但从旧村搬至新城的住民仍旧沿袭着他们以往的习俗。

Candles have lit up every street for the new immigrants on this spring night.
春日的夜晚，点点烛火照亮了移居者们居住的每条大街小巷。

Shamane: Ah. So you're only an assistant! No wonder they made you go through so many procedures earlier.
鬃毛沙砾：哦哦。原来你只是个协助教员啊！怪不得申请的时候这么麻烦。

Kanjira: Haha. What? So you is just rookie?
坎吉拉：什么？原来你是个半吊子呀！嘻嘻……

Matilda: Shut up! I won't allow another word of it! Humph, you'd better be careful; otherwise, you will regret your doings when you get to the Foundation!
玛蒂尔达：可恶！不准你再说！哼，当心点……等你到基金会，我一定要给你好看！

Kanjira: Heh heh.
坎吉拉：噗呲！

Matilda: Did you just make a face to me? Stop right there!
玛蒂尔达：你还冲我做鬼脸——你别跑！

Foundation Member: Ms. Sherjah and Mr. Sharma.
基金会人员：夏尔贾女士和……鬃毛沙砾先生。

Foundation Member: Thank you so much for helping our staff.
基金会人员：非常感谢你们二人对基金会成员的支援。

Ms. Sherjah: Emm, you flattered me. I just did what I could.
夏尔贾老师：呃，没有……我只是帮了一点小忙——

Foundation Member: No, madam, we've ascertained your achievement.
基金会人员：不，女士。您的行为我们已尽数知悉……

Foundation Member: Before this incident, you volunteered to help over 10 arcanists and human children, and this time you rescued more than 30 arcanists.
基金会人员：在此之前，您志愿救助了神秘学家与人类孩童 10 余名，在此次行动中，您共救助神秘学家 30 余名……

Foundation Member: That's remarkable, madam.
基金会人员：非常了不起的成绩，女士。

The woman in the Foundation uniform seems to be smiling at Sherjah and passes over a gray envelope.
身着基金会制服的女性似乎在面具之下对她微微一笑，随即递出了一张灰白色的信封。

Ms. Sherjah: What's this ...
夏尔贾老师：这是……

Foundation Member: A letter of introduction to the St. Pavlov Foundation.
基金会人员：圣洛夫基金会的入职介绍信。

Ms. Sherjah: ...!
夏尔贾老师：……！

Foundation Member: I'm sure you know our branch in Chandigarh is already under construction. Such a responsible and caring human member like you will be very welcome.
基金会人员：您也知道，基金会驻昌迪加尔分部目前仍在建设中，我们非常欢迎像您这样富有责任心的人类成员加入。

Foundation Member: Please do consider this opportunity.
基金会人员：请您务必考虑一下这个机会。

The Foundation member rummages through the materials in her hand.
基金会人员低下头，翻找手中的资料。

Foundation Member: According to the record, there's one more arcanist who also provided help for us in this mission.
基金会人员：根据记录，还有一名神秘学家也在此次任务中给予了我方帮助……

Foundation Member: So, where is Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?
基金会人员：请问，伽菈波那小姐……她现在在哪里？

Ms. Sherjah: Oh, she's ...
夏尔贾老师：噢，她在……

Sherjah turns around. Kanjira is gone too.
夏尔贾回过头，发现连坎吉拉也不见了身影。

Ms. Sherjah: That's weird.
夏尔贾老师：奇怪……

Ms. Sherjah: Oh!
夏尔贾老师：……啊！

She suddenly realizes something.
夏尔贾想起了什么。

Ms. Sherjah: I think it's not a good time for her.
夏尔贾老师：我想现在……她可能不太方便。

Foundation Member: ...?
基金会人员：……?

Ms. Sherjah: They will be back after the meteor shower.
夏尔贾老师：等流星雨结束，他们就会回来的。

Kanjira: Ah! Meteor shower! So many of they as the news mention!
坎吉拉：啊！是流星雨！果然和新闻里说的一样大！

Kanjira: Hmm. I wish I can have my stomach full every day when I go school!
坎吉拉：唔……我要许愿去学校之后，每天都能吃饱！

Matilda: Let me be an investigator, even for once!
玛蒂尔达：让我成为调查员吧，哪怕只有一次也好……！

Shamane: Alright, people, don't be greedy! One wish only!
鬃毛沙砾：好啦，别那么贪心，许一个就好了……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Goodbye, Kumar.
伽菈波那：<再见，库玛尔。>

3#2
3#2